Living in Hannover

A Practical Handbook for International Students
at Leibniz University Hannover

For students from every country — arrival, studies, everyday life, work and beyond

PDF edition — built on 2026-11-10
Live version: github.com/FreeXYZ-HalfPI/Hannover-Handbook-InternationalStudents
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Living in Hannover — A Practical Handbook for International Students

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A step-by-step guide for international students of Leibniz University Hannover (LUH) — from every country. · Whole handbook last reviewed: 2026-10-26

📥 **Download the whole handbook as one PDF** — it downloads straight away.

What is this handbook?

A practical, step-by-step guide for international students at Leibniz University Hannover (LUH): from applying while still at home, to arriving in Hannover, studying, working and staying after graduation. Each topic has its own page, and every page answers the same questions: What do I need to do? Where do I start? Which documents do I need and what does it cost? Which office is responsible? Where can I find official, up-to-date information?

Most pages apply to **every** international student. Where rules differ by nationality or status, you'll see the 🌍 symbol — and **Section 8** collects everything that depends on where you come from.

Where do I start?

- 🌍 **Not sure which rules apply to you?** → 58. Which rules apply to you? (by nationality)
- **Haven't applied yet?** → 1. Applying, uni-assist and recognition
- **Admitted and still at home?** → 2. Before you arrive
- **Just arrived?** → 54. Checklist from application to graduation
- **Is your family coming too?** → 11. Family
- **Looking for a phone number or address?** → 55. Official links and contacts
- **Don't understand a German term?** → 53. German–English glossary
- **Looking for something specific?** → 🔎 Search both handbooks (open the file in your browser) or run `python3 tools/search.py "your words"`
- **Quick question?** → 56. FAQ
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How every page is structured

1. **Purpose:** what problem the page solves.
2. **Who needs this?** All students, international students, or a specific group (🌍).
3. **Steps:** in order, in plain language.
4. **Documents and costs:** separating required from possible items.
5. **Responsible office:** official name, address and contact.
6. **Sources and official links:** a table of every source on the page with its **access date** and check result.
7. **Student experiences:** kept separate from official information; not legal advice.

The last review date of each page is in the green box at the top.

Symbols

Symbol	Meaning
🌍	Depends on your nationality or residence status
⚠️	Information needs confirmation from an official source
ℹ️	General tip or reminder
Yellow box	Important warning or "not legal advice" reminder
"unofficial / secondary source"	A figure or claim found only in a non-official source
✅ in the sources table	Link opened on the access date

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Contributing and maintenance

- **Report an error or add an experience:** → 57. Suggestions and experiences
- **Source rule:** every claim, figure, deadline or fee needs a source link next to it and must appear in the page's sources table with an access date. Priority: the university (uni-hannover.de), the City and Region of Hannover (hannover.de), the law (gesetze-im-internet.de), the Federal Government's portal (make-it-in-germany.com) and the responsible office.
- **Updates:** residence, insurance, tax and work rules change quickly; review these pages at least once a semester and update the dates.

> This handbook is general guidance, not legal, tax or medical advice. The responsible official office always has the final word.

Section 1 — Arriving in Hannover & First Steps

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Last reviewed: 2026-10-24 · Back to the handbook contents

The first administrative tasks, in the order you actually need to do them: from applying, visa and pre-departure documents to registering your address, bank, insurance, residence permit and bringing your family.

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- 1. Applying, uni-assist and recognition of your certificates — deadlines, uni-assist/VPD, anabin, Studienkolleg and ZAB
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- 3. Arriving in Hannover — from the airport or station to the university; tickets for the first days
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- 6. Opening a bank account — current account, basic account right and documents
- 7. Health insurance — choosing an insurer, EHIC, M10 and monthly cost
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- 9. Tax ID and official letters — Steuer-ID and broadcasting fee
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- 11. Family — bringing your spouse and children

🌍 Looking for the rules for your nationality? → Section 8 — Information by nationality

1. Applying, uni-assist and Recognition of Your Certificates

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 1 — Arriving in Hannover & First Steps · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

The first step is getting admitted. This page explains how to apply to Leibniz University Hannover (LUH), when the deadlines are, what uni-assist and the VPD are, and how foreign school and university certificates are assessed.

2. Who needs this?

- Bachelor's and Master's applicants who are still abroad or already in Germany.
- Graduates who need their foreign degree assessed for work or further study.
- 🌍 Rules differ for EU/EEA applicants, applicants with a German school-leaving certificate and applicants from APS countries (China, India, Vietnam) — see Section 8 — Information by nationality.

3. Steps

1. **Find your programme and its requirements.** Entry and language requirements are set in each programme's admission regulations, and only those regulations are binding (LUH – Language requirements). Programme search: LUH – Degree programmes.
2. **Deadlines.** Many Master's programmes have earlier deadlines for **non-EU applicants**: **15 April – 31 May** for the winter semester and **15 October – 30 November** of the previous year for the summer semester (not every programme starts in summer). German and EU applicants usually have until 15 July / 15 January. Some programmes are exceptions (LUH – Overview of application deadlines (PDF); LUH – Application & admission). ⚠️ Always check the current year's deadline for your own programme.
3. **VPD from uni-assist.** Non-EU applicants with foreign certificates usually need a **preliminary review documentation (VPD)** from uni-assist, which they must submit to the university themselves before the deadline (uni-assist – VPD; LUH – Language requirements).
4. **VPD timing.** A VPD usually takes 4–6 weeks after your documents and payment arrive; send everything at least **8 weeks before the deadline**. A VPD is valid for **one year** from issue (uni-assist – FAQs). 🌍 uni-assist publishes country-specific document requirements: uni-assist – Country information.

5. **Translations.** Documents not in German or English need a certified translation into German or English, together with the original-language document (uni-assist – FAQs).
6. **Language.** Bachelor's applicants with foreign certificates need German at **B1** to apply and **C1** to enrol, unless the programme regulations say otherwise. English-taught Master's programmes set their own English requirements (LUH – Language requirements). → 35. Learning German
7. **Does your school certificate give direct access?** Check the free **anabin** database (school certificates and universities by country). If your certificate does not give direct university access, you may need the **Feststellungsprüfung** after a year at a preparatory college (**Studienkolleg**) — Lower Saxony's is in Hannover (anabin; Niedersächsisches Studienkolleg).
8. **Assessment of a foreign university degree.** Check anabin first; if your university or degree is not listed, the **ZAB** issues a "Statement of Comparability" (Zeugnisbewertung). This is a comparison, not a professional licence (Recognition in Germany – Assessment of higher education qualifications; ZAB – Fees).
9. **After admission:** visa, proof of finances and insurance → 2. Before you arrive; enrolment → 12. Admission and enrolment.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
VPD from uni-assist	Required (non-EU with foreign certificates)	Valid for one year	uni-assist
uni-assist fee	Required	Set by the universities; paid regardless of the outcome	uni-assist – Handling fees
Certified translations	Required (documents not in German or English)	—	uni-assist – FAQs
Language certificate	Required	Depends on programme	LUH
APS certificate	Required (school/university education in China, India or Vietnam)	Apply in your home country before applying	61. Visa-required countries & APS
ZAB Statement of Comparability	Possible	€208; usually about three months	ZAB – Fees

5. Responsible office

- **Preliminary review:** uni-assist e.V. — uni-assist.de
- **Admission and advice:** Leibniz University Hannover — Central Student Advisory Service → 21. ServiceCenter; International Office → 22. International Office
- **Degree assessment:** Zentralstelle für ausländisches Bildungswesen (ZAB) — zab.kmk.org

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Language requirements	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
2	LUH – Degree programmes	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	LUH – Overview of application deadlines (PDF)	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	LUH – Application & admission	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	uni-assist – VPD	uni-assist	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	uni-assist – FAQs	uni-assist	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	uni-assist – Country information	uni-assist	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	anabin	KMK	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	Niedersächsisches Studienkolleg	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	Recognition in Germany – Assessment of higher education qualifications	Federal Government – Recognition in Germany	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
11	ZAB – Fees	KMK / ZAB	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
12	uni-assist – Handling fees	uni-assist	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
13	uni-assist.de	uni-assist	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
14	zab.kmk.org	KMK / ZAB	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

2. Before You Arrive — Visa, Proof of Finances and Preparation

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1. Purpose

This page lists what must be done **before you travel** to Hannover: visa, proof of financial resources, insurance, accommodation and enrolment documents. Mistakes or delays at this stage are hard to fix later.

2. Who needs this?

- 🌍 **What you need depends on your citizenship:**

Your citizenship	Visa before travelling?	Where to read more
EU / EEA	No — ID card or passport is enough	59. EU, EEA and Swiss citizens
Switzerland	No visa; residence permit after arrival	59. EU, EEA and Swiss citizens
Australia, Canada, Israel, Japan, New Zealand, South Korea, United Kingdom, USA (and for study only: Andorra, Brazil, El Salvador, Honduras, Monaco, San Marino)	No — residence permit applied for in Germany within 90 days	60. Visa-free nationalities
All other countries	**Yes — national visa (type D)**	61. Visa-required countries & APS

- **All students:** accommodation, health insurance and enrolment documents.

3. Steps

1. **Get a national visa (type D), not a Schengen visa (type C).** Only a type D visa can be converted into a residence permit for stays over 90 days; ask for multiple entry (LUH – Entry and Residence). A tourist visa does not allow you to enrol and cannot be converted.

2. If you do not yet have an unconditional admission, or must first attend a language course or Studienkolleg, there is a **visa for prospective students** (residence for up to 9 months to find a study place) (LUH – Entry and Residence).
3. **Find your German mission** (embassy or consulate) and its rules. Waiting times for appointments vary from a few days to many months depending on the country, and many missions use an external service provider (e.g. VFS Global or TLScontact) or the online **Consular Services Portal**. Apply only to the mission responsible for your place of residence (Federal Foreign Office – German missions abroad; Federal Foreign Office – Visa Navigator; Consular Services Portal). 🌍 Book your appointment as soon as you have your admission letter — or earlier if your mission runs a waiting list.
4. **Proof of financial resources.** Most students use a **blocked account (Sperrkonto)**; alternatives are a scholarship or a formal obligation letter (Verpflichtungserklärung) from someone living in Germany. Only an official confirmation showing the total amount and the monthly payout is accepted (Federal Foreign Office (German Embassy Managua) – Blocked account). For 2026 the German missions ask for **€992 per month, i.e. €11,904 per year** for regular study (German missions in Italy – Visa news). Applicants for the 9-month prospective-student residence may be asked for more (one mission lists €1,091/month) (German Embassy San José – Merkblatt Studium (PDF)). ⚠️ The amount is reviewed regularly — confirm it on your mission's website before transferring money.
5. **Health insurance.** Non-EU students need insurance for their whole stay (usually travel/incoming insurance for the first days). After enrolment, students can join statutory health insurance at the student rate (LUH – Entry and Residence). → 7. Health insurance
6. **Accommodation:** start searching as early as possible. → 4. Finding accommodation
7. **Personal liability insurance (Haftpflichtversicherung)** is strongly recommended (LUH – Entry and Residence).
8. Prepare your **enrolment documents** (originals, translations, admission letter). → 12. Admission and enrolment
9. Use the personal roadmap **EasyStartLUH** (LUH – Entry and Residence).
10. **Bring with you:** passport (valid well beyond your first year), originals and certified copies of your certificates, biometric photos, an international or translated driving licence if you plan to drive, prescriptions for regular medication (in English), and enough money (or a card that works abroad) for the first weeks — rent deposit and first rent are often due before your blocked account pays out. ℹ️ General advice; see 3. Arrival.

Related pages: 1. Applying and uni-assist, 11. Family, 62. Sanctions and payment restrictions

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
National visa (type D)	Required (visa-required nationalities)	Visa fee usually €75	LUH
Admission letter	Required	Stating programme and start semester	LUH
Proof of finances (blocked account, scholarship or Verpflichtungserklärung)	Required (non-EU)	€992/month = €11,904/year in 2026	German missions in Italy
Scholarship below the monthly amount	Possible	The gap must be covered, e.g. with a blocked account	Federal Foreign Office
APS certificate	Required (China, India, Vietnam)	Before the visa application	61. Visa-required countries & APS

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Travel or health insurance	Required	For the whole stay	LUH
Personal liability insurance	Possible (recommended)	—	LUH

> Blocked-account providers are private companies. The Federal Foreign Office does not recommend any provider. Compare fees and check that your mission accepts the provider before paying. If your country is affected by sanctions or banking restrictions, read 62. Sanctions and payment restrictions first.

5. Responsible office

- **Visa:** the German embassy or consulate responsible for your place of residence — list of German missions
- **University:** Hochschulbüro für Internationales – Welcome Centre (International Office), Welfengarten 1A, 30167 Hannover, building 1106, room 034 · incoming-student@uni-hannover.de · +49 511 762 188 99 (LUH)

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Entry and Residence	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Federal Foreign Office – German missions abroad	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Federal Foreign Office – Visa Navigator	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Consular Services Portal	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	Federal Foreign Office (German Embassy Managua) – Blocked account	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	German missions in Italy – Visa news	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	German Embassy San José – Merkblatt Studium (PDF)	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	EasyStartLUH	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	LUH	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

3. Arriving in Hannover and Getting Around in the First Days

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 1 — Arriving in Hannover & First Steps · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

How to get from the airport or station to your accommodation and the university, and which ticket to use in your first days.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** newcomers — especially those who arrive before the semester starts, i.e. before the semester ticket is valid.

3. Steps

1. **From Hannover Airport (HAJ):** the **S5** suburban train runs every 30 minutes and takes about 17–20 minutes to Hannover Hauptbahnhof (central station); the station is below Terminal C (Hannover Airport – Transport & Directions).
2. **Fare zone:** the airport is in **zone B** of the GVH network (ÜSTRA – Tickets and subscriptions). ⚠️ Check the current single-ticket price on the ÜSTRA site or at the ticket machine; ÜSTRA service line +49 511 1668-0.
3. **Arriving via Frankfurt, Hamburg, Berlin or another hub?** Long-distance ICE/IC trains reach Hannover Hbf directly; book with Deutsche Bahn (Deutsche Bahn). ℹ️ Saver fares are cheaper when booked early.
4. **The semester ticket (Deutschlandsemesterticket)** becomes valid on the first day of the semester: 1 October (winter) or 1 April (summer) (AStA – Semester ticket). If you arrive earlier, buy a separate ticket. → 30. Public transport
5. **University:** the main building (Welfenschloss) is at Welfengarten 1, 30167 Hannover (LUH – ServiceCenter). Directions: LUH – How to get here. → 14. Campus and buildings
6. Find buildings with the **Standortfinder** (LUH – Study checklist).
7. **No room yet?** Studentenwerk lists temporary options such as Jugendherberge Hannover (youth hostel), Naturfreundehaus and Bed'nBudget (Studentenwerk – Housing search). → 4. Finding accommodation
8. **First-week checklist:** register your address, open a bank account, finish enrolment and health insurance. → 54. Checklist

9. **Cash at the airport:** if you arrive from a country outside the EU carrying **€10,000 or more** in cash (or equivalent), you must **declare it in writing** to customs. There is no upper limit, and the declaration is free (Zoll – Cash). ℹ️ Keep the customs receipt — banks usually ask where large cash deposits come from. → 6. Bank account

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
GVH single ticket	Possible	Only before the semester ticket is valid; airport in zone B	ÜSTRA
Deutschlandsemesterticket	Required (part of the semester fee)	€226.80 of the winter 2026/27 semester fee	LUH – Re-registration
Temporary accommodation	Possible	Hostel etc.	Studentenwerk
Cash declaration to customs	Possible	Only for €10,000 or more when entering from outside the EU; free	Zoll

5. Responsible office

- **Public transport:** Großraum-Verkehr Hannover (GVH) / ÜSTRA — uestra.de; service line +49 511 1668-0
- **Semester ticket:** AStA Hannover, Welfengarten 2c, 30167 Hannover · semesterticket@asta-hannover.de (AStA)

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Hannover Airport – Transport & Directions	Hannover Airport	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	ÜSTRA – Tickets and subscriptions	ÜSTRA / GVH	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Deutsche Bahn	int.bahn.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	AStA – Semester ticket	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – ServiceCenter	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	LUH – How to get here	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Standortfinder	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	Studentenwerk – Housing search	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	Zoll – Cash	German Customs	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
11	LUH – Re-registration	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
12	uestra.de	ÜSTRA / GVH	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

4. Finding Accommodation and Signing a Rental Contract

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 1 — Arriving in Hannover & First Steps · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Finding a room in Hannover is hard, especially at the start of the semester. This page summarises official and common ways to find a room, typical costs and what to check in a rental contract.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** new students.
- Studentenwerk halls of residence are only for students enrolled at a Hannover university (LUH – Housing).

3. Steps

1. **Studentenwerk halls:** 20 halls, mostly furnished, often with fast and cheap internet; rent including utilities is usually €240–500 per month (LUH – Housing). Waiting lists are very long at the start of the semester — apply early (Studentenwerk – Housing search).
2. **Private student residences:** about €500–700 per month, e.g. Student One, THE FIZZ, i Live, Imvio and C5 (LUH – Housing).
3. **Room in a shared flat (WG):** common and a little more expensive than a hall; kitchen and bathroom are shared. Sources: Studentenwerk's online housing exchange and wg-gesucht.de (Studentenwerk; LUH).
4. **Sublets (Zwischenmiete):** furnished rooms for a limited time — a good option for the first weeks (LUH).
5. **Notice boards (Schwarzes Brett)** in the main building, canteens, libraries and institutes, and housing ads in Hannover newspapers on Wednesdays and Saturdays (LUH).
6. **Outside Hannover:** Studentenwerk suggests also searching in towns on S-Bahn lines within about 50 km, e.g. Nienburg, Hameln, Peine, Celle and Hildesheim — the semester ticket covers the trains (Studentenwerk).
7. **The International Office accommodation service** is only for exchange students, doctoral candidates and researchers, and is not guaranteed (LUH).
8. **Before signing,** make sure the landlord will give you a **landlord's confirmation (Wohnungsgeberbestätigung)**; without it you cannot register your address (LUH). → 5. Registering your

address

9. **Deposit (Kaution):** at most three months' rent excluding utilities; tenants may pay it in three monthly instalments, the first at the start of the tenancy (§ 551 BGB).
10. **Discrimination:** refusing a tenant because of ethnic origin is unlawful under the General Equal Treatment Act. If it happens to you, the Federal Anti-Discrimination Agency offers free advice (Federal Anti-Discrimination Agency – Housing).
11. **Tenant advice:** AStA offers free legal advice for students; tenants' associations (Mieterverein) offer advice for members (AStA Hannover). → 24. AStA
12. **Ads that say "no Anmeldung possible":** the most common housing problem students report. By law the landlord or main tenant must confirm your move-in **within two weeks** (§ 19 BMG), and you must register within two weeks (§ 17 BMG); breaking either rule is an administrative offence with a fine of up to €1,000 (§ 54 BMG). Without registration you get no Meldebescheinigung, and the bank account, residence permit and tax ID are all delayed. → 5. Registering your address
13. **Never buy an "address for registration":** offering or selling an address to someone who does not actually live there is prohibited and can be fined up to €50,000 (§ 19 (6) BMG; § 54 BMG).
14. **Practical strategy:** accept a room without Anmeldung only for the first few weeks and keep looking for one with registration at the same time.
15. **Renting from a tenant (Untermiete):** a tenant may only sublet a room or flat to you **with the landlord's permission** (§ 540 BGB). Ask to see that permission and whether you can register. → 67. Consumer rights and free legal help

> **Rental scams:** never send money before you have seen the room and signed a proper contract. If someone asks for a deposit or first rent before a viewing, or the landlord is "abroad" and only reachable remotely, it is very likely a scam. If you have already paid, report it to the police immediately and ask your bank to stop the transfer (Police information sheet via KIT (PDF, German)).

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Studentenwerk hall rent	—	€240–500 incl. utilities	LUH
Private residence rent	—	€500–700	LUH
Enrolment certificate	Required (Studentenwerk halls)	—	LUH
Deposit (Kaution)	Possible	Max. 3 months' basic rent; payable in 3 instalments	§ 551 BGB
Wohnungsgeberbestätigung	Required	From the landlord	City of Hannover form (PDF)

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Studentenwerk Hannover – Wohnheimverwaltung (halls of residence administration)
- **Address:** Jägerstraße 5, 30167 Hannover
- **Contact:** wohnen@studentenwerk-hannover.de · 0511 76-88069 / 76-88029 / 76-88972
- **Source:** Studentenwerk – Housing search

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Housing	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Studentenwerk – Housing search	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	§ 551 BGB	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
4	Federal Anti-Discrimination Agency – Housing	Federal Anti-Discrimination Agency	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	AStA Hannover	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	§ 19 (6) BMG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	§ 17 BMG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
8	§ 54 BMG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
9	§ 540 BGB	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	Police information sheet via KIT (PDF, German)	intl.kit.edu — unofficial / secondary source	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
11	City of Hannover form (PDF)	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **Studentenwerk waiting lists (2024–2026):** students reported waiting from several months to a year. What helped most: besides applying in the portal, e-mail the **caretaker or manager of each hall separately** and explain your situation; ask the Welcome Centre for its list of private residences; and spend the first weeks in a sublet (Zwischenmiete). Signing a hall contract usually required the enrolment certificate or proof of the semester-fee payment.
- **Rooms fill up before each semester** (March and September); most sublet offers were 1–6 months in halls near the main building.
- **First nights:** students without a room booked a hostel or used Studentenwerk's temporary options for the first nights. → 3. Arriving in Hannover
- **€100 "reservation fee" without a contract:** a common scam pattern — don't pay before you have a written contract and have seen the room.

5. Registering Your Address — Anmeldung / Bürgeramt

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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1. Purpose

Everyone who moves into a flat or room in Germany must officially register their address (Anmeldung). Without the registration certificate (Meldebescheinigung) the next steps — bank account, tax ID, library card and residence permit — are not possible (Studentenwerk Hannover – First steps; LUH – Study checklist).

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students living in the city or region of Hannover — **regardless of nationality**, including EU citizens.
- You must register again every time you move (Studentenwerk Hannover).

3. Steps

1. **Deadline:** within **two weeks** of moving in (hannover.gov.de – Registering a flat).
2. **Get the landlord's confirmation (Wohnungsgeberbestätigung)** from your landlord or main tenant, printed and signed. **A rental contract is not accepted instead** (hannover.gov.de). Official city form: PDF.
3. **Book an appointment.** All citizens' offices (Bürgerämter) in the city of Hannover work by appointment only, and city residents may go to any of them (hannover.de – Bürgeramt Aegi). Booking: termin.hannover.gov.de/buergeramt. ℹ️ New slots are often released early in the morning; check daily.
4. **University group appointment:** each semester the International Office arranges a group appointment for new international students at Bürgeramt Aegidientorplatz; a request does not guarantee a place (LUH – Appointment request Bürgeramt). ℹ️ For winter 2026/27 the request deadline was 1 October and the group appointment 13 October 2026; check the same page for the next semester.
5. **Online registration** has been possible since 2025, but currently not for holders of an electronic residence permit (eAT) (hannover.gov.de – Electronic registration). 🌍 It needs an ID card or eAT with online function — most first-time arrivals from outside the EU therefore register in person.
6. If you live in the **Hannover region** outside the city (e.g. Garbsen), go to that town's Bürgeramt or Einwohnermeldeamt (LUH; Studentenwerk).

7. **Religion** on the form is optional, but depending on what you declare, **church tax (Kirchensteuer)** may later be deducted from your salary (LUH – Entry and Residence).
8. **Name spelling:** make sure your name is written exactly as in your passport — this avoids problems later with the bank, tax office and residence permit. ℹ️ General advice.
9. Keep the certificate; you need it for the bank and the TIB library card (LUH – Study checklist). → 6. Bank account
10. **Your landlord has a duty too:** the landlord (Wohnungsgeber) must confirm your move-in in writing or electronically within two weeks (§ 19 BMG). Not issuing the confirmation, or not registering on time, is an offence with a fine of up to €1,000 (§ 54 BMG). → 4. Finding accommodation

Related pages: 47. Leaving Germany

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Passport or national ID card	Required	—	LUH
Wohnungsgeberbestätigung	Required	Printed and signed; a rental contract is not enough	hannover.gov.de
Marriage certificate	Possible	Only if married; may need a translation	LUH
Registration fee	—	Free	hannover.gov.de
Separate Meldebescheinigung	Possible	€7.50 (simple) or €9 (extended)	hannover.gov.de – Meldebescheinigung

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Bürgeramt Aegi (formerly Mitte), Landeshauptstadt Hannover — one of the city's citizens' offices
- **Address:** Aegidientorplatz 1, 30159 Hannover
- **Contact:** +49 511 168-32000 · buergeramt-aegi@hannover-stadt.de
- **Source:** hannover.de
- **Group appointment at the university:** International Office, Welfengarten 1A, 30167 Hannover, building 1106, room 029 · +49 511 762 3693 (LUH)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Studentenwerk Hannover – First steps	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	hannover.gov.de – Registering a flat	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	PDF	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
5	hannover.de – Bürgeramt Aegi	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	termin.hannover.gov.de/buergeramt	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	LUH – Appointment request Bürgeramt	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	hannover.gov.de – Electronic registration	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	LUH – Entry and Residence	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	§ 19 BMG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
11	§ 54 BMG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
12	hannover.gov.de – Meldebescheinigung	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **Order that worked for the first weeks (2024):** 1. Bürgeramt with the Wohnungsgeberbestätigung and passport; 2. bank appointment with the registration certificate, enrolment certificate and passport; 3. residence-permit application to the Ausländerbehörde with PDFs of the same documents and your visa. → 10. Residence permit

6. Opening a Bank Account — Sparkasse and Other Banks

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1. Purpose

Regular payments in Germany — semester fee, rent, phone bills — are usually made by bank transfer or direct debit, so a German current account (Girokonto) is almost essential (Studentenwerk Hannover – First steps). The monthly payout from a blocked account is also paid into this account.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students, especially non-EU students with a blocked account.
- 🌍 EU students can legally use an account from any SEPA country (IBAN discrimination is not allowed), but a German account is often still more practical (European Commission – Your Europe: Bank accounts).

3. Steps

1. **Register your address first** — the registration certificate is needed to open an account (Studentenwerk). → 5. Registering your address
2. According to the university, some banks also ask for your **tax ID (Steuer-ID)** (LUH – Entry and Residence). ℹ️ Each bank's list of documents differs; ask before you go.
3. **Right to a basic account:** everyone legally resident in the EU — including people without a fixed address, asylum seekers and people with a tolerated stay — has the right to a **basic payment account (Basiskonto)** (Payment Accounts Act § 31 ZKG; BaFin). The bank must offer you the contract **within ten business days** of receiving your complete application. Apply in writing and keep a receipt; if a bank refuses you, ask for the refusal in writing and contact BaFin. ℹ️ Students often found that one branch refused while another branch or bank accepted them.
4. Many banks and Sparkassen offer **free accounts for students**. If the account is free only for students, show an **enrolment certificate** — and a new one **every semester** (Studentenwerk).
5. **Online banks** can be opened by video identification and often work in English. ℹ️ Check that your passport/nationality is accepted for video-ident and that the bank issues a German IBAN (DE...).

6. A debit card (**Girocard**, also called EC card) is useful — some shops and canteens accept only Girocard or cash (Studentenwerk).
7. Pay the semester fee from a German account; international transfers cost fees and are slow (Studentenwerk). → 13. Semester fee and LeibnizCard
8. 🌍 **Sanctioned countries:** some banks run extra checks for nationals or residents of countries under EU sanctions. → 62. Sanctions and payment restrictions
9. **Blocked account for extending your residence permit:** use the amount and form that the Ausländerbehörde's own checklist asks for, not what others tell you. → 10. Residence permit
10. **Cash:** if you bring €10,000 or more in cash from outside the EU, declare it to customs and keep the receipt; banks usually ask where large cash deposits come from (Zoll – Cash). → 3. Arriving in Hannover

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Passport	Required	—	Studentenwerk
Admission letter / enrolment certificate	Required	—	Studentenwerk
Registration certificate	Required	—	Studentenwerk
Steuer-ID	Possible	Depends on the bank	LUH
Monthly account fee	Possible	Depends on the bank	Studentenwerk

5. Responsible office

- **Your chosen bank** (e.g. Sparkasse Hannover). This handbook does not recommend any bank.
- **Complaints about refusal of a basic account:** Bundesanstalt für Finanzdienstleistungsaufsicht (BaFin) — bafin.de
- **General guidance:** Studentenwerk Hannover, Jägerstraße 5, 30167 Hannover · info@studentenwerk-hannover.de

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Studentenwerk Hannover – First steps	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	European Commission – Your Europe: Bank accounts	European Union	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	LUH – Entry and Residence	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Payment Accounts Act § 31 ZKG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
5	bafin.de	BaFin	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
6	Zoll – Cash	German Customs	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **Branches differ a lot:** some opened an account the same day; others asked for the enrolment certificate or Steuer-ID, or sent the documents to head office for review. Several students who were refused opened an account at another branch or bank. ℹ️ This handbook does not recommend any bank.
- **Fees:** monthly account fees and card fees at the same bank were reported differently depending on age and account type — ask for the price list (Preis- und Leistungsverzeichnis) before signing.
- **Moving to another city:** Sparkassen are local; students usually opened a new account in the new city and closed the old one.
- **Online banking from abroad:** some German banking apps did not work from certain countries without a VPN; test access before travelling home.

7. Health Insurance — Krankenversicherung

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1. Purpose

You cannot enrol at the university without health insurance, and proof of insurance is also needed for the residence permit (Studentenwerk Hannover – First steps).

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students.
- 🌍 **EU/EEA and Swiss students** with statutory insurance at home can use the **European Health Insurance Card (EHIC)**; the German insurer then confirms the exemption to the university. For longer stays German insurance can still be useful (LUH – Entry and Residence).
- 🌍 **Countries with a social security agreement:** students insured at home in some non-EU countries (e.g. Türkiye, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Montenegro, North Macedonia, Serbia, Tunisia) may be able to use their home insurance with a certificate from their insurer. Check with the German statutory insurer before you arrive (DVKA – Social security agreements). ⚠️ Coverage depends on the specific agreement.
- 🌍 **All other non-EU students** need insurance for their whole stay; enrolled full-time students can join statutory insurance at the student rate (LUH – Entry and Residence).
- The student rate in statutory insurance is generally available until the end of the semester in which you turn 30 (gesetzlichekrankenkassen.de — unofficial source).

3. Steps

1. Choose a statutory health insurer (gesetzliche Krankenkasse). Studentenwerk names these insurers with offices in Hannover: AOK, BARMER, DAK, KKH and TK (Studentenwerk). All statutory insurers cover essentially the same benefits by law; they differ mainly in the additional contribution and service (e.g. English-language support).
2. Ask the insurer to send the **electronic insurance notification (M10)** directly to the university (Studentenwerk; LUH – Enrolment).
3. **Private insurance or exemption:** if you choose private insurance, you must apply to a statutory insurer for exemption within three months of enrolment, and the exemption is **irrevocable for your whole studies** (§ 8 SGB V). The private policy must meet the requirements of § 11 (1)–(3) SGB V for the residence permit (LUH – Entry and Residence).
4. Enrolled students are automatically covered by **statutory accident insurance** for university activities (LUH – Entry and Residence).
5. After joining, always carry your insurance card and show it at the doctor and pharmacy. → 33. Doctors and pharmacies
6. **Turning 30:** compulsory student insurance runs **at most until your 30th birthday**; it continues longer only if the type of studies or family or personal reasons justify it (§ 5 (1) no. 9 SGB V). Ask your insurer a few months before your 30th birthday what your options are afterwards and what they cost — students ask this question again and again.
7. **Read cheap private policies carefully:** before signing, check the limit for dental treatment, the deductible (your own share) and cover for non-urgent treatment. → 33. Doctors and pharmacies

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
M10 notification	Required	Sent by the insurer directly to the university	Studentenwerk
Basic student contribution 2026	Required	€87.38 per month	TK
Additional contribution (Zusatzbeitrag)	Required	Differs by insurer, e.g. TK €23	TK
Long-term care insurance (Pflegeversicherung)	Required	Under 23 and childless €30.78; 23+ and childless €35.91	AOK
Approximate monthly total	—	About €146–151 (BARMER example)	BARMER
Travel or private insurance before enrolment	Possible	Non-EU students	LUH

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** your chosen health insurer; each insurer's Hannover offices are on its website (Studentenwerk).
- **Insurance information at the university:** LUH – Health insurance
- **Social security agreements:** Deutsche Verbindungsstelle Krankenversicherung – Ausland (DVKA) — dvka.de

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Studentenwerk Hannover – First steps	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – Entry and Residence	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	DVKA – Social security agreements	DVKA (GKV-Spitzenverband)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	gesetzlichekrankenkassen.de	gesetzlichekrankenkassen.de — unofficial / secondary source	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – Enrolment	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	§ 8 SGB V	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
7	§ 5 (1) no. 9 SGB V	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
8	TK	Techniker Krankenkasse	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	AOK	AOK	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	BARMER	BARMER	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
11	LUH – Health insurance	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

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- **Cheap private insurance:** students who arrived with low-cost private insurance reported that dental costs were refunded only up to a small yearly limit and that specialist visits without a referral were sometimes not covered. You pay the bills yourself and send them in for reimbursement.
- **Supplementary dental insurance** only covers problems that start **after** the policy begins — take it out before your first dental check-up. Implants and bridges are usually not covered by statutory insurance.
- **Sick days at work:** your employer pays your wages for sick days (with a doctor's certificate), not your health insurer — whether statutory or private. → 33

8. SIM Card, Internet and Staying Connected

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 1 — Arriving in Hannover & First Steps · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

A German phone number and internet are needed in the first days for appointments, the bank, university e-mail and contacting your landlord. This page covers **SIM cards and internet for the first days**; long-term contracts are in 32. Internet, mobile and service contracts.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** newcomers.
- 🌍 **EU/EEA SIM cards** work in Germany without roaming charges under "roam like at home" — but only for periodic travel; operators may charge extra if you live in Germany permanently (Your Europe – Roaming).

3. Steps

1. **Prepaid SIM cards** are sold in shops and online; your identity must be verified before activation (§ 172 TKG).
2. **ID check is mandatory:** the operator must verify your name, address and date of birth with an ID document before activation. Allowed methods (in person, PostIdent or video identification) are set by the Bundesnetzagentur (Bundesnetzagentur – ID procedures for prepaid). ℹ️ Some video-ident systems do not accept every passport; in-shop activation is the fallback.
3. **University internet:** connect to **LUH-WLAN** (or **eduroam**, which also works at universities worldwide) with your LUH-ID; it is available in almost all buildings and on campus (LUH – Study checklist). → 17. Online systems
4. Many Studentenwerk halls have fast and cheap internet (LUH – Housing).
5. Some mobile providers offer **student discounts** on presentation of an enrolment certificate (LUH – Study checklist).
6. **Free Wi-Fi in town:** many trains, stations and cafés offer Wi-Fi. ℹ️ Use a VPN or avoid banking on open networks.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Passport for ID check	Required	To activate the SIM	Bundesnetzagentur
Enrolment certificate	Possible	For student discounts	LUH
SIM and data plan	—	Depends on provider	—

5. Responsible office

- **University internet:** Leibniz Universität IT Services (LUIS) — luis.uni-hannover.de
- **Mobile operator:** your choice; this handbook does not recommend any operator.
- **Regulator:** Bundesnetzagentur — Bundesnetzagentur – consumer information

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Your Europe – Roaming	European Union	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	§ 172 TKG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
3	Bundesnetzagentur – ID procedures for prepaid	Federal Network Agency	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – Housing	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	luis.uni-hannover.de	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Bundesnetzagentur – consumer information	Federal Network Agency	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

9. Tax ID (Steuer-ID) and Official Letters

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 1 — Arriving in Hannover & First Steps · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

After registering your address, two important letters usually arrive: your **tax identification number (Steuerliche Identifikationsnummer, Steuer-ID)**, needed for any job, and a letter about the **broadcasting fee (Rundfunkbeitrag)**. This page explains what to do with each.

2. Who needs this?

- **Steuer-ID:** everyone registering an address in Germany for the first time — especially anyone with a student job. Nationality does not matter.
- **Rundfunkbeitrag:** paid once per dwelling (Wohnung), not per person.

3. Steps

Tax ID (Steuer-ID)

1. After your first registration, the registration office passes your data to the **Federal Central Tax Office (BZSt)**, which sends your number **automatically** by post to your registered address — you do not need to apply (BZSt – Tax identification number).
2. According to the university, the letter arrives in about two to three weeks (LUH – Entry and Residence). ℹ️ Put your full name on your letterbox so the post can be delivered.
3. If it has not arrived **three months** after registration, send a copy of your ID and your registration certificate to the BZSt (BZSt – FAQ). The number is only sent by post to the registered address.
4. Keep the letter; employers and sometimes banks ask for it (LUH – Entry and Residence). → 40. Student jobs

Broadcasting fee (Rundfunkbeitrag)

1. The fee is **€18.36 per month per dwelling**, not per person (Rundfunkbeitrag – Students).
2. **Shared flat (WG):** only one adult resident must register and pay; residents decide among themselves who (Rundfunkbeitrag – Students). Others register as "already covered" with the payer's contribution number.

3. **Halls of residence:** a room entered from a common corridor counts as its own dwelling and pays separately — even with a shared bathroom or kitchen (Rundfunkbeitrag – Students).
4. **Exemption:** BAföG recipients not living with their parents can apply for exemption (betanet — unofficial source). 🌍 BAföG usually does not cover international students, with exceptions (e.g. EU citizens with long residence, refugees) (LUH – Study checklist). → 43. Scholarships and funding
5. English information: Rundfunkbeitrag – Students and apprentices.
6. **Do not ignore it:** unpaid fees are collected with reminders and can end in enforcement. Register (or deregister when you leave) online. ℹ️

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Steuer-ID	—	Free; sent automatically after registration	BZSt
Rundfunkbeitrag	Required (per dwelling)	€18.36 per month	Rundfunkbeitrag
BAföG notice for exemption	Possible	BAföG recipients only	betanet

5. Responsible office

- **Steuer-ID:** Bundeszentralamt für Steuern (BZSt), Federal Central Tax Office — postal address: Bundeszentralamt für Steuern, Referat St II 7, 11055 Berlin (BZSt – FAQ)
- **Rundfunkbeitrag:** ARD ZDF Deutschlandradio Beitragsservice — rundfunkbeitrag.de

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	BZSt – Tax identification number	Federal Central Tax Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – Entry and Residence	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	BZSt – FAQ	Federal Central Tax Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Rundfunkbeitrag – Students	ARD ZDF Deutschlandradio Beitragsservice	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	betanet	betanet.de — unofficial / secondary source	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Rundfunkbeitrag – Students and apprentices	ARD ZDF Deutschlandradio Beitragsservice	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	rundfunkbeitrag.de	ARD ZDF Deutschlandradio Beitragsservice	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

10. Residence Permit — Aufenthaltserlaubnis for Non-EU Students

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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This page is general information, not legal advice. Residence rules change; always check with the foreigners' authority (Ausländerbehörde) before acting.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 1 — Arriving in Hannover & First Steps · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

An entry visa is limited in time. To stay for your studies you need a **residence permit for study purposes** (§ 16b AufenthG), issued as an **electronic residence permit card (eAT)** (Studentenwerk Hannover – First steps).

2. Who needs this?

- 🌍 **Non-EU students** staying longer than 90 days — both those who entered with a visa and those from visa-free countries (Australia, Canada, Israel, Japan, New Zealand, South Korea, UK, USA and others) (LUH – Entry and Residence; § 41 AufenthV). → 60. Visa-free nationalities
- 🌍 **EU/EEA citizens** do not need one. **Swiss citizens** must apply for a (free-movement) residence permit for stays over 90 days (LUH – Entry and Residence). → 59. EU, EEA and Swiss citizens
- 🌍 Students with a study permit from **another EU country** may be able to study in Germany for up to 360 days under the EU mobility scheme without a German permit (LUH – Entry and Residence).
- 🌍 Refugees and people with temporary protection (e.g. from Ukraine) keep their existing status → 63. Refugees and people with protection status.

3. Steps

1. **When to apply:** within your first 90 days or **before your visa expires**, whichever is earlier. Apply early; delays are likely (LUH – Entry and Residence).
2. **Which office?** Residents of the **city of Hannover** go to the city's Ausländerbehörde (Landeshauptstadt Hannover); residents of the **Hannover region** (e.g. Garbsen) go to the Ausländerbehörde der Region Hannover (LUH; Studentenwerk).

3. **Online application (city of Hannover):** most applications are submitted through the city's online portal; no visit is needed at this stage (hannover.de – Service for skilled workers, students and self-employed). Portal: Issue or extension of a residence permit.
    - **Finding the form:** in the portal enter your postcode, then choose "Aufenthaltserlaubnis für Studium, Ausbildung oder Schulbesuch" and "Aufenthaltserlaubnis zum Zwecke des Studiums oder für studienvorbereitende Maßnahmen". Choose **"Ersterteilung"** for your first permit and **"Verlängerung"** for an extension; for an extension also enter your **Aktenzeichen** (file number from your last letter) and upload the documents (City of Hannover – Residence permit for study, online application).
    - **No online access?** According to the office's checklist you can send the documents by e-mail to abh-fus@hannover-stadt.de (subject: "Antrag für Aufenthaltserlaubnis") or by post (checklist "Studium / Studienvorbereitung", City of Hannover, 2025 — PDF).
    - **Language:** documents and information must in principle be provided in German (City of Hannover).
    - **Processing time:** up to **3 months** once all documents have arrived (City of Hannover). The office recommends applying **at least 3 months before** your visa or permit expires (Willkommensservice presentation for students, 2025 — PDF).
    - **Length of the permit:** usually issued and extended for **two years**, at least one year; shorter only if your programme is shorter (§ 16b AufenthG).
    - **Your duty to cooperate:** you must provide the required documents without delay (§ 82 AufenthG); false or incomplete information can lead to revocation, a fine or expulsion (City of Hannover).
4. The office reviews the application and, if approved, contacts you for an **appointment** to give fingerprints and later collect the card; this step is in person (hannover.de).
5. **If processing takes long:** if you apply for issue or extension **before your current permit or visa expires**, your stay remains lawful until the decision and you receive a **fictional certificate (Fiktionsbescheinigung)** (§ 81 AufenthG). This does not apply to Schengen visas. ℹ️ Keep proof that you applied (confirmation e-mail or PDF).
6. **Extension from the 4th semester on:** current transcripts from the examinations office and a statement from your faculty about your study progress are required (Studentenwerk).
7. **Travel:** with a valid eAT you can travel in the Schengen area for up to 90 days in any 180. → 39. Travelling in Europe
8. **Working** on a student residence permit is limited. → 40. Student jobs
9. **After graduation** you can get a residence permit to **look for work for up to 18 months**. → 46. After graduation
10. **Free advice:** the university holds information events on immigration law for students (LUH – Events); the Refugee Law Clinic Hannover also advises migrants (hannover.de – Refugee Law Clinic at the Faculty of Law (2020 report)).

Related pages: 19. Leave, change of programme and withdrawal, 39. Travelling in Europe, 46. After graduation

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Passport	Required	—	Studentenwerk
Recent biometric photo	Required	—	Studentenwerk
Rental contract / registration	Required	—	Studentenwerk

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Enrolment certificate	Required	—	Studentenwerk
Proof of health insurance	Required	—	Studentenwerk
Proof of finances	Required	One of: **blocked account (Sperrkonto)** releasing €992/month (on the city's own form; €11,904 for 12 months or €5,952 for 6 months), a scholarship letter stating amount and duration, a valid Verpflichtungserklärung, or an employment contract with the last three payslips	City of Hannover; German missions in Italy
Copy of your current permit or visa	Required	—	City of Hannover
Language course or Studienkolleg certificate	Possible	Only for preparatory measures: Studienkolleg or a language course of at least 18 hours per week	City of Hannover
Issue fee	Required	€100 under the current AufenthV. ℹ️ The city's service page still states €75 (extension €70) and exempts holders of German scholarships; the final amount is in your invitation letter.	§ 45 AufenthV; City of Hannover
Extension fee	Possible	€93 (more than 3 months); change of purpose €98	§ 45 AufenthV
Fast-track processing	Possible	€35 extra	§ 45a AufenthV
Transcripts and faculty statement	Possible	Only for extensions from the 4th semester	Studentenwerk

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Landeshauptstadt Hannover – Sachgebiet Willkommensservice (Kundenservice für Fachkräfte, Studierende und Selbstständige) — welcome service of the city's foreigners' authority
- **Address:** HannoverServiceCenter am Schützenplatz, Am Schützenplatz 1, 30169 Hannover
- **Contact:** phone +49 511 168-32330; Mon, Tue, Wed and Fri 08:00–12:00, Thu 13:00–17:00; U-Bahn stop Waterloo (lines 3, 7, 9) (City of Hannover). E-mail in the office's checklist: abh-fus@hannover-stadt.de. Contact form in the online portal
- **Residents of the Hannover region:** Ausländerbehörde der Region Hannover – Appointments & contact
- **Help at the university:** Welcome Centre, incoming-student@uni-hannover.de · +49 511 762 188 99 (LUH)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Studentenwerk Hannover – First steps	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
2	LUH – Entry and Residence	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	§ 41 AufenthV	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	hannover.de – Service for skilled workers, students and self-employed	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	Issue or extension of a residence permit	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	City of Hannover – Residence permit for study, online application	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	§ 16b AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	§ 82 AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	§ 81 AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	LUH – Events	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
11	hannover.de – Refugee Law Clinic at the Faculty of Law (2020 report)	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
12	German missions in Italy	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
13	§ 45 AufenthV	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
14	§ 45a AufenthV	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
15	Ausländerbehörde der Region Hannover – Appointments & contact	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
16	LUH	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **Online extension (2025–2026):** the International Office prepared a step-by-step guide with screenshots for online extensions under §16b and §18b. Common mistakes: forgetting the Aktenzeichen, and not uploading the transcript (Leistungsnachweis) from the 4th semester on.
- **Online information session:** each semester, during orientation week, the Ausländerbehörde holds an information session for new international students (e.g. 26.03.2025). Attending answers many questions.

- **Slow replies to e-mails and online applications** — from a few days to several months. When their permit was about to expire, many students went **in person, early in the morning**, during opening hours and received a temporary certificate or Fiktionsbescheinigung the same day.
- **Fiktionsbescheinigung for urgent travel:** bring proof of the reason (e.g. ticket or employer's letter). Some reported that the Fiktion invoice already included an advance on the card fee.
- **Photos:** in 2025 and 2026 the invitation letter said to take the biometric photo in the building before the appointment, or to bring a digital photo from an approved photographer.
- **Collecting the card:** the new card was usually handed over in person and the old one taken back. If you hear nothing by the announced date, follow up in person.
- **Financial proof:** whether an employment contract was accepted instead of a blocked account — especially for a **first** application — varied from case to case. Rely only on the official checklist.
- **Passport validity:** if your passport expires before the end of the permit you are applying for, renew it first.
→ 66. Documents, translations and certified copies

11. Family — Bringing Your Spouse and Children (Familiennachzug)

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This page is general information, not legal advice. Whether your family can join you depends on your residence status and nationality; check with the German mission or the Ausländerbehörde before acting.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 1 — Arriving in Hannover & First Steps · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

How your spouse or partner and children can join you in Germany (Familiennachzug), what is required, and where to find support for studying with children.

2. Who needs this?

- 🌍 **Non-EU students** who are married or have children and want their family with them.
- 🌍 **EU/EEA citizens:** family members (including non-EU family members) have free-movement rights; non-EU family members may need an entry visa, which is issued free of charge and quickly (Make it in Germany – Family reunification).

3. Steps

1. **General requirements for a non-EU spouse:** usually adequate health insurance, sufficient money to support the family and enough living space; both spouses must be at least 18 (Make it in Germany – Spouses joining non-EU citizens).
2. **German language for the spouse:** as a basic rule, the law requires the spouse to communicate in German at a basic level (A1) (§ 30 (1) AufenthG). There are exceptions — e.g. for spouses of citizens of the visa-free countries in § 41 AufenthV and for spouses of skilled workers (Make it in Germany). ⚠️ The law has no specific exception for spouses of **students**; ask the German mission whether A1 is required in your case.
3. **Financial proof for the family:** expect to show more money than the single-student amount (rent plus the family's living costs). ⚠️ Ask the mission for the amount it applies.

4. **Children:** requirements depend on the child's age and the family situation (Make it in Germany – Family reunification).
5. **Visa application:** family members apply at the German mission responsible for their place of residence. 🌍 In some countries missions have long waiting lists or limited capacity for family reunification, or work through partners such as IOM; check your mission's website early (Federal Foreign Office – German missions abroad).
6. **Documents from your country** (marriage and birth certificates) may need an apostille or legalisation and a certified translation. 🌍 Which one depends on the issuing country — ask the German mission in that country (Federal Foreign Office – German missions abroad). ⚠️
7. **After arrival:** family members must register their address and get a residence permit before their visa expires; book the Ausländerbehörde appointment early (Make it in Germany). → 5. Registering your address, 10. Residence permit
8. **Work for spouses:** spouses who join a student generally may work. ⚠️ Check the conditions noted on their residence permit.
9. **Childcare and school:** children aged 1+ have a legal right to a childcare place; school is compulsory from about age 6 (Make it in Germany – Childcare; Make it in Germany – School system). Child benefit (Kindergeld) may be available depending on your status (Federal Employment Agency – Child benefit).
10. **Studying with children at LUH:** the family service of the Office for Equal Opportunities and Diversity advises students with children (LUH – Studying with a child). → 27. ChancenVielfalt
11. **Inviting family for a short visit (Schengen visitor visa):** a host living in Hannover can sign a **formal obligation letter (Verpflichtungserklärung)** covering the guest's living costs, including medical treatment. Conditions: you live in Hannover, are at least 18, hold a residence permit valid for the whole visit, have sufficient income (last three payslips) and receive no social benefits. The fee is **€29** (also if your income turns out to be insufficient), processing takes about four to five weeks, and the obligation applies for **five years** from the guest's entry. Apply online or by appointment at the Ausländerbehörde (City of Hannover – Verpflichtungserklärung). ⚠️ If the guest uses public funds, the host must pay them back.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Passport	Required	—	Make it in Germany
Marriage or birth certificate	Required	Possibly with apostille/legalisation and translation	Make it in Germany
Proof of finances and health insurance for the family	Required	—	Make it in Germany
Spouse's basic German certificate (A1)	Possible	⚠️ Ask the mission	§ 30 AufenthG
Visa fee	Required (non-EU family of non-EU students)	Usually €75 per adult, €37.50 per minor	German Embassy San José – Student visa information (PDF)
Rental contract, payslips etc.	Possible	For the residence permit after arrival	Make it in Germany
Verpflichtungserklärung for visitors	Possible	€29; host needs payslips and a valid residence permit	City of Hannover

5. Responsible office

- **Visa:** the German mission responsible for your family's place of residence
- **Residence permit after arrival:** Ausländerbehörde → 10. Residence permit
- **Family service at LUH:** Hochschulbüro für ChancenVielfalt — chancenvielfalt.uni-hannover.de

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Make it in Germany – Family reunification	Federal Government – Make it in Germany	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Make it in Germany – Spouses joining non-EU citizens	Federal Government – Make it in Germany	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	§ 30 (1) AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Make it in Germany – Family reunification	Federal Government – Make it in Germany	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	Federal Foreign Office – German missions abroad	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	Make it in Germany – Childcare	Federal Government – Make it in Germany	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Make it in Germany – School system	Federal Government – Make it in Germany	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	Federal Employment Agency – Child benefit	Federal Employment Agency	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	LUH – Studying with a child	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	City of Hannover – Verpflichtungserklärung	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
11	German Embassy San José – Student visa information (PDF)	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
12	chancenvielfalt.uni-hannover.de	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

Section 2 — Starting Your Studies at Leibniz University Hannover

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From enrolment to exams, leave and changing programme: what you need to study at Leibniz University Hannover (LUH).

Pages in this section

- 12. Admission and enrolment — accepting your offer, enrolment documents and the applicant portal
- 13. Semester fee and LeibnizCard — semester fee, re-registration and your student card
- 14. Campuses and buildings — campuses, building numbers, maps and the library
- 15. Faculties and institutes — the nine faculties and subject advisors
- 16. Programme structure and timetable — examination regulations, ECTS, course catalogue
- 17. University systems — IdM, Stud.IP, QIS, Wi-Fi and RIDE
- 18. Exams and study support — exam registration, academic integrity and the examinations office
- 19. Leave, change of programme and withdrawal — Beurlaubung, Studiengangwechsel and Exmatrikulation
- 20. Fachschaft — your programme's student council

12. Admission and Enrolment — Zulassung & Immatrikulation

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 2 — Starting Your Studies · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Admission (Zulassung) does not yet make you a student; you only become a member of the university after **enrolment (Immatrikulation / Einschreibung)** (LUH – Enrolment). This page explains the steps and documents.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** newly admitted students; 🌍 non-EU students submit more documents.
- **Before applying:** non-EU applicants with a foreign school certificate need a VPD from **uni-assist**. Bachelor's applicants with foreign certificates need German at **B1** to apply and **C1** to enrol, unless the programme regulations say otherwise (LUH – Language requirements). → 1. Applying and uni-assist

3. Steps

1. **Know your programme type:** in programmes with **restricted admission (zulassungsbeschränkt)** you receive an admission letter (Zulassungsbescheid) and must accept it by the stated deadline. In programmes with **open admission (zulassungsfrei)** there is no admission letter and you enrol directly (LUH – Enrolment).
2. **Deadlines** are in your admission letter. Admission letters for the winter semester are sent from August, for the summer semester from February (LUH – Enrolment).
3. In the **applicant portal**, open the "Einschreibung" tab; forms and the upload link are there (LUH – Enrolment).
4. 🌍 **Non-EU students:** scan all documents, combine them into **one PDF** named "SURNAME Firstname(s)_Applicantnumber.pdf" and upload it via the portal (LUH – Enrolment).
5. **Pay the semester fee;** you are only enrolled once the **full amount** has arrived. For transfers from abroad, allow for bank charges (LUH – Enrolment). → 13. Semester fee and LeibnizCard
6. Ask your health insurer to send the **electronic insurance notification** to the university, and upload a **photo** for your student card at photo.idm.uni-hannover.de (LUH – Enrolment). → 7. Health insurance

7. **Conditional admission:** if you have provisional admission (vorläufige Zulassung), you must meet its conditions (e.g. language certificate) by the deadline in your letter, otherwise your enrolment is cancelled (LUH – Study checklist).
8. **Visa delays:** if your visa will not arrive in time, contact the admissions office and the International Office **before** the enrolment deadline — some programmes allow a later start or deferral. ⚠️ Rules vary by programme; ask in writing.
9. **After enrolment:** in September (winter) or March (summer) your enrolment documents and LeibnizCard arrive by post, together with an invitation to the welcome event (LUH – Enrolment).

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Signed acceptance form (Annahmeformular)	Required (non-EU)	From the applicant portal	LUH
Signed data form (Erhebungsbogen)	Required (non-EU)	With the admission letter or from the portal	LUH
Proof of health insurance	Required	—	LUH
Proof of semester fee payment	Required	€453.16 for winter 2026/27	LUH – Re-registration
Language certificate	Possible	If requested in your admission letter	LUH
Valid visa / residence title	Required (visa-required nationalities)	—	LUH
Passport	Required	—	LUH
Photo (upload)	Required	—	LUH
School-leaving / university entrance certificate	Required (open-admission programmes)	PDF scan	LUH

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Immatrikulationsamt (Admissions and Enrolment Office) in the LUH ServiceCenter
- **Address:** Welfengarten 1, 30167 Hannover (building 1101)
- **Contact:** service line +49 511 762 2020 · studium@uni-hannover.de
- **Source:** LUH – Enrolment; ServiceCenter

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Enrolment	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – Language requirements	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	photo.idm.uni-hannover.de	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
4	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – Re-registration	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	ServiceCenter	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

13. Semester Fee and Your Student Card (LeibnizCard)

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1. Purpose

Every semester you must pay the **semester fee (Semesterbeitrag)** to renew your enrolment (Rückmeldung); otherwise you are de-registered under Lower Saxony's Higher Education Act (LUH – Re-registration). The **LeibnizCard** is your student ID, library card, sports card, canteen payment card and locker key in one (LUH – Study checklist).

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students, every semester.
- 🌍 **No tuition fees** for regular degree students in Lower Saxony — the same for EU and non-EU students. Only the semester fee (and, after a long study period, the long-term fee below) applies (LUH – Study costs).

3. Steps

1. **First semester:** use the payment reference (Verwendungszweck) stated in your admission letter (LUH – Re-registration).
2. **Later semesters:** log in to the portal with your IdM username and check "My Account Balance" for the amount and reference (LUH – Re-registration).
3. Transfer the full amount to: Stiftung Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz Universität Hannover · IBAN: DE51 2505 0000 0151 8129 06 · BIC: NOLADE2HXXX (LUH – Re-registration).
4. **Payment reference for winter 2026/27:** for 7-digit matriculation numbers "26200" + number + "7"; for 8-digit numbers "2620" + number + "7" (LUH – Re-registration). ℹ️ The prefix changes every semester.
5. It can take up to a week for the payment status to show "Cleared" (LUH – Re-registration).
6. **Upload your photo** before enrolment at photo.idm.uni-hannover.de. The LeibnizCard arrives by post from mid-September (winter) or March (summer), together with your LUH-ID and initial password (LUH – Study checklist).
7. The card is pre-validated for the first semester; from the second semester you must **re-validate** it at the validation terminals (LUH – Study checklist).

8. Print your **enrolment certificate (Immatrikulationsbescheinigung)** from the QIS portal (LUH – Study checklist).
9. Get your **semester ticket (Deutschlandsemesterticket)** through the RIDE portal with your Stud.IP login (AStA – Semester ticket). → 30. Public transport
10. **Financial hardship?** AStA can refund the semester-ticket part in social hardship cases, and Studentenwerk/LUH offer emergency aid (AStA – Semester ticket). → 29. Counselling, 43. Scholarships ⚠️ Check conditions and deadlines.

Related pages: 19. Leave, change of programme and withdrawal

4. Documents and costs

Semester fee winter 2026/27: €453.16 (LUH – Re-registration)

Component	Amount (€)
Studentenwerk	130.00
Deutschlandsemesterticket	226.80
Student body (Studierendenschaft)	15.80
Bicycle workshop	1.11
Administrative fee	75.00
Kulturticket (State Theatre and Opera)	2.00
Semester-ticket hardship fund	2.20
Literarischer Salon	0.25

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Semester fee	Required	Every semester; re-registration deadline for winter 2026/27 was 18 July 2026	LUH
Photo for the card	Required	Before enrolment	LUH
Long-term study fee (Langzeitstudiengebühr)	Possible	€500 per semester once your "study credit" (Studienguthaben) is used up — usually after 12 semesters for a Bachelor's. Leave semesters, care for children under 14 and care for relatives do not count; part-time study €250. Different calculation for Master's students with a foreign Bachelor's.	LUH – Study costs

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** LUH ServiceCenter (card replacement and IdM password reset)
- **Address:** Welfengarten 1, 30167 Hannover (main building, building 1101)
- **Contact:** +49 511 762 2020 · studium@uni-hannover.de
- **Source:** ServiceCenter

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Re-registration	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	LUH – Study costs	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	photo.idm.uni-hannover.de	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	QIS portal	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	AStA – Semester ticket	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	ServiceCenter	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **Deadlines students were reminded of:** summer 2025 by 01.02.2025; winter 2025/26 by 19.07.2025; summer 2026 by 31.01.2026; winter 2026/27 by 18.07.2026. A payment can take up to a week to show as "Cleared" — don't pay on the last day. → 65. Annual student calendar
- **Refunds:** when the semester-ticket price was lowered (January 2025, €41), students had to request the difference themselves in Campusmanagement. Keep your bank details up to date under "Fee management".

14. Getting to Know LUH — Campuses and Buildings

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1. Purpose

LUH is spread across several parts of the city. This page helps you find the main building, lecture halls, library and canteens, and understand building numbers (e.g. 1101).

2. Who needs this?

- **All** new students.

3. Steps

1. **Main campus areas:** Welfengarten (main building), Conti-Campus at Königsworther Platz, Schneiderberg, Herrenhausen (the "green campus" for life, plant and earth sciences at Herrenhäuser Straße 2) and **Campus Maschinenbau Garbsen** for mechanical engineering (LUH – Campus & city; Faculty of Natural Sciences – Campus areas).
2. **Getting to Garbsen:** Stadtbahn line 4 to "Schönebecker Allee", then bus 404 (weekdays) or about 500 m on foot (Faculty of Natural Sciences – Campus areas).
3. **Main building (Welfenschloss):** Welfengarten 1, 30167 Hannover; the ServiceCenter is on floor 01 next to the covered courtyard (Lichthof) (LUH – ServiceCenter). → 21. ServiceCenter
4. **Building and room numbers:** every building has a four-digit number (e.g. main building 1101, International Office 1106). Building details: info.cafm.uni-hannover.de (LUH – Enrolment). ℹ️ Room "F 102" in building 1101 is often written "1101 – F102".
5. **Map:** use the Standortfinder (LUH – ServiceCenter).
6. **Explore the campus:** join the "Campus-Rallye" during orientation week (O-Woche) (LUH – Study checklist).
7. **Library:** the university library is the **TIB**. Your LeibnizCard is your library card, but it must be **activated** at the library information desk with your passport and registration certificate (LUH – Study checklist). Online pre-registration: TIB Reader Registration.
8. **Accessibility:** for step-free access and building accessibility, ask the advisory service for students with disabilities. → 27. ChancenVielfalt

9. Canteens on each campus → 28. Mensa

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
LeibnizCard	Required	For library, canteen and sports	LUH
Passport and registration certificate	Required	To activate the library card	LUH
Cost	—	None	—

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** LUH ServiceCenter
- **Address:** Welfengarten 1, 30167 Hannover
- **Contact:** +49 511 762 2020 · studium@uni-hannover.de · Mon–Fri 10:00–14:00
- **Source:** LUH – ServiceCenter

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Campus & city	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Faculty of Natural Sciences – Campus areas	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	LUH – ServiceCenter	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	info.cafm.uni-hannover.de	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – Enrolment	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	Standortfinder	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	TIB Reader Registration	TIB – Leibniz Information Centre	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

15. Faculties, Institutes and Departments — Fakultäten & Institute

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1. Purpose

For subject advice, exams and regulations you need to know which **faculty (Fakultät)** and **institute (Institut)** your programme belongs to. If you don't know your faculty, ask the Central Student Advisory Service (LUH – Study checklist).

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students.

3. Steps

1. **The nine faculties** of LUH (LUH – Faculties):
   - Fakultät für Architektur und Landschaft — Architecture and Landscape Sciences
   - Fakultät für Bauingenieurwesen und Geodäsie — Civil Engineering and Geodetic Science
   - Fakultät für Elektrotechnik und Informatik — Electrical Engineering and Computer Science
   - Fakultät für Maschinenbau — Mechanical Engineering
   - Fakultät für Mathematik und Physik — Mathematics and Physics
   - Naturwissenschaftliche Fakultät — Natural Sciences
   - Juristische Fakultät — Law
   - Philosophische Fakultät — Humanities
   - Wirtschaftswissenschaftliche Fakultät — Economics and Management
2. Besides the faculties there are three **schools**: QUEST Leibniz Research School, Leibniz School of Education and Leibniz School of Optics and Photonics (LUH – Research in the faculties).
3. On your faculty's website, find the **subject advisor (Fachstudienberatung)** and the **programme coordinator (Studiengangskoordination)** (LUH – Study checklist). Many English-taught Master's programmes have a dedicated coordinator for international students.

4. **Institutes** are smaller units within a faculty that run courses and research; you usually contact them for student assistant jobs (HiWi) and your thesis. ℹ️ General explanation. → 40. Student jobs

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
—	—	Overview page; no documents or costs.	—

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** your programme's faculty (list at Faculties)
- **If you don't know your faculty:** Zentrale Studienberatung (ZSB, Central Student Advisory Service) — studienberatung@uni-hannover.de · +49 511 762 5580 (LUH – ServiceCenter)

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – Faculties	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	LUH – Research in the faculties	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	LUH – ServiceCenter	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

16. Programme Structure, Choosing Courses and Your Timetable

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1. Purpose

In Germany you usually do not receive a ready-made timetable; you choose your courses yourself according to the **examination regulations (Prüfungsordnung)** and build your weekly schedule (LUH – Study checklist). For many international students this is the biggest difference from their home system.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students, especially in the first semester.

3. Steps

1. **Download and save** your programme's examination and internship regulations, as they may change (LUH – Study checklist). Where to find them: Exam information & subject advice.
2. Check which modules are compulsory (Pflichtmodul) and which are electives (Wahlmodul), and how many **ECTS** credits each carries. One ECTS credit corresponds to about 25–30 hours of work; a full-time semester is about 30 ECTS. ℹ️ General explanation.
3. **Course types:** Vorlesung (lecture), Übung (exercise/tutorial), Seminar (discussion, often with a presentation or paper), Praktikum/Labor (lab). Attendance is often not checked in lectures but is required in seminars and labs. ℹ️
4. Find courses in the **online course catalogue**, published from 1 September (winter) and 1 March (summer): Course catalogue (LUH – Study checklist).
5. Some courses require **registration in Stud.IP** (LUH – Study checklist). → 17. Online systems
6. **"c.t." and "s.t.":** a lecture at "10 c.t." starts at 10:15 (academic quarter); "s.t." means sharp. ℹ️
7. Your first-semester timetable is usually put together during **orientation week (O-Woche)** with help from senior students (LUH – Study checklist). → 20. Fachschaft

8. **Preparatory courses (Vorkurse)**, especially in engineering and science, are optional but strongly recommended (LUH – Study checklist).
9. **Recognition of previous credits:** if you studied elsewhere, ask your examinations office about crediting modules (Anerkennung) early. ⚠️ Rules vary by programme.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Examination regulations	Required	Saved copy	LUH
Stud.IP account	Required	With your LUH-ID	LUH
Cost	—	None	—

5. Responsible office

- **Subject advisor (Fachstudienberatung):** on your faculty's website — list of advisors
- **Your programme's Fachschaft:** senior students → 20. Fachschaft
- **Central Student Advisory Service:** studienberatung@uni-hannover.de · +49 511 762 5580 (LUH – ServiceCenter)

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Exam information & subject advice	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Course catalogue	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	LUH – ServiceCenter	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

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- No experiences added yet.

17. University Systems, E-mail and Learning Platforms

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1. Purpose

The university has several online systems whose names confuse newcomers. This page explains what each one is for and how to log in.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students.

3. Steps

1. Your **LUH-ID and initial password** arrive by post with the LeibnizCard; keep them safe (LUH – Study checklist).
2. **IdM (identity management):** the central login for activating and managing your Wi-Fi, cloud storage and learning-platform accounts. Log in the first time with your LUH-ID and initial password (LUH – Study checklist; activation guide).
3. **University e-mail:** official messages (exam changes, fees, deadlines) go to your university address. Check it regularly or forward it. ℹ️
4. **LUH-WLAN / eduroam:** wireless internet in almost all buildings (LUH – Study checklist). IT services: LUIS.
5. **Stud.IP:** online courses, files and contact with lecturers; registration for some courses and language courses happens here (LUH – Study checklist).
6. **QIS portal:** enrolment certificate, semester-fee status, course list and exam registration (LUH – Study checklist; LUH – Re-registration).
7. **RIDE:** get your semester ticket with your Stud.IP login (AStA – Semester ticket).
8. **LUH study-start app:** website content, the "Noch Fragen?" brochure, preparatory courses, canteen menus and more (LUH – Mobile app).
9. **Forgot your password?** Student assistants at the Infothek in the ServiceCenter can reset it (LUH – Study checklist). → 21. ServiceCenter

10. **Software and VPN:** students get free or discounted software and a VPN for off-campus access to licensed resources through LUIS. ℹ️
11. Full list of digital tools: Online services.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
LUH-ID and initial password	Required	With the LeibnizCard	LUH
Passport or LeibnizCard	Possible	For an in-person password reset	LUH
Cost	—	None	—

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Leibniz Universität IT Services (LUIS) — luis.uni-hannover.de
- **In-person help:** Infothek in the ServiceCenter, Welfengarten 1, 30167 Hannover (LUH – ServiceCenter)

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	activation guide	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	luis.uni-hannover.de	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	LUH – Re-registration	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	AStA – Semester ticket	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	LUH – Mobile app	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Online services	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	LUH – ServiceCenter	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

18. Exams, Academic Rules and Study Support

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 2 — Starting Your Studies · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

In Germany you must **register for exams yourself, within a fixed period**. Missing the registration deadline can have serious consequences (LUH – Study checklist).

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students.
- 🌍 **Non-EU students:** study progress is also checked when you extend your residence permit (Studentenwerk – First steps). → 10. Residence permit

3. Steps

1. Find **exam registration periods** and the responsible contacts at Exam information & subject advice (LUH – Study checklist).
2. Read your examination regulations: how many attempts are allowed, how to withdraw, etc. ℹ️ Rules differ between programmes; your programme's regulations apply. Failing the final attempt of a compulsory module can end your studies in that programme — get advice before your last attempt.
3. Exam registration is usually done in the QIS portal. ℹ️ Some programmes use another procedure; ask your examinations office.
4. **Academic integrity:** plagiarism and unauthorised use of AI tools are treated as cheating. Citation conventions may differ from your home country — learn them early (ZQS and the TIB offer courses). ℹ️
5. **Time management and exam anxiety:** "Lernwerkstatt" workshops at ZQS (LUH – ZQS) and free psychological counselling at ptb (ptb). → 25. ZQS, 29. Counselling
6. **Disadvantage compensation (Nachteilsausgleich):** students with a disability or chronic illness can apply for adjusted exam conditions (e.g. extra time). → 27. ChancenVielfalt
7. Get the **transcripts** needed for extending your residence permit from the examinations office (Studentenwerk).

8. **Know the registration periods in advance:** in recent years QIS exam registration usually ran **15–31 May** (summer semester) and **mid to 30 November** (winter semester); the second exam period has its own registration. Check the exact dates every semester in QIS and on your faculty's site. → 65. Annual student calendar

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Exam registration within the period	Required	—	LUH
Medical certificate for missing an exam	Possible	ℹ️ Conditions are in your regulations	Exam information
Cost	—	None	—

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Akademisches Prüfungsamt (SG 62 – Examinations Office), via the ServiceCenter desk
- **Address:** ServiceCenter, Welfengarten 1, 30167 Hannover
- **Contact:** +49 511 762 2020 · studium@uni-hannover.de
- **Source:** LUH – ServiceCenter; SG 62

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Studentenwerk – First steps	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Exam information & subject advice	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	LUH – ZQS	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	ptb	ptb – psychological counselling	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	LUH – ServiceCenter	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	SG 62	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **Errors during registration (university e-mail, May 2026):** if QIS shows an error, e-mail your faculty's examinations contact **straight away** (even at the weekend) and include your phone number — that way the problem is recorded within the deadline. Late registration is not accepted, so don't leave it to the last days.
- **Deadline reminders** were the most frequent study-related notice in student group chats.

19. Leave of Absence, Changing Programme and Withdrawal

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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🌍 For non-EU students, a leave of absence, a change of programme or withdrawal can affect your residence permit. Talk to the Ausländerbehörde and the International Office before acting. This page is not legal advice.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 2 — Starting Your Studies · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Sometimes studies don't go to plan: illness, a semester abroad, changing interests or deciding to stop. This page explains the three official options: leave of absence (Beurlaubung), change of programme (Studiengangwechsel) and de-registration (Exmatrikulation).

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students facing problems or changes — especially non-EU students.

3. Steps

Leave of absence (Beurlaubung)

1. **A reason is required:** e.g. illness, a semester abroad, pregnancy or other personal reasons, with proof (e.g. a medical certificate) (LUH – Leave of absence).
2. **When to apply:** at re-registration (Rückmeldung) and at the latest by the last day of the lecture period; in exceptional cases up to one month after the semester starts. Send the "Beurlaubungsbogen" form and proof as one PDF to Studierendenverwaltung@uni-hannover.de (LUH – Leave of absence).
3. **Limits:** usually at most **two consecutive semesters** per programme and at most **four semesters** in total; up to six for childcare. Leave is only for full semesters and usually **not possible in your first semester** (exception: a semester abroad in an integrated Master's with written approval of the faculty's dean of studies) (LUH Enrolment Regulations – § 9 (PDF)).
4. **Effects:** during leave you cannot attend courses or take exams; the leave semester counts as a university semester but not as a subject semester. **The semester fee still has to be paid**, unless the fee regulations say otherwise (LUH Enrolment Regulations – § 9; LUH – Leave of absence). → 13. Semester fee

5. 🌍 **Residence permit:** a leave semester (e.g. for illness) is normally compatible with a student permit, but you may not be allowed to work full-time during it. ⚠️ Inform the Ausländerbehörde.

Change of programme (Studiengangwechsel)

1. You must **apply again within the normal deadlines** for the new programme; you remain enrolled in the old one until admitted to the new one (LUH – Change of programme).
2. 🌍 **Residence:** a study permit is issued for a specific programme, and the Ausländerbehörde must be told about a change. § 16b AufenthG does not regulate a change of programme explicitly; it only says the permit is extended if the study purpose can still be achieved within a reasonable time (§ 16b (2) AufenthG). ⚠️ Ask the Ausländerbehörde before you switch. → 10. Residence permit

De-registration (Exmatrikulation)

1. You can apply in writing at any time; send the signed form to Studierendenverwaltung@uni-hannover.de. De-registration is not retroactive; if you apply within one month of the start of lectures, the semester fee is refunded (LUH – De-registration).
2. 🌍 **Residence after withdrawal:** a study permit depends on enrolment; talk to the Ausländerbehörde before de-registering. Options may include vocational training, a job or a new programme. → 10. Residence permit, 46. After graduation
3. **Struggling at the start?** The university's page on difficult study starts: Studien(fehl)start. Advice → 29. Counselling

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Beurlaubungsbogen form and proof	Required (leave)	—	LUH
Semester fee during leave	Required	Leave does not cancel the fee	§ 9 Enrolment Regulations
New application within normal deadlines	Required (change of programme)	—	LUH
Exmatrikulation form	Required (de-registration)	—	LUH

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Immatrikulationsamt / Studierendenverwaltung, Leibniz University Hannover
- **Contact:** Studierendenverwaltung@uni-hannover.de · ServiceCenter → 21. ServiceCenter

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Leave of absence	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH Enrolment Regulations – § 9 (PDF)	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	LUH – Change of programme	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	§ 16b (2) AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
5	LUH – De-registration	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	Studien(fehl)start	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

20. Your Programme's Student Council — Fachschaft / Fachrat

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 2 — Starting Your Studies · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

The **Fachschaft** (subject student council) is made up of senior students in your programme and answers questions about your subject (LUH – Study checklist). It is usually the first and friendliest place to ask.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students, especially in the first semester. International students are welcome — many Fachschaften also run events in English.

3. Steps

1. Find your Fachschaft or Fachrat in the list of Fachschaften and Fachräte (LUH – Study checklist).
2. Join your programme's orientation events (O-Woche); every programme has one (LUH – Study checklist). ℹ️ These are often organised with the Fachschaft.
3. Visit the Fachschaft's office hours with questions about the curriculum, exams and experience with courses; many also collect old exams for practice. ℹ️
4. You can become an active member or representative; Fachschaft councils (Fachschaftsräte) are elected — international students can vote and stand for election. → 52. Student representation

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
—	—	Free of charge.	—

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** your programme's Fachschaft / Fachrat — list

- **Umbrella body:** AStA Hannover, Welfengarten 2c, 30167 Hannover · info@asta-hannover.de (AStA – International students)

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	list of Fachschaften and Fachräte	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	AStA – International students	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

Section 3 — University Services & Student Support

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-10-24 · Back to the handbook contents

Which university office or student body to go to for which problem.

Pages in this section

- 21. ServiceCenter — first stop for academic and administrative matters
- 22. International Office — Welcome Centre and services for international students
- 23. Studentenwerk — halls, canteens and social counselling
- 24. AStA — advice for international students and the semester ticket
- 25. ZQS — study methods, key skills and Career Service
- 26. Leibniz Language Centre — language courses, placement tests and DSH
- 27. ChancenVielfalt — equal opportunities, discrimination, disability and studying with children
- 28. Mensa — canteens, topping up your card, prices and dietary labels
- 29. Counselling — academic, psychological, social and financial counselling

21. The University ServiceCenter

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 3 — University Services · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

The **ServiceCenter** is the first point of contact for most academic and administrative questions: enrolment, exams, student card, passwords and referral to advisors (LUH – ServiceCenter). If you don't know where to go, start here.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students.

3. Steps

1. **Reception (Empfang):** handing in and collecting documents that are not sent digitally, replacing your LeibnizCard and general guidance (LUH – ServiceCenter).
2. **Infothek:** student assistants for basic information, applications, online services and password resets (LUH – ServiceCenter).
3. **Offices reachable through the desk:** Central Student Advisory Service (ZSB), Admissions Office, Examinations Office, International Office, Studentenwerk and ZQS (LUH – ServiceCenter).
4. **ZQS office hours at the Infothek:** learning advice Thursdays 13:00–14:00; Career Service Mondays 13:00–14:00 (LUH – ServiceCenter). → 25. ZQS
5. **ServiceCenter or International Office?** General academic and administrative matters → ServiceCenter; visa, residence and settling in as an international student → 22. International Office.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
LeibnizCard or passport	Possible	For personal matters such as passwords or cards	LUH
Cost	—	Free	—

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** ServiceCenter der Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz Universität Hannover
- **Address:** Welfengarten 1, 30167 Hannover; main building (Welfenschloss), floor 01, next to the Lichthof
- **Opening hours:** Mon–Fri 10:00–14:00
- **Contact:** service line +49 511 762 2020 · studium@uni-hannover.de · student advice: studienberatung@uni-hannover.de, +49 511 762 5580 (Mon–Fri 9:00–16:00)
- **Source:** LUH – ServiceCenter

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – ServiceCenter	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

22. International Office — Hochschulbüro für Internationales / Welcome Centre

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 3 — University Services · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

The **International Office (Hochschulbüro für Internationales)** and its **Welcome Centre** help international students with entry, residence, housing, orientation programmes and emergency financial aid (LUH – International first-semester students).

2. Who needs this?

- **International students** of every nationality (EU and non-EU), exchange students, doctoral candidates and visiting researchers.

3. Steps

1. **With or without an appointment:** come during office hours or book an in-person or online appointment by e-mail or phone (LUH – International Office).
2. **Orientation programmes:** Orientation Days for international students, Start Smart and STEPin for Master's students (LUH). → 51. Events and networking
3. **Study-Buddy and Senior Student Partnership:** programmes that pair you with a student who already knows Hannover (LUH – International students). → 48. Programmes for international students at LUH
4. **Group appointment for address registration** → 5. Registering your address
5. **Financial aid:** emergency aid (Notfall-Beihilfe) and degree-completion aid (Studienabschlussbeihilfe) for international students (LUH – Financial aid for international students). → 43. Scholarships and funding
6. **Refugees and students from crisis regions:** a dedicated contact advises refugees and prospective students with a refugee background (LUH – Information for refugees). → 63. Refugees and people with protection status
7. **Events on immigration law** for studying and working are held regularly (LUH – Events).
8. Follow the office on Instagram for current events and deadlines.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Passport or residence permit	Possible	Depending on the topic	—
Cost	—	Advice is free	—

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Hochschulbüro für Internationales – Welcome Centre (International Office)
- **Address:** Welfengarten 1A, 30167 Hannover, building 1106, room 034
- **Office hours (from 1 September 2026):** Mon, Tue and Thu 10:00–12:00 and 14:00–16:00; Wed 10:00–14:00; Fri 10:00–12:00 (LUH – International Office)
- **Contact:** incoming-student@uni-hannover.de · welcome-centre@zuv.uni-hannover.de · +49 511 762 188 99 (LUH)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – International first-semester students	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – International Office	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Start Smart	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	STEPin	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – International students	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	LUH – Financial aid for international students	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	LUH – Information for refugees	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	LUH – Events	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	Instagram	instagram.com	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

23. Student Services — Studentenwerk Hannover

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1. Purpose

Studentenwerk Hannover is an organisation independent of the university that runs halls of residence, canteens, social counselling and BAföG. Part of your semester fee (€130) goes to it (LUH – Re-registration).

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students at Hannover's universities.

3. Steps

1. **Halls of residence:** 20 halls, online application (LUH – Housing). → 4. Finding accommodation
2. **Canteens:** Mensa and cafés, paid with the LeibnizCard. → 28. Mensa
3. **BAföG and social counselling:** BAföG, allowances, loans, scholarships and insurance; German only (LUH – Study checklist). Book social counselling: stwh-portal.de (Studentenwerk – Housing search). ℹ️ Bring a German-speaking friend if needed.
4. **Guide for international students:** First Steps in Germany.
5. **Saving money:** list of student discounts at Save money (LUH – Study checklist). → 31. Shopping

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Studentenwerk contribution	Required	€130 per semester, part of the semester fee	LUH
Enrolment certificate	Possible	For halls and some services	LUH – Housing

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Studentenwerk Hannover (Anstalt des öffentlichen Rechts — public-law institution)
- **Address:** Jägerstraße 5, 30167 Hannover

- **Contact:** info@studentenwerk-hannover.de · halls: wohnen@studentenwerk-hannover.de
- **Source:** Studentenwerk

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Re-registration	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – Housing	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	stwh-portal.de	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	Studentenwerk – Housing search	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	First Steps in Germany	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Save money	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

24. General Students' Committee — AStA

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 3 — University Services · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

The **AStA (Allgemeiner Studierendenausschuss)** is the executive committee of the student body. For international students it offers first-level advice on studies, residence permits, student jobs, finances and employment rights, and it runs the semester ticket (AStA – International students; AStA – Semester ticket).

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students; the international department is specifically for international students.

3. Steps

1. **Open advice (Erstberatung & Orientierung):** no appointment needed during office hours; topics: studies, residence permit, student jobs, finances and employment law (AStA).
2. **Referral:** AStA refers you to the right specialist advice centres in Hannover (AStA).
3. **Support for international student groups** and the foreign students' commission (AusländerInnenkommission) (AStA). → 49. International student groups
4. **Financial help:** short-term AStA loans (Darlehen) and the subsidised canteen meal card (Mensafreitisch) (LUH – Financial aid for international students). → 43. Scholarships and funding
5. **Semester ticket:** for ticket problems e-mail semesterticket@asta-hannover.de (AStA – Semester ticket). → 30. Public transport
6. The AStA is elected by the **Student Council (Studentischer Rat)**. → 52. Student representation

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Student body contribution	Required	€15.80, part of the semester fee	LUH
Advice	—	Free	AStA

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Allgemeiner Studierendenausschuss (AStA) der Leibniz Universität Hannover
- **Address:** Welfengarten 2c, 30167 Hannover
- **International department office hours:** Mon and Tue 12:00–14:00; Thu 16:00–18:00; or by e-mail appointment
- **Contact:** international@asta-hannover.de (preferred) · info@asta-hannover.de
- **Source:** AStA

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	AStA – International students	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	AStA – Semester ticket	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	LUH – Financial aid for international students	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	LUH	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

25. Centre for Quality in Teaching and Key Competencies — ZQS

> **⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice**
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> **Last reviewed:** 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 3 — University Services · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

The **ZQS** (Zentrale Einrichtung für Qualitätsentwicklung in Studium und Lehre) helps students with **study methods, time and exam management, key skills and career planning** (LUH – ZQS).

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students — especially those adjusting to the German way of studying and examining, or looking for an internship.

3. Steps

1. **Learning support (Lernwerkstatt):** advice and workshops on learning, time management and exams (LUH – ZQS).
2. **Key competencies (Schlüsselkompetenzen):** seminars that earn **ECTS credits** and projects with companies or on sustainability (ZQS – Key competencies). ℹ️ Intercultural-competence and academic-writing courses are especially useful for international students.
3. **Career Service:** career guidance, internships, starting your career and the "Career Dates" job fair (LUH – ZQS). → 45. Career service
4. **Office hours at the Infothek:** learning advice Thursdays 13:00–14:00; Career Service Mondays 13:00–14:00 (LUH – ServiceCenter).

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Registration for a seminar or workshop	Possible	Depends on the programme; questions about credit-bearing seminars: seminare@zqs.uni-hannover.de	ZQS – Team and contact

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Cost	—	⚠️ Not stated in official sources; ask before registering.	—

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Zentrale Einrichtung für Qualitätsentwicklung in Studium und Lehre (ZQS)
- **Address:** Callinstraße 14, 30167 Hannover, building 3428
- **Contact:** office +49 511 762 14150 (ZQS – Team and contact)
- **Source:** LUH – ZQS

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – ZQS	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	ZQS – Key competencies	ZQS, Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	LUH – ServiceCenter	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	ZQS – Team and contact	ZQS, Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

26. University Language Centre — Leibniz Language Centre (LLC)

> **⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice**
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> **Last reviewed:** 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 3 — University Services · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

The **Leibniz Language Centre (LLC)** offers general and specialised language courses, exam preparation, placement tests and writing support in foreign languages (LLC).

2. Who needs this?

- Students learning **German** or preparing for the DSH exam. → 35. Learning German
- Any student who wants English, French, Spanish or other languages.

3. Steps

1. **Languages:** English, French, Spanish, German and others such as Italian and Turkish (LLC).
2. **German:** semester courses (LLC – German courses) and the intensive course "D-intensiv" preparing for the **DSH** (LLC).
3. **Registration only via Stud.IP.** For German, English and Spanish (except A1) you must pass a **placement test** in Stud.IP; TOEFL or DSH certificates are not accepted instead (LLC – Registration).
4. **Registration period:** for winter 2026/27 it ran from 25 September to 16 October 2026, followed by a lottery (LLC – Registration). ℹ️ Check the same page for the next semester.
5. If your placement result does not match your actual level: placement@llc.uni-hannover.de (LLC).
6. **Exams:** DSH, TOEFL and the DAAD language certificate (LLC).
7. **Self-directed learning (SDL)** and **tandem** partnerships — a great way to practise German while teaching your own language (Tandem offers).
8. **InterWRITE:** academic writing support in a foreign language (LLC).

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Placement test	Required (German, English and Spanish above A1)	In Stud.IP	LLC
Course fee	Possible	According to the LLC fee rules: Guidelines for courses and fee regulation	LLC

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Leibniz Language Centre (LLC) der Leibniz Universität Hannover
- **Address:** Im Moore 11B, 30167 Hannover, building 1138
- **Contact:** +49 511 762 4914 · office (room 212): Mon and Wed 10:00–12:00 · placement test: placement@llc.uni-hannover.de
- **Source:** LLC – Contact

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LLC	Leibniz Language Centre	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LLC – German courses	Leibniz Language Centre	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	LLC – Registration	Leibniz Language Centre	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Tandem offers	Leibniz Language Centre	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	Guidelines for courses and fee regulation	Leibniz Language Centre	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	LLC – Contact	Leibniz Language Centre	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

27. Office for Equal Opportunities and Diversity — Hochschulbüro für ChancenVielfalt

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 3 — University Services · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

The **Hochschulbüro für ChancenVielfalt** is the university's central office for equal opportunities and diversity. It advises all students on topics from **family and studying with children** to **experiences of discrimination** — including racism and discrimination based on origin, religion, gender or sexual orientation (ChancenVielfalt – Counselling).

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students — especially those who have experienced discrimination or harassment, student parents, LGBTQIA+ students and students with a disability or chronic illness.

3. Steps

1. Book an appointment by e-mail or phone; advice is available **in person or online** and also **in English** (ChancenVielfalt).
2. **Confidentiality:** nothing is passed on without your consent; **anonymous** reporting via a form is also possible (ChancenVielfalt).
3. **Protection against discrimination:** learn about your rights and options (Protection against discrimination).
4. **A-Team:** a confidential student-to-student contact point for experiences of discrimination (ChancenVielfalt).
5. **Studying with children:** Studying with a child.
6. **Students with disabilities or chronic illness:** the university has a Commissioner for Students with Disabilities, and ChancenVielfalt can refer you (Referral advice). More: Inclusive studies. 🌍 International applicants with a disability can also contact the national information centre at the Deutsches Studierendenwerk (DSW – Studying with disabilities).
7. **Outside the university:** the Federal Anti-Discrimination Agency offers free advice in several languages (Federal Anti-Discrimination Agency).

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
—	—	Advice is free and confidential.	ChancenVielfalt

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Hochschulbüro für ChancenVielfalt der Leibniz Universität Hannover
- **Address:** Wilhelm-Busch-Straße 4, 30167 Hannover, building 1214, room 205
- **Contact:** beratung@chancenvielfalt.uni-hannover.de · 0511 762 5750
- **Source:** ChancenVielfalt – Counselling

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	ChancenVielfalt – Counselling	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Protection against discrimination	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Studying with a child	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Referral advice	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	Inclusive studies	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	DSW – Studying with disabilities	studierendenwerke.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Federal Anti-Discrimination Agency	Federal Anti-Discrimination Agency	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

28. Student Canteens — Mensa

> **⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice**
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1. Purpose

The **Mensa** (student canteen) is the cheapest way to get a hot lunch at university. This page shows where the canteens are, how to pay and how to find food that fits your diet.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students.

3. Steps

1. **Payment:** pay cashless with your LeibnizCard; no separate validation is needed (LUH – Study checklist). Keep the card on the reader until payment is complete (Studentenwerk – Canteen FAQ).
2. **Topping up:** at top-up machines, €5–70 with €5, €10, €20 and €50 notes; in some canteens by bank card. Direct payment by bank card or phone is only possible at Contine, TiHo-Tower and Garbsen (Studentenwerk – Canteen FAQ).
3. **Studentenwerk canteens:** Hauptmensa, Contine, Mensa Garbsen, Mensa Campus Linden, Mensa Herrenhausen, Mensa Blumhardtstraße, Mensa Große Pause and more (Studentenwerk – Canteens).
4. **Cafés:** Café Leibniz in the Hauptmensa, Café-bar in the Contine, Moccabar, Coffee-Shop Appelstraße, Cafeteria Sprengelstube and more (Studentenwerk – Canteens).
5. **Opening times:** Opening times at a glance.
6. **Daily menu** is also in the LUH study-start app (LUH – Study checklist). → 17. Online systems
7. **Dietary needs:** menus mark vegetarian and vegan dishes and list allergens and additives; dishes containing pork or alcohol are labelled. ⚠️ Halal certification is not generally indicated — check the labels or ask staff. → 64. Religion, food and home communities
8. **Help for students on a low income:** AStA's subsidised meal card (Mensafreitisch) (LUH – Financial aid for international students). → 43. Scholarships and funding

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
LeibnizCard	Required	For payment	LUH
"Niedersachsen-Menü"	—	Student price in 2026: €2.50; only with canteen card or LeibnizCard	Studentenwerk
"Pasta & Friends" counter	—	€2	Studentenwerk – 5 Mensa tips
Other dishes	—	Prices on each canteen's menu	Studentenwerk – Canteens

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Studentenwerk Hannover – Hochschulgastronomie
- **Head office:** Jägerstraße 5, 30167 Hannover
- **Contact:** mensen@studentenwerk-hannover.de · 0511 76-88969 (Studentenwerk – Canteen FAQ)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Studentenwerk – Canteen FAQ	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Studentenwerk – Canteens	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Opening times at a glance	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – Financial aid for international students	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	Studentenwerk	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Studentenwerk – 5 Mensa tips	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

29. Academic, Psychological, Social and Financial Counselling

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🩺 Medical disclaimer

This page is **not medical advice, diagnosis or treatment** and does not replace an examination or advice from a doctor, psychotherapist or pharmacist. Make decisions about illness, medicines and treatment only with them. **In an emergency call 112 immediately**; outside surgery hours call 116117. Names of doctors or clinics (where given) come from public registers and are not a recommendation, endorsement or guarantee by ISL.

In an emergency (danger to life or suicidal thoughts) call **112** immediately. The crisis telephone line (TelefonSeelsorge) is free and available 24/7: **0800 111 0 111**, **0800 111 0 222** or **116 123** (TelefonSeelsorge). → 37. Emergency numbers

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 3 — University Services · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

This page lists free counselling for **academic, psychological, social and financial** problems and tells you where to go for each.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students — especially new international students in their first months. Homesickness, loneliness and culture shock are common and nothing to be ashamed of.

3. Steps

1. **Academic advice** (choosing or changing programme, study problems): Zentrale Studienberatung — studienberatung@uni-hannover.de · +49 511 762 5580 (LUH – ServiceCenter).
2. **Psychological counselling (ptb):** free, confidential and anonymous on request; for exam anxiety, learning problems, relationship issues, loneliness with depression or suicidal thoughts, and **adjusting to a new country and culture**. Counselling is also available in English (ptb).

3. **First ptb appointment** is booked by phone (TiHo – ptb). You can fill in the questionnaire and consent form before the first session (ptb).
4. **Psychotherapy outside the university:** with statutory health insurance you can see a psychotherapist without a referral; the appointment service **116 117** helps find an initial consultation (116117 – Appointment service). ℹ️ Therapists who work in your language can be searched for in the Lower Saxony psychotherapists' directory (Psychotherapeutenkammer Niedersachsen – Therapist search).
5. **Social and financial advice:** BAföG and social counselling at Studentenwerk (in German) (LUH – Study checklist). → 23. Studentenwerk
6. **Financial advice for international students:** International Office (emergency aid); the church organisations KED (Protestant) and KHG (Catholic) also offer advice and emergency aid, regardless of religion (LUH – Financial aid for international students). → 43. Scholarships and funding
7. **Residence, work and employment rights:** AStA's open advice (AStA). → 24. AStA
8. **Discrimination and diversity** → 27. ChancenVielfalt
9. **Study methods** → 25. ZQS

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
ptb questionnaire and consent form	Possible	Before the first session	ptb
Cost	—	All counselling on this page is free.	ptb

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Psychologisch-Therapeutische Beratung für Studierende (ptb) — psychological counselling for students
- **Address:** Im Moore 13, 30167 Hannover
- **Contact:** +49 511 762-3799 · info@ptb.uni-hannover.de (MHH – ptb)
- **Current opening hours:** ptb.uni-hannover.de

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	TelefonSeelsorge	TelefonSeelsorge	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – ServiceCenter	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	ptb.uni-hannover.de	ptb – psychological counselling	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	TiHo – ptb	tiho-hannover.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	116117 – Appointment service	Kassenärztliche Bundesvereinigung	2026-11-03	✅ Opened (browser; redirects to 116117-termine.de)

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
6	Psychotherapeutenkammer Niedersachsen – Therapist search	pknds.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	LUH – Financial aid for international students	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	AStA	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	MHH – ptb	mhh.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened (browser)

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **Group support in times of crisis (2025–2026):** when war or communication blackouts hit students' home countries, ptb organised anonymous online workshops at students' request, and the International Office provided rooms for support meetings. If you are not doing well, don't stay alone — contact ptb or TelefonSeelsorge. → 37. Emergency numbers
- **ptb group course "stress management"** (in German, summer semester 2026) was open to students of all Hannover universities, with prior registration.
- **Tell people:** in difficult periods, let your professor or employer know that your concentration is affected — they may not know what is happening in your home country.

Section 4 — Everyday Life in Hannover

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Last reviewed: 2026-10-24 · Back to the handbook contents

Transport, shopping, doctors, waste, leisure, safety, driving and travel in Europe.

Pages in this section

- 30. Public transport and cycling — semester ticket, validity, refunds and bikes
- 31. Shopping and saving money — discounts, Hausmarke, Pfand, opening hours and food from home
- 32. Internet, mobile and service contracts — contract terms, cancellation and consumer protection
- 33. Doctors and pharmacies — doctors, 116117, on-duty pharmacies and medicines from home
- 34. Leisure, sports and culture — university sports, theatre and opera
- 35. Learning German — LLC, tandem, VHS and free online courses
- 36. Waste and house rules — waste separation, bulky waste and quiet hours
- 37. Emergency numbers — emergency numbers, lost documents, embassies and police
- 38. Driving licence — validity of foreign licences and conversion by country
- 39. Travelling in Europe — the 90/180-day Schengen rule

30. Public Transport, Deutschlandticket and Cycling

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 4 — Everyday Life in Hannover · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

With the semester ticket (Deutschlandsemesterticket), paid with your semester fee, you can use almost all local and regional public transport in Germany at no extra cost. This page explains how to get the ticket, where it is valid and what is available for cyclists.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students.

3. Steps

1. **Validity:** all local and regional transport **throughout Germany** — buses, trams (Stadtbahn), S-Bahn and regional trains. **Long-distance trains (IC, ICE, EC) are not included** (AStA – Semester ticket).
2. **On your phone:** log in to the **RIDE** portal with your Stud.IP login (Web-SSO) and download the ticket; it can be added to Apple Wallet or Google Wallet (AStA).
3. **No smartphone:** send the chip-card request form with the subject "Chipkarte" to semesterticket@asta-hannover.de (AStA).
4. **Valid from:** 1 October (winter) and 1 April (summer) (AStA). Always carry ID (passport, ID card or residence card) with the ticket.
5. **"Gesperrt" (blocked) shown during a ticket check:** open the ticket directly in the RIDE portal; the Wallet copy may be outdated. If you were fined, e-mail AStA with the subject "Bescheinigung Semesterticket" (AStA).
6. **Refunds or exemption:** for a stay of more than 120 consecutive days outside the ticket area, or a semester abroad or compulsory internship abroad, apply to AStA with proof (e.g. Learning Agreement) at the latest **one month after lectures start** (AStA – Semester ticket hardship fund rules (PDF); AStA – Semester ticket (English)). ⚠️ The refund form is no longer online; request it from mobilitaet@asta-hannover.de. A hardship fund exists for special cases — for example international students without a work permit or with a

restricted one (AStA – Hardship fund portal). ⚠️ These documents date from 2017–2021; ask mobilitaet@asta-hannover.de for current conditions.

7. **Local transport in Hannover:** the GVH network (trams, buses and S-Bahn) — uestra.de.
8. **Cycling:** Hannover is flat and bike-friendly. AStA runs a bike workshop (Fahrradwerkstatt), funded by a small part of the semester fee (€1.11) (LUH – Re-registration; AStA – Bike workshop). ℹ️ Use lights after dark and lock your bike well — bike theft is common. Cyclists must follow traffic rules; fines apply.
9. **Re-activate every semester:** the ticket is issued anew each semester. From 1 October or 1 April log in to RIDE again and download the new ticket or add it to your Wallet (AStA – Semester ticket). → 65. Annual student calendar
10. **Strikes and diversions:** ÜSTRA and regiobus were on strike several times in 2024–2026, and during construction weeks parts of some lines (e.g. 4 and 5 towards Garbsen) are replaced by buses (Ersatzverkehr). Before an exam or important appointment check uestra.de or the ÜSTRA app. ℹ️ If there is a strike on an exam day, plan ahead and, if needed, e-mail your lecturer and the examinations office before the exam.

Related pages: 38. Driving licence, 39. Travelling in Europe

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Deutschlandsemesterticket	Required	€226.80, part of the winter 2026/27 semester fee	LUH
Long-distance train ticket	Possible	Bought separately	AStA
Refund documents	Possible	Learning Agreement or internship proof	AStA

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** AStA Hannover – Semesterticket
- **Address:** Welfengarten 2c, 30167 Hannover
- **Contact:** semesterticket@asta-hannover.de · login problems: studium@uni-hannover.de
- **Source:** AStA

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	AStA – Semester ticket	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	AStA – Semester ticket hardship fund rules (PDF)	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	AStA – Semester ticket (English)	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened (the former address returned 404)
4	AStA – Hardship fund portal	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	uestra.de	ÜSTRA / GVH	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	LUH – Re-registration	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
7	AStA – Bike workshop	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **Strike days (2025–2026):** when only ÜSTRA or regiobus were on strike, the S-Bahn and regional trains (DB) usually still ran. Students got to university by bike, S-Bahn or sharing rides with friends.
- **Second-hand bikes and repairs:** the university bike sale and the free repair workshop (you only pay for parts) were recommended several times. → 24. AStA

31. Everyday Shopping, Supermarkets and Saving Money

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 4 — Everyday Life in Hannover · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

A guide to everyday shopping and saving money in Hannover: student discounts, bottle deposit (Pfand), shop opening hours and where to find food from home.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** newcomers.

3. Steps

1. **Student discounts:** show your enrolment certificate for discounts at theatres, the opera, cinemas, museums, adult-education courses and some companies (LUH – Study checklist).
2. **Hausmarke card:** a free discount card for Hannover students at more than 100 shops, restaurants, museums and clubs; get it from the **Tourist Information** office (hannover.de – Hausmarke).
3. **Theatre and opera:** LUH students can attend the Staatstheater Hannover with the "Theaterflatrate"; its share (Kulturticket) is included in the semester fee (Studentenwerk – Save money). → 34. Sports and culture
4. **ISIC card** for discounts outside Germany (LUH – Study checklist).
5. **Bottle deposit (Pfand):** single-use bottles and cans carry a **€0.25** deposit, reusable bottles usually €0.08 or €0.15. Any shop selling that type of packaging must take it back, even if bought elsewhere; shops under 200 m² only take back their own brands (Federal Environment Ministry – Single-use and reusable; Verbraucherzentrale).
6. **Sundays and public holidays:** shops in Lower Saxony are generally **closed**; only a few Sundays a year are allowed by the city (IHK Braunschweig – NLöffVZG). Do your weekend shopping on Saturday. ℹ️ Shops in the main station are an exception.
7. **Discount supermarkets** such as Aldi, Lidl, Penny and Netto are usually cheapest. ℹ️ General experience.
8. **Food from home:** Hannover has many international grocery stores (Turkish, Arabic, Persian, Asian, African, Eastern European, Latin American) and halal butchers, especially in districts such as Linden, Vahrenwald

and around Steintor. ℹ️ Community tip — help us build a list on page 57. → 64. Religion, food and home communities

9. **Second-hand:** furniture and household goods are cheap on classified sites, at flea markets and in social department stores (Sozialkaufhaus). Halls often have "give-away" shelves. ℹ️
10. **Studentenwerk's money-saving list:** Save money (LUH – Study checklist).

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Enrolment certificate	Possible	For discounts	LUH
Hausmarke card	Possible	Free; from Tourist Information	hannover.de
Bottle deposit	—	€0.25 (single-use); refunded when you return the bottle	BMUKN

5. Responsible office

- No single responsible office.
- **Saving money:** Studentenwerk Hannover, Jägerstraße 5, 30167 Hannover (Save money)
- **Hausmarke card:** Tourist Information Hannover (hannover.de)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	hannover.de – Hausmarke	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Studentenwerk – Save money	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Federal Environment Ministry – Single-use and reusable	Federal Environment Ministry	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	Verbraucherzentrale	Verbraucherzentrale	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	IHK Braunschweig – NLöffVZG	ihk.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Save money	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

32. Internet, Mobile and Service Contracts

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 4 — Everyday Life in Hannover · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

After the first months many students sign contracts for home internet, mobile phone or electricity. German contracts have fixed terms and cancellation rules; this page summarises what to check before signing. (SIM card for the first days → 8. SIM card and internet)

2. Who needs this?

- Students living in a private flat or shared flat (WG); many Studentenwerk halls include internet (LUH – Housing).

3. Steps

1. **Contract term and cancellation:** phone and internet contracts can have an initial term of at most **24 months**; after that they can be cancelled **monthly** with one month's notice. The last possible cancellation date must be shown on your bill (Verbraucherzentrale; Bundesnetzagentur – Contracts). ℹ️ If you will only stay 1–2 years, prefer monthly-cancellable plans.
2. **Right of withdrawal:** contracts concluded online or by phone can usually be withdrawn within **14 days** without giving reasons (§ 355 BGB).
3. **Student discounts:** some mobile providers offer discounts with an enrolment certificate (LUH – Study checklist).
4. **Electricity:** if you rent a private flat you need an electricity contract. ℹ️ In halls and many WGs electricity is included in the rent; ask your landlord.
5. **Beware of door-to-door and phone sales:** don't sign anything at the door; ask for the offer in writing. ℹ️
6. **Before leaving Germany or moving,** cancel contracts in time. ℹ️ → 47. Leaving Germany
7. **Problem with a contract?** The consumer advice centre (Verbraucherzentrale Niedersachsen) helps; telephone advice without appointment is free, in-person advice needs an appointment (Verbraucherzentrale – Hannover office).

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
German bank account (IBAN)	Required	For monthly direct debit	ℹ️ Ask the provider
Registration certificate or passport	Possible	Depends on the provider	ℹ️ Ask the provider
Enrolment certificate	Possible	For discounts	LUH

5. Responsible office

- **Consumer protection:** Verbraucherzentrale Niedersachsen, Beratungsstelle Hannover — Landschaftstraße 3, 30159 Hannover (entrance from Georgsplatz) · 0511 91196-0 (Verbraucherzentrale)
- **Telecoms regulator:** Bundesnetzagentur — Bundesnetzagentur – consumer information

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Housing	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Verbraucherzentrale	Verbraucherzentrale	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Bundesnetzagentur – consumer information	Federal Network Agency	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	§ 355 BGB	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	Verbraucherzentrale – Hannover office	Verbraucherzentrale Niedersachsen	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

33. Doctors, Pharmacies and Health Care

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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🩺 Medical disclaimer

This page is **not medical advice, diagnosis or treatment** and does not replace an examination or advice from a doctor, psychotherapist or pharmacist. Make decisions about illness, medicines and treatment only with them. **In an emergency call 112 immediately**; outside surgery hours call 116117. Names of doctors or clinics (where given) come from public registers and are not a recommendation, endorsement or guarantee by ISL.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 4 — Everyday Life in Hannover · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

In Germany you usually see a **general practitioner (Hausarzt)** first, who refers you to a specialist if needed. This page explains how to find a doctor, where to go at night and at weekends, and how pharmacies work.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students with health insurance. → 7. Health insurance

3. Steps

1. **Always carry the insurance card** your insurer sends you and show it at the practice. ℹ️ If you don't have the card yet, ask your insurer for a temporary certificate. 🌍 EU students with an EHIC show the EHIC.
2. **Finding a doctor and booking appointments:** the official service **116117** (phone and 116117.de) helps find doctors and arrange appointments. ℹ️ Many practices list the languages they speak; online booking platforms let you filter by language.
3. **Nights, weekends and holidays (non-urgent):** the on-call medical service (ärztlicher Bereitschaftsdienst) via **116117** (116117.de).
4. **Emergency and danger to life: 112** → 37. Emergency numbers
5. **Pharmacy (Apotheke):** prescription medicines require a doctor's prescription (Rezept). Find the on-duty pharmacy with the free postcode search at **aponet.de**; pharmacies may charge €2.50 at night (usually

20:00–06:00), on Sundays and holidays, which your insurer pays if the doctor writes "noctu" on the prescription (aponet – On-duty pharmacy search).

6. **Co-payment for medicines (Zuzahlung):** 10% of the price, at least €5 and at most €10, never more than the medicine itself; under-18s are exempt (Federal Ministry of Health – Co-payment rules (PDF)).
7. 🌍 **Bringing medicines from home:** some medicines that are legal in your country are controlled in Germany. Carry a prescription or doctor's letter (in English or German); for narcotics you need a certificate under the Schengen rules or a doctor's certificate (BfArM – Travelling with narcotic drugs).
8. **Dentist:** check-ups are covered by statutory insurance; many treatments require a co-payment. ℹ️ Ask for a cost estimate (Heil- und Kostenplan) first.
9. **Mental health:** free ptb counselling at the university → 29. Counselling
10. **Sick note (Arbeitsunfähigkeitsbescheinigung):** see or call a doctor on the day you fall ill. The start of the illness can be backdated only **exceptionally and usually by at most three days** (G-BA – Decision on the AU guideline 2015 (PDF)). For missing an exam, your programme's rules for a medical certificate (Attest) apply. → 18. Exams
11. **Hospital emergency department (Notaufnahme)** is for serious and urgent cases; for ordinary illness outside surgery hours call **116117**, which sends you to an on-call practice (116117.de).
12. **Finding a doctor who speaks English or your language:** open arztsuche.116117.de, enter the speciality (e.g. `Hausarzt` for a GP) and your postcode, then under **Filter → Fremdsprachen** tick your language. On 25.10.2026 there were more than 120 English-speaking practices within 25 km of Hannover. ℹ️ Dentists are listed separately by the Lower Saxony dental association (KZVN – Dentist search), which had no language filter — ask when booking.

Unwritten rules

13. **GP first.** For most problems go to your Hausarzt first; they refer you (Überweisung) to a specialist, and specialist appointments are easier to get with a referral.
14. **Everything works by appointment.** Call or book online; many practices also have an open consultation hour (offene Sprechstunde) without appointment.
15. **Cancel appointments you can't attend.** Some practices charge for missed appointments. ⚠️ Ask each practice about its rules.
16. **Show your insurance card** at your first visit each quarter.
17. **Keep a list of your medicines and medical history** (in English is fine) on your phone. Pharmacies don't accept prescriptions from other countries; show your old prescription to a German GP to get a German one, and bring enough of your regular medicine for the first months.

Dentist with statutory insurance

18. **Free check-up every six months:** statutory insurance pays **one check-up per half-year** for adults; tartar removal once a year and a gum check (PSI) every two years. **Professional tooth cleaning (PZR)** is usually private — some insurers pay part of it (Verbraucherzentrale – Which dental check-ups does insurance pay?).
19. **Get a bonus booklet (Bonusheft) from day one.** For crowns, bridges and dentures your insurer pays **60%** of the standard treatment; **70%** if you had at least one check-up every year for the last **five years**, and **75%** after **ten years** of regular check-ups (§ 55 SGB V). Have every check-up stamped.
20. **Fillings:** insurance pays the standard material; if you choose a more expensive one you pay the difference (Verbraucherzentrale – Dental services covered by statutory insurance).
21. **Private dental bills:** the fee factor ranges from 1 to 3.5; **2.3** is the standard, and anything higher must be **justified** by difficulty or time (§ 5 GOZ). Ask for a written cost estimate before expensive treatment and check it with your insurer — some treatments must be approved **before** they start.

22. **Unfinished treatment from home:** if you have an implant or treatment started abroad, bring the records and X-rays; some German surgeons will not continue another dentist's work. ℹ️

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Health insurance card	Required	At every visit	ℹ️ Your insurer
Co-payment for medicines	Possible	10%, min. €5, max. €10	BMG
Doctor's visit	—	⚠️ Usually no separate charge with statutory insurance; ask your insurer about exact coverage	—

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Kassenärztliche Vereinigung — service **116117** (finding a doctor and on-call service)
- **Contact:** 116117 · 116117.de
- **Your health insurer:** for questions on costs and coverage

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	116117.de	Kassenärztliche Bundesvereinigung	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	aponet – On-duty pharmacy search	ABDA (pharmacists)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Federal Ministry of Health – Co-payment rules (PDF)	Federal Ministry of Health	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	BfArM – Travelling with narcotic drugs	Federal Institute for Drugs and Medical Devices	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	G-BA – Decision on the AU guideline 2015 (PDF)	g-ba.de	2026-11-03	✅ Opened
6	arztsuche.116117.de	Kassenärztliche Bundesvereinigung	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	KZVN – Dentist search	kzvn.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened (browser)
8	Verbraucherzentrale – Which dental check-ups does insurance pay?	Verbraucherzentrale	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	§ 55 SGB V	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
10	Verbraucherzentrale – Dental services covered by statutory insurance	Verbraucherzentrale	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
11	§ 5 GOZ	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **Prescriptions from home** were not accepted by pharmacies; students showed their old prescription to a German GP and got a German one.
- **No GP yet:** several students were seen during a nearby practice's open consultation hour. Many booked specialist appointments via Doctolib or 116117; an urgency code on the referral got appointments faster.
- **Emergency department:** long waits in the Notaufnahme are normal — patients are seen by urgency, not arrival time.
- **Privacy:** share lists of recommended doctors by private message, not in public groups.

34. Leisure, Sports, Culture and Social Life

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 4 — Everyday Life in Hannover · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Ways to do sport, enjoy culture and make friends in Hannover — from university sports to theatre and opera with a student ticket.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students.

3. Steps

1. **University sports (Hochschulsport):** about 100 sports in hundreds of courses; registration opens shortly before the semester and popular courses fill up quickly (LUH – Study checklist; Hochschulsport – Sports programmes).
2. Students of LUH and partner universities pay **student rates** (Hochschulsport). Your LeibnizCard is your sports card (LUH – Study checklist).
3. **Theatre and opera:** LUH students can attend the Staatstheater Hannover with the "Theaterflatrate"; its share (Kulturticket, €2) is included in the semester fee (Studentenwerk – Save money; LUH – Re-registration). Details at staatstheater-hannover.de.
4. **Student discounts** for cinemas and museums with your enrolment certificate (LUH – Study checklist). → 31. Shopping
5. **City and university:** Campus and city and city events in the hannover.de events calendar. ℹ️ Popular free spots: Herrenhausen Gardens (reduced student entry), Maschsee lake, Eilenriede city forest, and the Maschsee festival and Schützenfest in summer.
6. **Making friends:** Study-Buddy, international student groups and events → 48. Programmes for international students, 49. International student groups, 51. Events and networking
7. **Getting Theaterflatrate tickets:** free flatrate tickets are released **three days before** each performance in the theatre's online shop while seats last; people under 30 may also get up to 30% off, depending on the performance (Staatstheater – Ticket service).

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
LeibnizCard	Required	For university sports	LUH
Sports course fees	Possible	Student rates; each course page shows its price	Hochschulsport
Theaterflatrate	—	Already paid with the semester fee	Studentenwerk

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Zentrale Einrichtung für Hochschulsport Hannover (university sports)
- **Address:** Am Moritzwinkel 6, 30167 Hannover (SportCAMPUS)
- **Source:** Hochschulsport

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Hochschulsport – Sports programmes	Hochschulsport Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Hochschulsport	Hochschulsport Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Studentenwerk – Save money	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – Re-registration	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	staatstheater-hannover.de	Staatstheater Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Campus and city	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	hannover.de events calendar	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	Staatstheater – Ticket service	Staatstheater Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **Most recommended (2024–2026):** Hochschulsport, the student cinema (UniKino), free open-air summer concerts (Maschpark, Welfengarten), the Maschseefest and the annual university ball (Hochschulball — presale in November; tickets sell out within hours). → 65. Annual student calendar

35. Learning German and Practising the Language

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 4 — Everyday Life in Hannover · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Even in English-taught programmes, German is needed for everyday life, official offices and work — and it greatly improves your job chances after graduation. This page summarises ways to learn and practise German in Hannover.

2. Who needs this?

- All international students — especially those who need **C1** or the **DSH** to enrol. Bachelor's applicants with foreign certificates need B1 to apply and C1 to enrol (LUH – Language requirements).

3. Steps

1. **Semester German courses** at the Leibniz Language Centre (LLC – German) and the intensive **D-intensiv** course for the DSH. → 26. Language Centre
2. **Tandem:** practise with a German speaker who is learning your language (LLC – Tandem).
3. **Self-directed learning (SDL)** at the LLC (LLC).
4. **Study-Buddy** for cultural exchange (LUH – Study-Buddy).
5. **Volkshochschule Hannover (adult education centre):** German courses and integration courses outside the university; free German-course advice without appointment on Thursdays 14:00–16:00 (VHS Hannover – German advice). Course list, including neighbourhood courses: VHS Hannover – German courses.
6. **Free online courses:** Deutsche Welle offers free courses from A1 to C1 (DW – Learn German); the Goethe-Institut has free practice material (Goethe-Institut – Practise German). The Federal Employment Agency publishes a list of free websites and apps for learning German (Federal Employment Agency – Free online German courses (PDF)).
7. **Recognised certificates:** TestDaF, DSH, Goethe-Zertifikat and telc are widely accepted; check which one your programme or employer accepts (TestDaF).
    - For university admission DSH, TestDaF or telc C1 Hochschule are usually accepted; for permanent residence and many jobs, level B1 (LUH – Language certificates). → 46. After graduation

What worked for students

8. **Class plus daily practice:** a class alone is not enough; 20–30 minutes of listening and repeating aloud (shadowing) every day made the biggest difference. ℹ️ Student experience.
9. **Connect German to your life:** tandem, a university sports course in German, a student job and university events. → 34. Sports and culture, 51. Events
10. **Credits for language courses:** in some programmes LLC courses count towards your degree; ask your faculty about the form and conditions. ℹ️

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Language certificate (B1, C1 or DSH)	Possible	Depends on programme and admission letter	LUH
LLC course fee	Possible	According to LLC fee rules	LLC
VHS course fee	Possible	⚠️ Not in the sources checked; see the VHS website	vhs-hannover.de

5. Responsible office

- **Leibniz Language Centre (LLC):** Im Moore 11B, 30167 Hannover · +49 511 762 4914 (LLC – Contact)
- **Volkshochschule Hannover:** Burgstraße 14, 30159 Hannover · integration.vhs@hannover-stadt.de (VHS Hannover – German advice)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Language requirements	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LLC – German	Leibniz Language Centre	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	LLC – Tandem	Leibniz Language Centre	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	LLC	Leibniz Language Centre	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – Study-Buddy	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	VHS Hannover – German advice	Volkshochschule Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	VHS Hannover – German courses	Volkshochschule Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	DW – Learn German	learngerman.dw.com	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
9	Goethe-Institut – Practise German	goethe.de	2026-11-03	✅ Opened (browser)
10	Federal Employment Agency – Free online German courses (PDF)	Federal Employment Agency	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
11	TestDaF	testdaf.de	2026-11-03	⚠️ Server error (HTTP 500 or 503) on the check date; re-check later
12	LLC	Leibniz Language Centre	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
13	vhs-hannover.de	Volkshochschule Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
14	LLC – Contact	Leibniz Language Centre	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **LLC courses** satisfied most students; places fill quickly, registration is through Stud.IP with a placement test, and allowed absences are limited.
- **Private language schools** were more expensive for intensive courses (e.g. to go from B1 to C1 quickly); students asked for a trial lesson or others' experience first. ℹ️ This handbook does not recommend any school.
- **Speaking takes time:** several students said their speaking improved more through daily practice and real situations (work, tandem, sports club) than through classes.
- **Textbooks:** common course books (e.g. the Netzwerk series) were often swapped second-hand.

36. Waste Separation, House Rules and Living in Germany

> **⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice**
>
> **Rules, amounts, deadlines and procedures can change at any time without notice.** The Iranian Student Association of Leibniz University Hannover (ISL) and the authors of this handbook accept **no responsibility** for the accuracy, completeness or currency of the content, or for the consequences of using it. Check with the responsible official office before you act; it always has the final word.
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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 4 — Everyday Life in Hannover · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

In Germany waste must be separated and buildings have house rules (Hausordnung). Ignoring them is the most common cause of trouble with neighbours and landlords.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** residents of the city and region of Hannover.

3. Steps

Waste separation in the Hannover region

1. **Yellow bin (Gelbe Tonne):** lightweight packaging (plastic, metal, cartons); it replaced the yellow bag and is free for residents (hannover.de – Yellow bin). In the city, aha is responsible; outside the city, Remondis (hannover.de – Yellow bag).
2. **Organic bin (Biotonne):** replaced organic-waste bags across the region on 1 August 2024. Plastic (even "bioplastic"), **cooked food**, nappies and pet litter are not allowed (hannover.de).
3. **Residual waste (Restabfalltonne):** bins have replaced bags since early 2024 (hannover.de).
4. **Paper (Altpapiertonne):** since August 2025 collected only in paper bins (hannover.de).
5. **Glass:** separate by colour (white, brown, green) into glass containers (aha – Glass). ℹ️ Avoid using them at night and on Sundays (noise).
6. **Bulky waste (Sperrmüll):** collection of up to 5 m^3 is free by appointment; each item max. 2 m long and 75 kg. Put items out on collection day by 6:00, not earlier (aha – Bulky waste collection). You can also take up to 1 m^3 per day free to a **recycling centre (Wertstoffhof)**.
7. **Collection calendar** for your address: aha-region.de. The aha app also sends reminders.

House rules

1. Get the **house rules (Hausordnung)** from your landlord and read them (stairwell cleaning, quiet hours, etc.). ℹ️

2. **Quiet hours (Ruhezeiten)** usually apply at night (often 22:00–06:00) and on Sundays and public holidays; details are in the Hausordnung. ℹ️
3. **Air regularly (Lüften)** — open windows wide for a few minutes several times a day — to prevent mould. ℹ️
4. **Heating and electricity** are often billed annually; a large back-payment can follow if you heat a lot. ℹ️ Check your Nebenkosten statement.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Yellow bin	—	Free	hannover.de
Bulky waste collection	—	Up to 5 m^3 free; express service costs extra	aha
Waste fees	Possible	ℹ️ Usually part of the service charges (Nebenkosten); ask your landlord	—

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Zweckverband Abfallwirtschaft Region Hannover (aha), the region's waste management authority
- **Contact:** free hotline **0800 999 11 99** (Mon–Thu 7:00–16:30, Fri 7:00–15:00) (aha)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	hannover.de – Yellow bin	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	hannover.de – Yellow bag	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	hannover.de	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	aha – Glass	aha – Region Hannover waste management	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	aha – Bulky waste collection	aha – Region Hannover waste management	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	aha-region.de	aha – Region Hannover waste management	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

37. Safety, Emergency Numbers and City Services

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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🩺 Medical disclaimer

This page is **not medical advice, diagnosis or treatment** and does not replace an examination or advice from a doctor, psychotherapist or pharmacist. Make decisions about illness, medicines and treatment only with them. **In an emergency call 112 immediately**; outside surgery hours call 116117. Names of doctors or clinics (where given) come from public registers and are not a recommendation, endorsement or guarantee by ISL.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 4 — Everyday Life in Hannover · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Know emergency numbers and urgent help **before** you need them. Save this page on your phone.

2. Who needs this?

- **Everyone.**

3. Steps

Situation	Number	Notes
Fire, ambulance, danger to life	**112**	European emergency number; free, 24/7 (hannover.de – Emergency services)
Police	**110**	Free (hannover.de – Emergency services)
On-call doctor (non-urgent, nights and weekends)	**116117**	116117.de
Emotional crisis	**0800 111 0 111** · **0800 111 0 222** · **116 123**	TelefonSeelsorge; free, 24/7 and anonymous; chat and e-mail at online.telefonseelsorge.de (TelefonSeelsorge)

Situation	Number	Notes
Violence against women	**116 016**	Free, 24/7, in 18 languages (Hilfetelefon Gewalt gegen Frauen)
On-duty pharmacy	Online search at aponet.de	aponet
Emergency on campus	LUH emergency information	LUH – Emergency

1. **Calling 112:** say **where** you are, **what** happened, **who** is calling and **how many** people are injured; then wait for questions (BBK – First aid and emergency call; hannover.de – Emergency services). Operators usually also speak English.
2. If you cannot speak, the official **nora** app allows a silent emergency call (BBK).
3. **Warning apps:** NINA (federal warning app) sends alerts about fire, floods, severe weather and other dangers for your location (BBK – NINA). The nationwide **warning day (Warntag)** is usually the second Thursday in September: a test alert at 11:00 and the all-clear around 11:45. Next Warntag: 9 September 2027 (BBK – Nationwide warning day).
4. **Lost passport or residence card:** inform the Ausländerbehörde immediately and report theft to the police. 🌍 Only **your own country's embassy or consulate** can issue a new passport (EU citizens can also get emergency help from any EU country's embassy if theirs is not reachable); the Ausländerbehörde issues the new residence card, which can take 4–8 weeks (City of Munich – Loss of residence documents; City of Wiesbaden). ℹ️ Ask the Hannover Ausländerbehörde for its exact procedure. → 10. Residence permit
5. 🌍 **Your embassy or consulate:** find your country's diplomatic mission in Germany in the Federal Foreign Office's list (Federal Foreign Office – Missions of other states in Germany). Register with your embassy if it offers a registration service for citizens abroad. → 64. Religion, food and home communities
6. **Discrimination or harassment at university** → 27. ChancenVielfalt
7. **Victims of crime:** the WEISSER RING helps victims free of charge (WEISSER RING).
8. **World War II bombs (Kampfmittel):** old bombs are still found in Hannover, and thousands of people may have to leave their homes for a few hours. Check the evacuation area and emergency shelters on the Feuerwehr Hannover website, and take medicines and important documents with you.
9. **Heat waves:** follow heat and severe-weather warnings at DWD – Warnings or in NINA. Drink enough water and avoid going out at midday.
10. **Fraud, theft and free legal help** → 67. Consumer rights, scams and free legal help

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Calling 112 and 110	—	Free	hannover.de
Reporting lost documents	Possible	May cost a fee	City of Wiesbaden

5. Responsible office

- **Hannover police:** Polizeidirektion Hannover, Waterloostraße 9, 30169 Hannover · 0511 109-0 · pd-h.polizei-nds.de (hannover.de – Police directorate)
- **City list of emergency services:** hannover.de – Emergency services & numbers

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	hannover.de – Emergency services & numbers	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	116117.de	Kassenärztliche Bundesvereinigung	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	TelefonSeelsorge	TelefonSeelsorge	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Hilfetelefon Gewalt gegen Frauen	Federal Office for Family Affairs	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	aponet	ABDA (pharmacists)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	LUH – Emergency	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	BBK – First aid and emergency call	Federal Office of Civil Protection	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	BBK – NINA	Federal Office of Civil Protection	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	BBK – Nationwide warning day	Federal Office of Civil Protection	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	City of Munich – Loss of residence documents	stadt.muenchen.de — unofficial / secondary source	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
11	City of Wiesbaden	wiesbaden.de — unofficial / secondary source	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
12	Federal Foreign Office – Missions of other states in Germany	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
13	WEISSER RING	weisser-ring.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
14	Feuerwehr Hannover	feuerwehr-hannover.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
15	DWD – Warnings	dwd.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
16	pd-h.polizei-nds.de	Police Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
17	hannover.de – Police directorate	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **2024–2026:** students were alerted to the Warntag, a bomb evacuation in Misburg-Nord (October 2026) and temperatures near 40 °C (June 2026). On hot days the university canteens handed out free water.

38. Driving Licence — Führerschein

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 4 — Everyday Life in Hannover · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

A foreign driving licence is valid in Germany for a limited time only — and the rules depend heavily on the country that issued it. This page explains how long you can drive with it and how to convert it into a German licence (Umschreibung).

2. Who needs this?

- 🌍 **EU/EEA licences** remain valid in Germany without conversion (until their expiry date) (§ 28 FeV – EU/EEA licences).
- 🌍 **Non-EU licences:** see the steps below. Whether you need driving tests to convert depends on the country (Annex 11 FeV).
- ℹ️ With the semester ticket you rarely need a car. → 30. Public transport

3. Steps

1. **Validity of a non-EU licence:** valid for **six months** after you take up ordinary residence in Germany (§ 29 FeV).
2. **Extension:** the licensing authority can extend this by up to six months if you prove you will not stay in Germany longer than twelve months (§ 29 FeV). ℹ️ For students staying several years this rarely applies — apply for conversion early.
3. **Translation:** a licence not in German needs a translation from an internationally recognised automobile club of the issuing country or from a body designated by the German Transport Ministry — or an International Driving Permit (§ 29 FeV).
4. 🌍 **Which countries need no tests?** Annex 11 FeV lists countries whose class B licences are converted **without** theory and practical tests — among them Albania, Andorra, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Israel, Japan, Kosovo, Monaco, Montenegro, Namibia, New Zealand, North Macedonia, Serbia, Singapore, South Africa, South Korea, Switzerland, Taiwan, Ukraine, the United Kingdom, all Australian states and Canadian provinces, and many US states (some US states need the theory test only). Licences from countries **not** on

the list (most countries in Africa, Asia, Latin America and the Middle East) need both a **theory and a practical test** (Annex 11 FeV). ⚠️ Check the current list for your country/state.

5. **Conversion (city of Hannover):** apply **in person** with an **appointment** at the city's driving licence office (Fahrerlaubnisbehörde). Processing takes about three to four weeks (hannover.gov.de – Conversion of third-country licences).
6. **If tests are needed:** you must register with a driving school, which registers you for the tests; lessons are not mandatory by law, but practical test preparation usually requires some. The theory test can be taken in several foreign languages, including English. ⚠️ Ask your driving school which languages are offered.
7. **Residents of the Hannover region** (outside the city) apply at the Region Hannover licensing office (hannover.de – Foreign driving licence).

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
ID card or passport	Required	—	hannover.gov.de
Valid foreign licence	Required	The foreign licence is handed in	hannover.gov.de
Recent biometric photo	Required	—	hannover.gov.de
Translation of the licence	Required (to drive on a non-German licence)	From an approved body	§ 29 FeV
Conversion fee	Required	€45.10, payable by debit or credit card	hannover.gov.de
Test and driving-school fees	Possible	If tests are required	⚠️ Not stated in official sources checked

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Landeshauptstadt Hannover – 32.12 Fahrerlaubnisbehörde (city driving licence office)
- **Address:** Am Schützenplatz 1, 30169 Hannover
- **Contact:** city online appointments or 32.12Terminvergabe@Hannover-Stadt.de (hannover.gov.de – Driving licence office)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	§ 28 FeV – EU/EEA licences	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
2	§ 29 FeV	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
3	Annex 11 FeV	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
4	hannover.gov.de – Conversion of third-country licences	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	hannover.de – Foreign driving licence	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	hannover.gov.de – Driving licence office	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

39. Travelling in Europe with a Residence Permit

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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This page is general information, not legal advice. Check that your passport and residence card are valid before travelling.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 4 — Everyday Life in Hannover · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

With a German residence card you can make short trips to other Schengen countries. This page explains the 90/180-day rule and what to check before travelling.

2. Who needs this?

- 🌍 Non-EU students with a national type D visa or German residence permit.
- 🌍 EU/EEA and Swiss citizens travel freely with their ID card or passport.

3. Steps

1. **Basic rule:** holders of a national residence permit of a Schengen state (and of a national type D visa) may stay in other Schengen states for up to **90 days in any 180-day period** while it is valid (Federal Foreign Office – Schengen Agreement).
2. **Calculating 90/180:** always count back 180 days from the day in question; the days of entry and exit count as days of stay (Federal Foreign Office – Calculating the length of stay). The EU's short-stay calculator helps (European Commission – Short-stay calculator).
3. **Working in other countries:** this travel right does not include permission to work there (Federal Foreign Office – Visa for Germany).
4. **Entry/Exit System (EES):** since late 2025 the EU registers non-EU travellers at external Schengen borders biometrically. Holders of a Schengen residence permit are exempt but should show it at border control (European Union – EES). ⚠️
5. **Non-Schengen countries** (e.g. the UK, Ireland, Türkiye) have their own entry rules; you may need a separate visa or electronic travel authorisation depending on your nationality. ℹ️ Check the destination's rules first.

6. **If your permit is being renewed** and you only have a Fiktionsbescheinigung, ask the Ausländerbehörde before travelling. ⚠️ Re-entry and travel rules with a Fiktionsbescheinigung depend on its type. → 10. Residence permit
7. 🌍 **Travelling to your home country:** if your residence card expires while you are abroad, you will need a new visa to return (City of Wiesbaden). Stays outside Germany longer than six months can also cause a residence permit to lapse (§ 51 AufenthG). ℹ️ Check your card's validity before long trips.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Valid passport	Required	—	Federal Foreign Office
Valid residence card or national D visa	Required	—	Federal Foreign Office
Health insurance valid abroad	Possible	ℹ️ Ask your insurer about coverage abroad; EU students can use the EHIC	—

5. Responsible office

- **General information:** Auswärtiges Amt (Federal Foreign Office) — auswaertiges-amt.de
- **Questions about your own permit:** Ausländerbehörde → 10. Residence permit

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Federal Foreign Office – Schengen Agreement	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Federal Foreign Office – Calculating the length of stay	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	European Commission – Short-stay calculator	European Union	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Federal Foreign Office – Visa for Germany	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	European Union – EES	European Union	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	City of Wiesbaden	wiesbaden.de — unofficial / secondary source	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	§ 51 AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	auswaertiges-amt.de	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

Section 5 — Work, Finance & Career

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-10-24 · Back to the handbook contents

Student jobs, tax, scholarships, entrepreneurship, staying after graduation and leaving Germany. The information in this section is general and not legal or tax advice.

Pages in this section

- 40. Student jobs — 140-day limit, HiWi, Werkstudent, Minijob and minimum wage
- 41. Job search and German CV — Career Service, job portals and German CV conventions
- 42. Tax and payslips — tax-free allowance, insurance and tax returns
- 43. Scholarships and financial support — emergency aid, completion aid, Deutschlandstipendium, DAAD and foundations
- 44. Starting a business — starting business and start-up advice
- 45. Career service and internships — Career Service, internships and Career Dates
- 46. After graduation — job-seeker permit, Blue Card, permanent residence and naturalisation
- 47. Leaving Germany — Abmeldung, cancelling contracts, closing accounts and pension refund

40. Student Jobs — Werkstudent, HiWi and Minijob

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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💬 About this page: 🐞 Report an error or broken link · 💡 Suggest an idea · ✍️ Share an experience · ✏️ Edit it yourself

This page is general information, not legal or tax advice. Work rules for non-EU students depend on your residence permit; check with the Ausländerbehörde before starting a job.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 5 — Work, Finance & Career · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

This page explains the types of student jobs (HiWi, Werkstudent, Minijob) and the **legal limits** on working as a student; breaking these limits can put your residence permit at risk.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students.
- 🌍 **EU/EEA and Swiss students** may work without residence-law limits, like German students (social-insurance rules still apply) (Make it in Germany – Working while studying).
- 🌍 **Non-EU students** with a study permit are limited as described below. Refugees and people with temporary protection have different rules → 63. Refugees and protection status.

3. Steps

1. **Limit for non-EU students:** without approval from the Federal Employment Agency, at most **140 working days per year**, tracked as a working-day account (§ 16b (3) AufenthG; Make it in Germany).
2. **How days are counted:** whichever method is more favourable for you, week by week: (a) a day with up to 4 hours of work counts as half a day, longer days as full days; or (b) up to **20 hours per week during the lecture period**, and any number of hours per week **during semester breaks**, count as **2.5 working days** (§ 16b (3) AufenthG).
3. **Student side jobs (studentische Nebentätigkeiten)** — e.g. HiWi jobs at the university — do not count towards the 140 days (§ 16b (3) AufenthG). ℹ️ Ask the Ausländerbehörde whether your specific job qualifies.
4. **Internships:** a compulsory internship in your curriculum counts as part of your studies; a voluntary internship outside it counts towards the limit or needs approval from the Federal Employment Agency (BA)

(BA – Technical instructions (PDF)). → 45. Career service and internships

5. **Self-employment/freelancing** is not covered by the 140 days and needs separate permission from the Ausländerbehörde. ⚠️
6. **Types of jobs:**
   - **HiWi (studentische Hilfskraft):** student assistant at a university institute; ads on institute websites and the university job page.
   - **Werkstudent:** subject-related work at companies, usually at most 20 hours per week during the semester.
   - **Minijob:** earnings up to **€603 per month** in 2026 (€7,236 per year) (Deutsche Rentenversicherung; iww.de).
7. **Minimum wage:** €13.90 per hour in 2026, €14.60 from 1 January 2027 (Federal Government – Minimum wage). This applies to everyone regardless of nationality.
8. **Social security number (Sozialversicherungsnummer):** issued automatically and free of charge with your first job subject to social insurance (Deutsche Rentenversicherung).
9. **Work is not enough to finance your studies:** the Ausländerbehörde expects your livelihood to be secured independently of a job. ℹ️
10. **Tax, insurance and payslips** → 42. Tax and payslips
11. **Employment-law advice** for international students: AStA (AStA); the DGB's "Faire Mobilität" also advises foreign workers in many languages (Faire Mobilität). → 24. AStA

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Steuer-ID	Required	For every job	→ 9. Tax ID
Residence permit allowing work	Required (non-EU)	—	§ 16b AufenthG
Enrolment certificate	Possible	ℹ️ Werkstudent employers usually ask for it	—
Social security number	Possible	Automatic with your first insured job	DRV
German bank account	Required	—	→ 6. Bank account

5. Responsible office

- **Work permission:** Ausländerbehörde → 10. Residence permit
- **Advice:** AStA Hannover, Welfengarten 2c, 30167 Hannover · international@asta-hannover.de (AStA)
- **Jobs and internships:** Career Service → 45. Career service

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Make it in Germany – Working while studying	Federal Government – Make it in Germany	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	§ 16b (3) AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	BA – Technical instructions (PDF)	Federal Employment Agency	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	university job page	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	Deutsche Rentenversicherung	Deutsche Rentenversicherung	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	iww.de	iww.de — unofficial / secondary source	2026-11-08	❌ Server error (HTTP 500) on the check date; the official Deutsche Rentenversicherung source above gives the same limit
7	Federal Government – Minimum wage	Federal Government	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	Deutsche Rentenversicherung	Deutsche Rentenversicherung	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	AStA	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	Faire Mobilität	faire-mobilitaet.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

41. Job Search and Preparing a German CV

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 5 — Work, Finance & Career · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

CVs and applications in Germany follow their own format and conventions. This page shows where to look for jobs and where to get help writing your application.

2. Who needs this?

- Students looking for a student job, internship or first job after graduation.

3. Steps

1. **The university Career Service** helps students of all subjects with job search, applications, internships and contacts with employers (ZQS – Career Service). → 45. Career service
2. **Individual advice** on CVs and applications: Individual advice.
3. **Programme for international students** at the Career Service: Internationals welcome – Students.
4. **Career Dates job fair** (LUH – ZQS).
5. **Career Service office hour at the Infothek:** Mondays 13:00–14:00 (ServiceCenter).
6. **Job portals:** the Federal Employment Agency's job exchange (BA – Jobsuche) and the official portal for international professionals (Make it in Germany – Job listings).
7. **German CV (Lebenslauf):** usually tabular and in reverse chronological order, one to two pages, sent with a cover letter (Anschreiben) and relevant certificates. A photo and date of birth are common but not required — employers may not discriminate on such grounds (General Equal Treatment Act). ℹ️ Sample templates: Europass CV.
8. 🌍 **Foreign degrees and professions:** for regulated professions (e.g. teaching, medicine, some engineering titles) you need formal recognition; the "Recognition Finder" tells you what applies (Recognition in Germany – Recognition Finder).

Where to find job ads

9. **jobicco (LUH):** short-term and part-time student jobs such as tutoring, retail and events (jobicco Uni Hannover).
10. **Stellenticket (LUH):** internships, working-student (Werkstudent) jobs, theses in companies, trainee programmes, graduate jobs and research assistant positions, run with the Career Service (Stellenticket LUH).
11. **Federal Employment Agency job search:** filter by city, radius, field and working hours (full-time, part-time, Minijob) (BA – Jobsuche).
12. **Research assistant (HiWi) jobs** at university institutes → 40. Student jobs

Free help

13. **Career guidance at the Hannover employment agency (Berufsberatung für Studierende):** help choosing a career path, labour-market outlook, choosing a master's, and doubts about continuing your studies — **free and confidential**. Book online; drop-in hour for study doubts on Thursdays 12:00–14:00 at Escherstraße 17 (Agentur für Arbeit Hannover – Studies).
14. **Recognition of foreign qualifications for work (IQ):** IHK Hannover offers **free advice** on recognition and adaptation training for all occupations in the "Integration durch Qualifizierung" programme (IHK Hannover – Recognition of foreign qualifications). For evaluating a university degree → 66. Documents and credential evaluation
15. **Employment-law questions:** AStA's advice for international students → 24. AStA

Managing your applications

16. **Keep a tracking table:** company, job title, date sent, contact person, status (sent / interview / rejected) and follow-up date. ℹ️ Students found this prevents forgetting and double applications.
17. **Tailor each application:** a short cover letter that answers the requirements of that ad; send all documents as one PDF. ℹ️
18. **Follow up:** if you hear nothing after about two weeks, send a short, polite e-mail. ℹ️
19. **Before signing:** check the working-hour limit of your student residence permit; if the contract runs until your permit expires, ask the employer for a letter stating that the contract will be extended if your permit is. → 40, 10. Residence permit

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
CV and cover letter	Required	—	—
Certificates and references	Possible	Depending on the job ad	—
Career Service advice	—	⚠️ Not stated in official sources; ask before registering	—

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Career Service, ZQS — Leibniz University Hannover
- **Address:** Callinstraße 14, 30167 Hannover, building 3428 (ZQS – Team and contact)
- **Contact:** Career Service

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	ZQS – Career Service	ZQS, Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Individual advice	ZQS, Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Internationals welcome – Students	ZQS, Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	LUH – ZQS	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	ServiceCenter	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	BA – Jobsuche	Federal Employment Agency	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Make it in Germany – Job listings	Federal Government – Make it in Germany	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	Europass CV	European Union	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	Recognition in Germany – Recognition Finder	Federal Government – Recognition in Germany	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	jobicco Uni Hannover	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
11	Stellenticket LUH	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
12	Agentur für Arbeit Hannover – Studies	Federal Employment Agency	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
13	IHK Hannover – Recognition of foreign qualifications	ihk.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
14	ZQS – Team and contact	ZQS, Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **General job or one in your field?** Students tried both: general jobs (bakery, cashier, warehouse, phone support) are found faster, while Werkstudent jobs help your career. Common advice: start applying for Werkstudent jobs early in your studies — you don't need perfect German or full skills.

- **Apply every day:** several students filtered job portals by "last 24 hours" and "part-time", sent a few applications every day, and got answers.
- **German:** for general jobs, even basic German greatly improved the chances. → 35. Learning German
- **Pension insurance number:** HiWi contracts ask for it; it is on the letter from your insurer or on a previous payslip.

42. Tax, Payslips and Work-Related Insurance

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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This page is general information, not tax advice.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 5 — Work, Finance & Career · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

When you work, you receive a payslip (Gehaltsabrechnung) showing deductions for tax and insurance. This page explains the basics and how to get tax back with a tax return.

2. Who needs this?

- Students with a job. → 40. Student jobs

3. Steps

1. Give your **tax ID (Steuer-ID)** to your employer. → 9. Tax ID
2. **Basic tax-free allowance (Grundfreibetrag) 2026:** €12,348 per year; income up to this amount is tax-free (Federal Ministry of Finance – Monthly report Feb 2026).
3. **Minijobs** up to €603 per month have simpler rules. → 40. Student jobs
4. **Insurance in student jobs:** working up to **20 hours a week** during the semester, you are exempt from health, long-term care and unemployment insurance, but pay **pension insurance** on earnings over €603 per month. Working more than 20 hours (except in semester breaks, or evenings/weekends for up to 26 weeks) means all insurances apply (DRV – Student employee privilege).
5. **Tax return (Steuererklärung):** if tax was deducted during the year but your annual income was below the allowance, you can usually get it back — up to four years retroactively. Official free system: ELSTER (English interface available). ℹ️ For your own case, consult a tax adviser or a wage-tax assistance association (Lohnsteuerhilfeverein).
6. 🌍 **Double taxation agreements:** Germany has treaties with many countries; some contain special rules for students (e.g. on payments from home). Check the treaty with your country (Federal Ministry of Finance – Double taxation agreements). ⚠️

7. **Church tax (Kirchensteuer):** may be deducted depending on the religion you declared at registration (LUH – Entry and Residence). → 5. Registering your address

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Steuer-ID	Required	—	→ 9. Tax ID
Annual wage-tax certificate (Lohnsteuerbescheinigung)	Possible	For the tax return; ℹ️ from your employer, usually by end of February of the following year	—
ELSTER	—	Free	elster.de

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** the tax office (Finanzamt) for your address. ⚠️ Find the office for your district on the Lower Saxony tax administration website (Steuerverwaltung Niedersachsen – Finanzämter).
- **General advice:** AStA (employment law) — international@asta-hannover.de

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Federal Ministry of Finance – Monthly report Feb 2026	Federal Ministry of Finance	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	DRV – Student employee privilege	Deutsche Rentenversicherung	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	elster.de	German tax administration (ELSTER)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Federal Ministry of Finance – Double taxation agreements	Federal Ministry of Finance	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – Entry and Residence	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	Steuerverwaltung Niedersachsen – Finanzämter	Lower Saxony tax administration	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

43. Scholarships and Financial Support

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 5 — Work, Finance & Career · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

This page lists financial aid and scholarships that students — especially international students — in Hannover can apply for, from emergency aid to long-term scholarships.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students; some aid is only for non-EU students.
- 🌍 **BAföG** (state student finance) is usually only for German students, but some international students qualify — e.g. EU citizens who have lived/worked in Germany long enough, recognised refugees and some people with long-term residence (§ 8 BAföG – eligible foreign nationals; LUH – Study checklist). ⚠️ Ask Studentenwerk's BAföG office.

3. Steps

1. **Emergency aid (Notfall-Beihilfe) from the International Office:** for sudden financial crises not caused by you, e.g. theft, fire, sudden job loss or illness. The amount is not fixed, it is usually paid only once during your studies and there is no legal right to it (LUH – Financial aid for international students).
2. **Degree-completion aid (Studienabschlussbeihilfe):** for non-EU students with a study residence permit in their thesis phase; partial monthly payments. Application periods each year: **1–31 January, 1–31 March, 1–31 July and 1–31 October**, followed by a 20–30-minute interview (LUH).
3. **AStA:** short-term loans (Darlehen) and the subsidised canteen card (Mensafreitisch) (LUH). → 24. AStA
4. **KED and KHG (church organisations):** advice and emergency financial aid, regardless of religion (LUH).
5. **Deutschlandstipendium:** €300 per month for two semesters, for German and international students of all subjects. 2026/27 round: applications **10 August – 30 September 2026** via the university's online portal (LUH – Deutschlandstipendium news; LUH – Deutschlandstipendium). ℹ️ Check the next deadline around August 2027.
6. **DAAD scholarship database:** search by country of origin, subject and degree level (DAAD – Scholarship database). 🌍 Many DAAD programmes are country-specific — apply from your home country, often a year

in advance.

7. **Political and religious foundations** (Begabtenförderungswerke) also fund international students, e.g. Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung, Konrad-Adenauer-Stiftung, Heinrich-Böll-Stiftung, Rosa-Luxemburg-Stiftung, Evangelisches Studienwerk, Cusanuswerk and the Avicenna-Studienwerk for Muslim students (Stipendium Plus – the foundations).
8. 🌍 **Home-country scholarships:** many governments fund study in Germany (ask your ministry of education or the German embassy).

4. Documents and costs

Documents for emergency aid and degree-completion aid (all in one PDF) (LUH):

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Passport and residence card	Required	—	LUH
Enrolment certificate and transcript	Required	—	LUH
Statements of all accounts for the last three months (incl. PayPal and credit card)	Required	—	LUH
Blocked account statement or Verpflichtungserklärung	Required	—	LUH
Proof of income or employment contract, and rental contract	Required	—	LUH
Registration for final exam/thesis	Required (degree-completion aid only)	—	LUH
Scholarship certificate and proof of the crisis	Possible	—	LUH

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Hochschulbüro für Internationales (International Office) — financial aid for international students
- **Address:** Welfengarten 1A, 30167 Hannover, building 1106, room 030
- **Contact:** incoming-student@uni-hannover.de · +49 511 762 3964; an in-person consultation before applying is recommended.
- **Source:** LUH

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	§ 8 BAföG – eligible foreign nationals	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	LUH – Financial aid for international students	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	LUH – Deutschlandstipendium news	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – Deutschlandstipendium	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	DAAD – Scholarship database	DAAD	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
7	Stipendium Plus – the foundations	stipendiumplus.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

44. Entrepreneurship and Starting a Business

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🌍 For non-EU students, starting a business or becoming self-employed may require a change or review of your residence permit; talk to the Ausländerbehörde first.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 5 — Work, Finance & Career · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

If you have a business or start-up idea, the university and the city of Hannover offer free advice, workshops and funding routes such as the EXIST grant.

2. Who needs this?

- LUH students, researchers and graduates with a business idea or who want to join start-up teams.

3. Steps

1. **starting business:** a joint service of **hannoverimpuls** (the economic development agency of the city and region) and LUH that helps turn innovative ideas into business plans; advice is free (starting-business.de; Free advice; LUH – Business start-ups).
2. People not affiliated with the university are referred to hannoverimpuls (starting-business.de – Advice).
3. **University patents and start-ups office:** SG 44 – Patente und Gründung (LUH – SG 44).
4. **Doctoral candidates and researchers:** Self-employment / Starting a business – Graduate Academy.
5. **Federal platform:** Gründerplattform, a free online guide from planning to financing.
6. 🌍 **Residence:** self-employment after graduation may require a residence permit for self-employment (§ 21 AufenthG); graduates of German universities have eased conditions (§ 21 AufenthG; Make it in Germany – Self-employment). → 10. Residence permit, 46. After graduation

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
starting business advice	—	Free	starting-business.de
Residence permit for self-employment	Possible	Non-EU students/graduates	§ 21 AufenthG

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** starting business — hannoverimpuls GmbH and Leibniz University Hannover (SG 44 – Patente und Gründung)
- **Contact:** info@starting-business.de · SG 44: +49 511 762 5724 (LUH – Business start-ups)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	starting-business.de	hannoverimpuls / LUH	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	starting-business.de – Advice	hannoverimpuls / LUH	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	LUH – Business start-ups	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	LUH – SG 44	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	Self-employment / Starting a business – Graduate Academy	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	Gründerplattform	gruenderplattform.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	§ 21 AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	Make it in Germany – Self-employment	Federal Government – Make it in Germany	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

45. University Career Service and Internships

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 5 — Work, Finance & Career · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

This page introduces the university's services for **career orientation, internships and entering the job market**, and the rule on **residence after graduation**.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students — especially those with a compulsory internship or close to graduation.

3. Steps

1. **Career Service (ZQS):** advice and workshops on career orientation, internships and starting work (LUH – ZQS).
2. **Career Dates:** the university's job fair (LUH – ZQS).
3. **Credit-bearing key-skills courses** and projects with companies (ZQS – Key competencies). → 25. ZQS
4. **University page on careers and internships:** Career orientation & internships.
5. 🌍 **Internships and the work limit:** a compulsory internship is part of your studies; for non-EU students a voluntary internship counts towards the limit or needs approval from the Federal Employment Agency. → 40. Student jobs
6. 🌍 **After graduation:** non-EU graduates can get a residence permit to **look for work for up to 18 months**, provided their living costs are covered (§ 20 AufenthG). → 46. After graduation

Related pages: 46. After graduation, 47. Leaving Germany

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Your programme's internship regulations	Possible	If you have a compulsory internship	LUH – Study checklist

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Proof of living costs	Required (job-search permit)	—	§ 20 AufenthG
Career Service advice	—	⚠️ Not stated in official sources	—

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Career Service, ZQS — Leibniz University Hannover
- **Address:** Callinstraße 14, 30167 Hannover, building 3428
- **Office hour at the Infothek:** Mondays 13:00–14:00, ServiceCenter, Welfengarten 1 (ServiceCenter)
- **Contact:** Career Service

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – ZQS	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	ZQS – Key competencies	ZQS, Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Career orientation & internships	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	§ 20 AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	ServiceCenter	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Career Service	ZQS, Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

46. After Graduation — Job Search, EU Blue Card and Permanent Residence

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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This page is general information, not legal advice. The right residence permit depends on your personal situation; talk to the Ausländerbehörde before acting.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 5 — Work, Finance & Career · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

After graduation your study permit is no longer enough. This page explains the legal ways to stay in Germany: job-seeker residence, residence for skilled work, the EU Blue Card (Blaue Karte EU) and permanent residence (Niederlassungserlaubnis).

2. Who needs this?

- 🌍 **Non-EU** graduates of German universities. EU, EEA and Swiss citizens do not need a residence permit (Make it in Germany – Prospects after graduation).
- 🌍 Citizens of the § 41 AufenthV countries (e.g. USA, Canada, Japan, UK) may take up any employment and apply for the permit in Germany (§ 26 BeschV). ⚠️

3. Steps

1. **Act in time:** apply for the new permit **before your study permit expires** (Make it in Germany). → 10. Residence permit
2. **Job-seeker residence:** up to **18 months** to find a job matching your qualification (§ 20 AufenthG). During these 18 months any work is allowed, and the permit **cannot be extended** (Make it in Germany).
3. **Requirements:** successful degree, health insurance and secured living costs (Make it in Germany; § 20 AufenthG).
4. **With a job offer:** a qualified job offer lets you get a residence permit for skilled workers or a Blue Card. The job need not match your subject, except for the Blue Card; regulated professions need a licence (Make it in Germany).

5. **EU Blue Card:** university degree, employment contract of at least six months, and an annual salary of at least 50% of the pension-insurance contribution ceiling; 45.3% for graduates within three years of their degree and shortage occupations (§ 18g AufenthG). 2026 amounts: **€50,700** and, for recent graduates and shortage occupations, **€45,934.20** per year (Make it in Germany – EU Blue Card (PDF)).
6. **Permanent residence (Niederlassungserlaubnis):** for those who studied in Germany, after **two years** with a skilled-work permit or Blue Card and **24 months** of pension contributions, plus "sufficient German" and other conditions (§ 18c AufenthG). Blue Card holders can qualify sooner with B1 German (§ 18c (2) AufenthG).
7. **Naturalisation:** since 2024 German citizenship is possible after 5 years of legal residence (with conditions), and multiple citizenship is generally allowed (BAMF – Naturalisation in Germany). ⚠️ Rules may change; check the current law. 🌍 Whether you may keep your original citizenship also depends on your home country's law.
8. **Doctorate or vocational training** are further ways to stay; each has its own residence permit (Make it in Germany).
9. **Self-employment after graduation** → 44. Starting a business

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Degree certificate	Required	—	Make it in Germany
Health insurance	Required	—	Make it in Germany
Proof of living costs	Required (job-seeker permit)	—	§ 20 AufenthG
Employment contract or job offer	Required (Blue Card or work permit)	Blue Card: at least six months	§ 18g AufenthG
Residence permit fee	Required	→ 10. Residence permit	§ 45 AufenthV

5. Responsible office

- **Decision:** Ausländerbehörde → 10. Residence permit
- **Job search:** the university Career Service → 45. Career service; Federal Employment Agency (Bundesagentur für Arbeit) (Make it in Germany)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Make it in Germany – Prospects after graduation	Federal Government – Make it in Germany	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	§ 26 BeschV	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	§ 20 AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
4	§ 18g AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	Make it in Germany – EU Blue Card (PDF)	Federal Government – Make it in Germany	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	§ 18c (2) AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	BAMF – Naturalisation in Germany	Federal Office for Migration and Refugees (BAMF)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened (the former BMI page returned “page not found” after the BMI site redesign; replaced)
8	§ 45 AufenthV	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

47. Finishing Your Studies and Leaving Germany — Abmeldung

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 5 — Work, Finance & Career · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Finishing your studies or leaving Germany has its own paperwork. If it is not done, bills and contracts may continue after you leave. This page lists what to do.

2. Who needs this?

- Students who have finished or are leaving Germany — and those just moving to another city (new registration → 5. Registering your address).

3. Steps

1. **Deregister your address (Abmeldung):** if you are not moving to a new address in Germany, deregister within **two weeks** of moving out; at the earliest one week before (§ 17 BMG). In the city of Hannover this is **free** (hannover.gov.de – Deregistration). Keep the deregistration certificate — banks, insurers and the broadcasting fee service ask for it.
2. **Broadcasting fee:** deregister (Rundfunkbeitrag – Deregister). → 9. Tax ID and official letters
3. **Contracts:** cancel phone, internet, electricity and gym in time; phone and internet contracts can be cancelled with one month's notice after the minimum term (Verbraucherzentrale). → 32. Contracts
4. **Housing:** give notice according to your contract and get your deposit back. ℹ️ The notice period is in your contract (usually three months for private flats). → 4. Accommodation
5. **Health insurance:** tell your insurer that you are finishing or leaving. ℹ️ Student insurance ends after de-registration from the university; ask your insurer for details. → 7. Health insurance
6. **University:** de-registration (Exmatrikulation) and returning library items. → 19. Leave and withdrawal
7. **Bank account and tax:** close the account after the last bills are paid and check a tax return for your final year to reclaim overpaid tax. → 6. Bank account, 42. Tax

8. **Blocked account:** close it with your provider once you no longer need it; any remaining balance is paid out. ℹ️
9. 🌍 **Pension contributions refund:** non-EU citizens who leave Germany permanently can usually apply for a refund of their own pension contributions after **24 months** outside Germany — **not** if you are from a country with a social security agreement that counts German periods (e.g. USA, Canada, India, Japan, Korea, Türkiye) or an EU/EEA country (Deutsche Rentenversicherung – Refund of contributions (German)). ⚠️ Check your case with the DRV.
10. **If you want to stay in Germany** → 46. After graduation

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Deregistration	Required (leaving Germany)	Free	hannover.gov.de
ID card or passport	Required	For the Abmeldung	⚠️ See the city page for the full list
Cancelling contracts	Required	According to each contract's notice period	Verbraucherzentrale

5. Responsible office

- **Deregistration:** citizens' offices (Bürgerämter) of the city of Hannover → 5. Registering your address (hannover.gov.de)
- **Broadcasting fee:** ARD ZDF Deutschlandradio Beitragsservice — rundfunkbeitrag.de
- **Pension refund:** Deutsche Rentenversicherung — deutsche-rentenversicherung.de

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	§ 17 BMG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
2	hannover.gov.de – Deregistration	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Rundfunkbeitrag – Deregister	ARD ZDF Deutschlandradio Beitragsservice	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Verbraucherzentrale	Verbraucherzentrale	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	Deutsche Rentenversicherung – Refund of contributions (German)	Deutsche Rentenversicherung	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	rundfunkbeitrag.de	ARD ZDF Deutschlandradio Beitragsservice	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	deutsche-rentenversicherung.de	Deutsche Rentenversicherung	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

Section 6 — Student Community & Engagement

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-10-24 · Back to the handbook contents

Programmes for international students, student groups, volunteering and student representation.

Pages in this section

- 48. Programmes for international students at LUH — Study-Buddy, Senior Student Partnership, events and excursions
- 49. International and country-based student groups — student associations, AStA, ESN and founding your own group
- 50. Volunteering — volunteering at the university and in the city
- 51. Events and networking — Erstival, O-Woche, Start Smart and networking
- 52. Student representation — StuRa, AStA, Fachschaften and elections

48. Programmes for International Students at LUH — Study-Buddy, Senior Student Partnership and More

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 6 — Student Community & Engagement · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

LUH runs several support and mentoring programmes specifically for international students. This page collects them in one place so you can sign up early — ideally before you arrive.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** international degree students (EU and non-EU), especially in the first two semesters.
- German and senior international students who want to volunteer as buddies or mentors.

3. Steps

1. **Study-Buddy:** the International Office pairs new international students with students already at LUH, who help with first steps and show you around; local and international students sign up separately (LUH – Study-Buddy). ℹ️ Register as soon as you have your admission letter.
2. **Senior Student Partnership:** peer mentoring in which experienced students support international newcomers during their studies (LUH – Senior Student Partnership).
3. **Care services overview:** all support offers for international students (LUH – Care services).
4. **Orientation Days, Start Smart and STEPin** → 51. Events and networking
5. **Events and excursions** for international students (city tours, trips, cultural evenings) (LUH – Events and excursions).
6. **International Day:** an annual event presenting international opportunities at LUH (LUH – International Day).
7. **EasyStartLUH:** a personal digital roadmap for your study start (EasyStartLUH).
8. **Information for international graduates:** what to do at the end of your studies (LUH – After your studies). → 46. After graduation

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Registration	Possible	Online form for Study-Buddy	LUH
Cost	—	ℹ️ Free; excursions may have a small fee	—

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Hochschulbüro für Internationales – Welcome Centre
- **Address:** Welfengarten 1A, 30167 Hannover, building 1106
- **Contact:** incoming-student@uni-hannover.de · +49 511 762 188 99 (LUH – International students)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Study-Buddy	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – Senior Student Partnership	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	LUH – Care services	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	LUH – Events and excursions	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – International Day	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	EasyStartLUH	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	LUH – After your studies	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	LUH – International students	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

49. International and Country-Based Student Groups

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 6 — Student Community & Engagement · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Groups and programmes that connect international students with each other and with German students — including associations for students from a particular country or region.

2. Who needs this?

- International students and anyone interested in cultural exchange.
- 🌍 Students who want to meet people from their own country or language community.

3. Steps

1. **List of registered student groups** (cultural, international, religious, political, subject-related): Student associations (LUH – Study checklist). 🌍 Students from many countries and regions have formed their own associations — search the list for your country, region or language, or ask AStA.
2. **AStA's international department:** supports international student groups and the foreign students' commission (AusländerInnenkommission) and organises intercultural events (AStA). → 24. AStA
3. **Erasmus Student Network (ESN):** organises events and trips for exchange and international students in many university cities (ESN – Find a section). ⚠️ Check whether a Hannover section is currently active.
4. **Study-Buddy:** the International Office's intercultural exchange programme (Study-Buddy). → 48. Programmes for international students
5. **Language tandem** → 35. Learning German
6. **Founding your own group:** student groups can register with the university and get support from AStA (rooms, funding for events) (LUH – Student associations).
7. **Communities outside the university** (cultural associations, religious communities, consulates) → 64. Religion, food and home communities
8. ℹ️ Know an active group that is missing? Add it via page 57.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
—	—	ℹ️ Most programmes are free; ask before registering.	—

5. Responsible office

- **AStA – International students:** Welfengarten 2c, 30167 Hannover · international@asta-hannover.de (AStA)
- **Study-Buddy:** Hochschulbüro für Internationales (LUH)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Student associations	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	AStA	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	ESN – Find a section	esn.org	2026-11-03	⚠️ Bot protection (Cloudflare challenge) — open in a browser
5	Study-Buddy	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

50. Volunteering and Getting Involved at University

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 6 — Student Community & Engagement · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Ways to volunteer at the university and in the city — to help others, practise German, build a network and strengthen your CV.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students.

3. Steps

1. **Become a Study-Buddy** and help new international students (Study-Buddy).
2. **Join student groups or AStA** (Student associations). → 49. International student groups
3. **Get involved in your Fachschaft.** → 20. Fachschaft
4. **A-Team:** student-to-student contact point on discrimination (ChancenVielfalt). → 27. ChancenVielfalt
5. **Help maintain this handbook** — fix information or add your experience. → 57. Suggestions and experiences
6. **Sustainability projects** in the ZQS key-skills programme, with ECTS credits (ZQS – Key competencies).
7. **Volunteering in Hannover:** the city's volunteer phone line run by Freiwilligenzentrum Hannover: **0800 330 20 30** (free; Mon 10:00–18:00, Wed and Thu 14:00–18:00) · the city's volunteer network HannoNetz: hannonetz.de · 0511 168-41825 (hannover.de – Volunteer phone line).

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
—	—	Volunteering is free.	—

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Residence permit	Possible	🌍 ℹ️ Paid volunteering or an expense allowance may count as work for non-EU students; ask the Ausländerbehörde. → 40. Student jobs	—

5. Responsible office

- **AStA Hannover:** Welfengarten 2c, 30167 Hannover · info@asta-hannover.de
- **International Office (Study-Buddy):** incoming-student@uni-hannover.de
- **Freiwilligenzentrum Hannover:** 0800 330 20 30 (hannover.de)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Study-Buddy	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Student associations	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	ChancenVielfalt	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	ZQS – Key competencies	ZQS, Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	hannonetz.de	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	hannover.de – Volunteer phone line	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

51. Events, Networking and Meeting Other Students

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 6 — Student Community & Engagement · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Finding friends and a professional network in your first months — loneliness is one of the most common problems for new students (ptb).

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students, especially in the first semester.

3. Steps

1. **Erstival:** the central welcome event where the university president greets new students; the invitation comes with your enrolment documents (LUH – Study checklist; Erstival).
2. **Orientation week (O-Woche)** and **Orientation Days** for international students (Orientation Days).
3. **Networking from day one:** the university's page Making contacts (LUH – Study checklist).
4. **Start Smart:** online events for first-year Bachelor's and Master's students; some need registration (Start Smart).
5. **AStA intercultural events** (AStA) and **Career Dates** for professional networking (LUH – ZQS). → 45. Career service
6. **International Office events and excursions** → 48. Programmes for international students
7. **University social media:** Instagram @uni_hannover and LinkedIn (LUH – Study checklist).
8. **Country and culture groups** → 49. International student groups

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Prior registration	Possible	For some Start Smart events	LUH

5. Responsible office

- **International orientation events:** Hochschulbüro für Internationales — incoming-student@uni-hannover.de · +49 511 762 188 99
- **Start Smart:** Central Student Advisory Service and International Office (LUH – Study checklist)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	ptb	ptb – psychological counselling	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Erstival	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Orientation Days	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	Making contacts	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	Start Smart	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	AStA	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	LUH – ZQS	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	Instagram @uni_hannover	instagram.com	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	LinkedIn	linkedin.com	2026-10-26	⚠️ Blocks automated checks — open in a browser

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

52. Student Participation and Representation in University Bodies

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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💬 About this page: 🐞 Report an error or broken link · 💡 Suggest an idea · ✍️ Share an experience · ✏️ Edit it yourself

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 6 — Student Community & Engagement · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

In Germany students have a **share and representatives** in running the university. This page explains the structure of student representation at LUH and how to take part.

2. Who needs this?

- Students who want student voices — including international students' voices — to be heard.
- **Voting rights:** all enrolled students, **regardless of nationality**, can vote in student elections (LUH – Bodies & committees).

3. Steps

1. **Student body (Studierendenschaft):** all students are members, and part of the semester fee (€15.80) goes to it (LUH – Re-registration).
2. **Student Council (Studentischer Rat, StuRa):** a kind of student parliament made up of representatives of the faculties' Fachschaft councils and members elected directly by all students. Elections are online, and terms last two semesters (LUH – Bodies & committees; Student body election rules (PDF)).
3. **AStA:** the executive committee of the student body; it is not elected directly by students but by the StuRa, to which it is accountable (LUH – Bodies & committees). → 24. AStA
4. **Fachschaft and Fachrat:** student representation for each subject; Fachschaft councils are elected in the student elections (Fachschaften). → 20. Fachschaft
5. **Foreign students' commission (AusländerInnenkommission):** supported by AStA; advises university committees on improving the situation of international students (AStA).
6. **University bodies (Senate and faculty councils):** include student representatives. ⚠️ Check the number of seats and election dates at Bodies & committees.
7. **Statutes and regulations:** AStA – Statutes and regulations.

8. 🌍 **Political activity:** non-EU citizens enjoy freedom of expression and assembly in Germany; political activity at university is legal. ℹ️ If you fear consequences from your home country's authorities, talk confidentially to the International Office or AStA.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Enrolment	Required	To vote and stand for election	LUH
Student body contribution	Required	€15.80 in the semester fee	LUH

5. Responsible office

- **Official name:** Studierendenschaft der Leibniz Universität Hannover, with StuRa and AStA
- **AStA address:** Welfengarten 2c, 30167 Hannover
- **Contact:** info@asta-hannover.de
- **Source:** LUH – Bodies & committees

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Bodies & committees	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – Re-registration	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Student body election rules (PDF)	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Fachschaften	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	AStA	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	AStA – Statutes and regulations	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

Section 7 — Resources & Appendices

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-10-26 · Back to the handbook contents

Glossary, checklists, contacts, FAQ and student experiences.

Pages in this section

- 53. German–English glossary — German terms with English explanations
- 54. Checklist — from applying to graduation
- 55. Official links and contacts — all addresses and numbers in one place
- 56. FAQ — short answers to common questions
- 57. Suggestions and experiences — share experiences and report errors
- 65. Annual student calendar — deadlines, holidays and recurring events
- 66. Passport, documents, certified translations and certified copies — embassy, sworn translators, ZAB, Beglaubigung
- 67. Consumer rights, scams and free legal help — right of withdrawal, Mahnbescheid, Legal Clinic
- 68. GitHub guide — how to contribute — issues and pull requests, step by step with pictures

53. German–English Glossary of Administrative and University Terms

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 7 — Resources & Appendices · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

German administrative and university terms you will see in letters, forms and websites, with an English explanation and the related page in this handbook.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** newcomers.

3. Glossary

Administration and residence

German	English	Page
Anmeldung	Registration of your address	5. Registering your address
Bürgeramt / Einwohnermeldeamt	Citizens' office / residents' registration office	5. Registering your address
Meldebescheinigung	Registration certificate	5. Registering your address
Wohnungsgeberbestätigung	Landlord's confirmation of residence	5. Registering your address
Ausländerbehörde	Foreigners' authority (immigration office)	10. Residence permit
Aufenthaltserlaubnis / eAT	Residence permit / electronic residence permit card	10. Residence permit
Fiktionsbescheinigung	Certificate that your stay remains lawful while your application is processed	10. Residence permit

German	English	Page
Sperrkonto	Blocked account	2. Before you arrive
Finanzierungsnachweis	Proof of financial resources	2. Before you arrive
Verpflichtungserklärung	Formal obligation letter by a third party to cover your costs	2. Before you arrive
Auslandsvertretung / Botschaft / Konsulat	German mission abroad / embassy / consulate	2. Before you arrive
APS (Akademische Prüfstelle)	Academic Evaluation Centre (China, India, Vietnam)	61. Visa-required countries & APS
Beglaubigung / Apostille	Certification / apostille (legalisation of documents)	11. Family
Termin	Appointment	—

Housing and everyday life

German	English	Page
Kaution	Rent deposit	4. Accommodation
WG (Wohngemeinschaft)	Shared flat	4. Accommodation
Zwischenmiete	Sublet	4. Accommodation
Kaltmiete / Warmmiete / Nebenkosten	Basic rent / rent incl. utilities / service charges	4. Accommodation
Hausordnung	House rules	36. Waste and house rules
Sperrmüll	Bulky waste	36. Waste and house rules
Pfand	Bottle deposit	31. Shopping
Girokonto / Basiskonto	Current account / basic payment account	6. Bank account
Rundfunkbeitrag	Broadcasting fee	9. Tax ID and official letters
Steuer-ID	Tax identification number	9. Tax ID and official letters

Insurance and health

German	English	Page
Krankenversicherung / Krankenkasse	Health insurance / health insurer	7. Health insurance
Haftpflichtversicherung	Personal liability insurance	2. Before you arrive
Hausarzt	General practitioner (family doctor)	33. Doctors and pharmacies
Überweisung	Referral (to a specialist) — also "bank transfer"	33. Doctors and pharmacies
Rezept	Prescription	33. Doctors and pharmacies
Zuzahlung	Co-payment	33. Doctors and pharmacies
Notdienst	Emergency / on-call service	37. Emergency numbers

University

German	English	Page
Zulassung / Zulassungsbescheid	Admission / admission letter	12. Admission and enrolment
Immatrikulation / Einschreibung	Enrolment	12. Admission and enrolment
Immatrikulationsbescheinigung	Enrolment certificate	13. Semester fee and LeibnizCard
Rückmeldung	Re-registration each semester	13. Semester fee and LeibnizCard
Semesterbeitrag	Semester fee	13. Semester fee and LeibnizCard
Langzeitstudiengebühr	Long-term study fee	13. Semester fee and LeibnizCard
Exmatrikulation	De-registration from the university	19. Leave and withdrawal
Fakultät / Institut	Faculty / institute	15. Faculties
Prüfungsordnung	Examination regulations	16. Programme structure
Vorlesungsverzeichnis	Course catalogue	16. Programme structure
Vorlesung / Übung / Seminar	Lecture / exercise class / seminar	16. Programme structure
Pflichtmodul / Wahlmodul	Compulsory module / elective module	16. Programme structure
O-Woche	Orientation week	16. Programme structure
Prüfungsamt	Examinations office	18. Exams
Nachteilsausgleich	Disadvantage compensation (adjusted exam conditions)	18. Exams
Fachschaft / Fachrat	Subject student council	20. Fachschaft
Studentenwerk	Student services organisation	23. Studentenwerk
AStA	General Students' Committee	24. AStA
Studentischer Rat (StuRa)	Student Council (student parliament)	52. Student representation
Mensa	Student canteen	28. Mensa
Studienkolleg / Feststellungsprüfung	Preparatory college / university-entrance assessment exam	1. Applying

Work and money

German	English	Page
HiWi (studentische Hilfskraft)	Student assistant	40. Student jobs
Werkstudent	Working student	40. Student jobs
Minijob	Job paying up to €603 per month (2026)	40. Student jobs
Lebenslauf / Anschreiben	CV / cover letter	41. Job search and CV
Grundfreibetrag	Basic tax-free allowance	42. Tax and payslips

German	English	Page
Steuererklärung	Tax return	42. Tax and payslips
Stipendium	Scholarship	43. Scholarships

Application, family, travel and graduation

German	English	Page
Bewerbung / Bewerbungsfrist	Application / application deadline	1. Applying
VPD (Vorprüfungsdokumentation)	Preliminary review documentation by uni-assist	1. Applying
Zeugnisbewertung	Statement of comparability (ZAB)	1. Applying
Familiennachzug	Family reunification	11. Family
Beurlaubung / Urlaubssemester	Leave of absence / leave semester	19. Leave and withdrawal
Studiengangwechsel	Change of programme	19. Leave and withdrawal
Führerschein / Umschreibung	Driving licence / conversion of a foreign licence	38. Driving licence
Schengen-Raum	Schengen area	39. Travelling in Europe
Blaue Karte EU	EU Blue Card	46. After graduation
Niederlassungserlaubnis	Permanent residence permit	46. After graduation
Einbürgerung	Naturalisation	46. After graduation
Abmeldung	Deregistration of your address	47. Leaving Germany
Aufenthaltsgestattung / Duldung	Permission to stay during asylum procedure / tolerated stay	63. Refugees and protection status

More terms: Hochschullexikon – studieren in Niedersachsen (German; recommended in the LUH – Study checklist).

Rights, documents and legal help

German	English	Page
Basiskonto	Basic payment account every legal EU resident is entitled to	6. Bank account
Untermiete	Sublet from a tenant (needs the landlord's permission)	4. Accommodation
Widerrufsrecht	14-day right of withdrawal from a contract	67. Consumer rights
Kündigungsfrist	Notice period for ending a contract	67. Consumer rights
Inkasso	Debt-collection agency	67. Consumer rights
Mahnbescheid	Court payment order (object within two weeks)	67. Consumer rights

German	English	Page
Anzeige	Police report / criminal complaint	67. Consumer rights
Beglaubigung / beglaubigte Kopie	Certification / certified copy	66. Documents
Apostille / Legalisation	Confirmation that a foreign public document is genuine	66. Documents
beeidigte(r) Übersetzer(in)	Sworn (certified) translator	66. Documents
Zeugnisbewertung (ZAB)	Evaluation of a foreign degree	66. Documents
Arbeitsunfähigkeitsbescheinigung (AU)	Sick note for your employer	33. Doctors
Überweisung	Referral to a specialist (also: bank transfer)	33. Doctors
Bonusheft	Dental bonus booklet	33. Doctors
Notaufnahme	Hospital emergency department	33. Doctors
Warntag	Nationwide test of the warning system	37. Emergency

4. Documents and costs

- None.

5. Responsible office

- Maintained by the handbook contributors. Suggest a new term → 57. Suggestions and experiences

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Hochschullexikon – studieren in Niedersachsen	studieren-in-niedersachsen.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

54. Checklist — Before Arrival, First Week, First Month and First Semester

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 7 — Resources & Appendices · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

An ordered checklist of essential tasks from before departure to the end of your first semester; each item links to its full page. Based on the university's Study checklist and the pages of this handbook.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** newcomers. Items marked **(non-EU)** apply only to students without EU/EEA citizenship; items marked **(visa)** apply to visa-required nationalities only.

3. Checklist

Before you travel

- ☐ Find out which rules apply to your nationality → 58. Which rules apply to you?
- ☐ Apply by the deadline and get a VPD from uni-assist (non-EU) → 1. Applying
- ☐ APS certificate (China, India, Vietnam) → 61. Visa-required countries & APS
- ☐ If your family is coming: requirements and timing → 11. Family
- ☐ Book a visa appointment and get a national type D visa (visa) → 2. Before you arrive
- ☐ Blocked account or other proof of finances (non-EU) → 2. Before you arrive
- ☐ Travel or health insurance; EHIC for EU students → 7. Health insurance
- ☐ Search and book accommodation → 4. Accommodation
- ☐ Pay the semester fee and upload your photo → 12. Enrolment, 13. Semester fee
- ☐ Sign up for Study-Buddy → 48. Programmes for international students

First week

- ☐ Get the Wohnungsgeberbestätigung from your landlord → 5. Registering your address
- ☐ Book and attend the Anmeldung (within two weeks of moving in) → 5. Registering your address

- ☐ SIM card → 8. SIM card and internet
- ☐ Join statutory health insurance and have the M10 sent → 7. Health insurance
- ☐ Complete enrolment → 12. Enrolment

First month

- ☐ Open a bank account → 6. Bank account
- ☐ Apply for a residence permit before your visa expires / within 90 days (non-EU, and Swiss) → 10. Residence permit
- ☐ Activate IdM, Wi-Fi and Stud.IP → 17. Online systems
- ☐ Get your semester ticket → 30. Public transport
- ☐ Activate your TIB library card → 14. Campus and buildings
- ☐ Attend O-Woche and Orientation Days → 16. Programme structure, 51. Events
- ☐ Download your examination regulations and plan your timetable → 16. Programme structure
- ☐ Register for language or sports courses → 26. Language Centre, 34. Sports and culture
- ☐ Save the emergency numbers and find your embassy/consulate → 37. Emergency numbers

First semester

- ☐ Register for exams in time → 18. Exams
- ☐ Follow up on your Steuer-ID if it hasn't arrived after three months → 9. Tax ID
- ☐ Register for the Rundfunkbeitrag (once per dwelling) → 9. Tax ID
- ☐ Pay next semester's fee (Rückmeldung) → 13. Semester fee
- ☐ Re-validate your LeibnizCard for the second semester → 13. Semester fee
- ☐ Convert your driving licence within six months if needed (non-EU) → 38. Driving licence

End of studies

- ☐ Apply for a job-seeker permit or Blue Card before your study permit expires (non-EU) → 46. After graduation
- ☐ Deregister your address, Rundfunkbeitrag and contracts when leaving Germany → 47. Leaving Germany

4. Documents and costs

- See each item's page.

5. Responsible office

- General questions: ServiceCenter (+49 511 762 2020) and Welcome Centre (+49 511 762 188 99) → 21. ServiceCenter, 22. International Office

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	university's Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

55. Official Links and Contacts

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 7 — Resources & Appendices · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

All addresses, phone numbers and official links from this handbook in one place.

2. Who needs this?

- **Everyone.**

3. Contacts

University

Office	Address	Contact	Page
ServiceCenter	Welfengarten 1, 30167 Hannover (building 1101)	+49 511 762 2020 · studium@uni-hannover.de	21. ServiceCenter
Central Student Advisory Service (ZSB)	ServiceCenter	+49 511 762 5580 · studienberatung@uni-hannover.de	29. Counselling
Welcome Centre / International Office	Welfengarten 1A, building 1106, room 034	+49 511 762 188 99 · incoming-student@uni-hannover.de	22. International Office
Psychological counselling (ptb)	Im Moore 13, 30167 Hannover	+49 511 762-3799 · info@ptb.uni-hannover.de	29. Counselling
Leibniz Language Centre	Im Moore 11B, 30167 Hannover (building 1138)	+49 511 762 4914	26. Language Centre
ZQS / Career Service	Callinstraße 14, 30167 Hannover (building 3428)	+49 511 762 14150	25. ZQS

Office	Address	Contact	Page
ChancenVielfalt	Wilhelm-Busch-Straße 4, 30167 Hannover	0511 762 5750 · beratung@chancenvielfalt.uni-hannover.de	27. ChancenVielfalt
Hochschulsport	Am Moritzwinkel 6, 30167 Hannover	—	34. Sports and culture
starting business	—	info@starting-business.de	44. Starting a business
Certification office (Beglaubigungsstelle)	Building 1101, room A112	beglaubigungsstelle@zuv.uni-hannover.de	66. Documents
Legal Clinic (Faculty of Law)	—	contact form	67. Consumer rights

Student bodies

Office	Address	Contact	Page
AStA (international department)	Welfengarten 2c, 30167 Hannover	international@asta-hannover.de	24. AStA
AStA (semester ticket)	Welfengarten 2c, 30167 Hannover	semesterticket@asta-hannover.de	30. Public transport
Studentenwerk Hannover	Jägerstraße 5, 30167 Hannover	info@studentenwerk-hannover.de	23. Studentenwerk
Studentenwerk halls	Jägerstraße 5, 30167 Hannover	wohnen@studentenwerk-hannover.de	4. Accommodation
Studentenwerk canteens	—	mensen@studentenwerk-hannover.de · 0511 76-88969	28. Mensa

City and other offices

Office	Address	Contact	Page
Bürgeramt Aegi	Aegidientorplatz 1, 30159 Hannover	+49 511 168-32000 · buergeramt-aegi@hannover-stadt.de	5. Registering your address
City Ausländerbehörde (Willkommensservice)	Am Schützenplatz 1, 30169 Hannover	online portal	10. Residence permit
Polizeidirektion Hannover	Waterloostraße 9, 30169 Hannover	0511 109-0	37. Emergency numbers
Verbraucherzentrale	Landschaftstraße 3, 30159 Hannover	0511 91196-0	32. Contracts, 67. Consumer rights
Employment agency – career guidance for students	Escherstraße 17, 30159 Hannover	online booking	41. Job search
Volkshochschule Hannover	Burgstraße 14, 30159 Hannover	integration.vhs@hannover-stadt.de	35. Learning German
aha (waste)	—	0800 999 11 99 (free)	36. Waste and house rules

Office	Address	Contact	Page
Freiwilligenzentrum	—	0800 330 20 30 (free)	50. Volunteering
City driving licence office (32.12 Fahrerlaubnisbehörde)	Am Schützenplatz 1, 30169 Hannover	32.12Terminvergabe@Hannover-Stadt.de	38. Driving licence
German missions abroad (visa)	—	list of missions	2. Before you arrive
Foreign embassies and consulates in Germany	—	Federal Foreign Office – Missions of other states in Germany	64. Religion, food and home communities
uni-assist (application review)	—	uni-assist.de	1. Applying

Emergency numbers → 37. Emergency numbers

Situation	Number
Ambulance and fire brigade	112
Police	110
On-call doctor	116117
Emotional crisis (TelefonSeelsorge)	0800 111 0 111 · 0800 111 0 222 · 116 123
Violence against women	116 016
On-duty pharmacy	Online search: aponet.de

Frequently used links

- Study checklist · International first-semester students · Entry and Residence — Leibniz University Hannover
- Semester dates · Re-registration · Online services — Leibniz University Hannover
- Standortfinder — university map
- First Steps in Germany — Studentenwerk Hannover
- Bürgeramt appointments — City of Hannover
- Make it in Germany — official portal for international professionals and students
- Study in Germany (DAAD) — DAAD's official portal for international students
- uestra.de (GVH) · aha-region.de · 116117.de

4. Documents and costs

- None.

5. Responsible office

- Maintained by the handbook contributors; report broken links on 57. Suggestions and experiences.

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	contact form	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	online portal	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	online booking	Federal Employment Agency	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	list of missions	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	Federal Foreign Office – Missions of other states in Germany	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	uni-assist.de	uni-assist	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	International first-semester students	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	Entry and Residence	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	Semester dates	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
11	Re-registration	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
12	Online services	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
13	Standortfinder	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
14	First Steps in Germany	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
15	Bürgeramt appointments	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
16	Make it in Germany	Federal Government – Make it in Germany	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
17	Study in Germany (DAAD)	DAAD	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
18	uestra.de (GVH)	ÜSTRA / GVH	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
19	aha-region.de	aha – Region Hannover waste management	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
20	116117.de	Kassenärztliche Bundesvereinigung	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

56. Frequently Asked Questions from New Students

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 7 — Resources & Appendices · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Short answers to the questions newcomers ask most, with links to the full pages.

2. Who needs this?

- **Everyone.**

3. Questions and answers

What should I do first? Register your address (Anmeldung) — the bank, Steuer-ID, library and residence permit all depend on it (Studentenwerk). → 5. Registering your address

I don't have a permanent home yet — can I register? Yes, a temporary address works if you have a Wohnungsgeberbestätigung; register again after moving (Studentenwerk; hannover.gov.de). → 5. Registering your address

🌍 **Do I need a visa?** EU/EEA and Swiss citizens: no. Citizens of Australia, Canada, Israel, Japan, New Zealand, South Korea, the UK and the USA (and, for study only, Andorra, Brazil, El Salvador, Honduras, Monaco and San Marino) can enter without a visa and apply for a residence permit in Germany. Everyone else needs a national type D visa (§ 41 AufenthV; LUH – Entry and Residence). → 58. Which rules apply to you?

How much money do I need to show? For 2026, €992 per month (€11,904 per year), usually in a blocked account (German missions in Italy). → 2. Before you arrive

How much is the semester fee? €453.16 for winter 2026/27, including the semester ticket (LUH). → 13. Semester fee

Are there tuition fees? No, apart from the semester fee — for both EU and non-EU students. Only if your "study credit" runs out (usually after 12 semesters for a Bachelor's) is a long-term fee of €500 per semester charged (LUH – Study costs). → 13. Semester fee

How much is health insurance per month? About €146–151 for statutory student insurance in 2026 (BARMER). 🌍 EU students with an EHIC may be exempt. → 7. Health insurance

How much can I work? 🌍 Non-EU students: 140 working days per year (half days and weekly counting possible); student-assistant jobs at the university don't count. EU students: no residence-law limit (§ 16b AufenthG). → 40. Student jobs

My permit is expiring and there is no decision on my extension yet. If you applied before it expired, your previous permit stays valid until the decision and you receive a Fiktionsbescheinigung (§ 81 AufenthG). → 10. Residence permit

Can I get BAföG? Usually not, with exceptions for some EU citizens, refugees and long-term residents (LUH – Study checklist). Other aid → 43. Scholarships

Where is the semester ticket valid? On local and regional transport throughout Germany; IC and ICE trains are not included (AStA). → 30. Public transport

I forgot my LUH-ID password. Go to the Infothek in the ServiceCenter (LUH – Study checklist). → 17. Online systems

I'm not feeling well and feel lonely. Free, confidential counselling at ptb (ptb); in an emergency call 112. → 29. Counselling

Can I drive with my foreign licence? 🌍 EU licences: yes. Non-EU licences: for six months after taking up residence, with a translation; after that you must convert it — with or without tests depending on your country (§ 29 FeV). → 38. Driving licence

Can my spouse come? Yes, subject to requirements such as finances and insurance; the application goes through the German mission in your family's country (Make it in Germany). → 11. Family

Can I stay after graduation? Yes — non-EU graduates can get a job-seeker permit for up to 18 months (§ 20 AufenthG). → 46. After graduation

Can I travel to other European countries with my residence card? Yes, up to 90 days in any 180 in Schengen countries, without the right to work (Federal Foreign Office). → 39. Travelling in Europe

🌍 **My country is under sanctions — can I still pay my fees and open accounts?** Usually yes, but transfers may be slow or blocked. → 62. Sanctions and payment restrictions

🌍 **I am a refugee / from Ukraine — can I study?** Yes; there are special advice services and rules. → 63. Refugees and people with protection status **The room ad says "no Anmeldung possible" — should I take it?** Only for the first few weeks. The landlord must legally confirm your move-in within two weeks, and without registration your bank account and residence permit are delayed (§ 19 BMG). → 4. Accommodation

How much cash can I bring to Germany? There is no limit, but €10,000 or more must be declared in writing to customs when you enter from outside the EU (Zoll). → 3. Arriving in Hannover

QIS showed an error when I registered for an exam. E-mail your faculty's examinations contact immediately and include your phone number; late registration is not accepted. → 18. Exams

Where can I see all important deadlines of the year? → 65. Annual student calendar

The bank won't open an account for me. Try another branch or bank. Everyone legally resident in the EU has the right to a basic account, and the bank must respond within ten business days (§ 31 ZKG). → 6. Bank account

I signed a contract online or at my door and regret it. You usually have a 14-day right of withdrawal and don't need to give a reason (§ 355 BGB). → 67. Consumer rights and free legal help

Where can I get free legal advice? The Law Faculty's Legal Clinic advises LUH students free of charge (Legal Clinic). → 67

Where can I get certified copies of my university documents? At the university's Beglaubigungsstelle — free, by appointment (LUH – Certification office). → 66. Documents, translations and certified copies

My passport is about to expire. Renew it at your country's embassy or consulate before applying to extend your residence permit. → 66

I want to invite my parents to visit. The host signs a Verpflichtungserklärung at the Ausländerbehörde; fee €29 (City of Hannover). → 11. Family

I'm turning 30 — what happens to my student health insurance? Compulsory student insurance ends at the latest at 30 (§ 5 SGB V). Ask your insurer early. → 7. Health insurance

I saw the doctor late — can the sick note be backdated? Only exceptionally, usually by up to three days. → 33. Doctors

How do I find a doctor who speaks English? Use the language filter of the official 116117 doctor search. → 33. Doctors

4. Documents and costs

- See each topic's page.

5. Responsible office

- If your question isn't here: ServiceCenter or Welcome Centre → 21. ServiceCenter, 22. International Office

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Studentenwerk	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	hannover.gov.de	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	§ 41 AufenthV	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	LUH – Entry and Residence	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	German missions in Italy	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	LUH	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	LUH – Study costs	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	BARMER	BARMER	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	§ 16b AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	§ 81 AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
11	LUH – Study checklist	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
12	AStA	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
13	ptb	ptb – psychological counselling	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
14	§ 29 FeV	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
15	Make it in Germany	Federal Government – Make it in Germany	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
16	§ 20 AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
17	Federal Foreign Office	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
18	§ 19 BMG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
19	Zoll	German Customs	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
20	§ 31 ZKG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
21	§ 355 BGB	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
22	Legal Clinic	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
23	LUH – Certification office	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
24	City of Hannover	City of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
25	§ 5 SGB V	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

57. Suggestions and Student Experiences

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 7 — Resources & Appendices · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

A place for real student experiences and suggestions to improve the handbook. **Personal experience is kept separate from official information** and is not a general rule or legal advice.

2. Who needs this?

- All readers — and anyone with an experience or correction to share. Experiences from students of **every nationality** are welcome, especially country-specific tips (visa waiting times, document legalisation, banking) for Section 8.

3. How to contribute

1. **Report an error or broken link:** open a GitHub issue with the page number, a description and the correct source.
2. **Add an experience:** use the template below in a GitHub issue or pull request, or in the "7. Student experiences" section of the relevant page.
3. **Date every experience** — rules change.
4. **Don't post personal data** (passport numbers, exact addresses, etc.).
5. ⚠️ **items** on the pages need confirmation or completion; if you have an official source, add it.

Experience template

Field	Example
Related page	10. Residence permit
Your nationality (optional)	e.g. "Brazilian" — helps others with the same rules
Date	October 2026
Experience	What happened, how long it took, what helped

Field	Example
Name (optional)	Your name or "anonymous"

4. Documents and costs

- None; contributing is free.

Experiences

- No experiences added yet.

5. Responsible office

- **Handbook maintainers:** review experiences and corrections and move them into the main pages — via GitHub issues.

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	GitHub issues	github.com	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

65. Annual Student Calendar — Deadlines, Holidays and Recurring Events

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 7 — Resources & Appendices · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

All the deadlines and events that come back every year, in one month-by-month table. Most reminders in student group chats are about exactly these dates.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** LUH students, especially in their first semesters.
- Student groups planning reminders and events.

3. Steps

1. The "usually" column is based on the years 2024–2026. ℹ️ Always check the exact date for the current year in the official source of that row.
2. Deadlines marked 🔴 are **not extended** and missing them has serious consequences. Set a reminder on your phone for them.

Month	What?	Usually	Page
January	🔴 Pay the summer-semester fee (re-registration / Rückmeldung)	By the end of January or 1 February	13
January	Student elections (Studentischer Rat and other bodies) at wahl.uni-hannover.de	Second half of January	52
January	University ball (Hochschulball) in the Lichthof — tickets on sale in November	Late January	34
February–March	Intensive LLC language courses between semesters; placement test	March	26

Month	What?	Usually	Page
March	Orientation days and the Ausländerbehörde's online session for new international students	Late March	22
March	Clocks go forward (summer time) — check the time difference to home	Last Sunday in March	—
1 April	Summer semester starts; 🔴 download the new semester ticket in RIDE	1 April	30
April	Hannover Messe trade fair (sometimes free tickets for students)	April	51
May	🔴 Exam registration for the summer semester in QIS	15–31 May	18
May–June	Stadtradeln cycling challenge and the university sports festival	May–June	34
June–July	🔴 Pay the winter-semester fee (re-registration / Rückmeldung)	Mid-June to about 18/19 July	13
July–August	Deutschlandstipendium applications	About 1 July to 15 August	43
August	Semester-ticket refund from AStA's hardship fund (Semesterticket-Ausfallfonds)	By early or mid-August	30
Summer	Heat waves; Maschseefest and free open-air concerts	July–August	37
September	Registration for the second exam period; winter course schedule in Stud.IP	Mid-September	18
September	Warntag — nationwide test alert at 11:00	Second Thursday in September (9 September 2027)	37
September–October	Orientation days and International Office sessions for new students	Late September and early October	22
1 October	Winter semester starts; 🔴 download the new semester ticket in RIDE	1 October	30
October	Clocks go back (winter time)	Last Sunday in October	—
November	🔴 Exam registration for the winter semester in QIS	Mid to 30 November	18
December–January	Christmas break: no classes, most canteens closed and buildings unheated; TIB libraries usually open	About 21 December to 5 January	28

3. 🌍 **Cultural festivals of student groups** — for example Nowruz (around 20 March) and Yalda night (21 December) celebrated by the Iranian Student Association (ISL) with the International Office — are open to all students; most need registration. → 49. International student groups

Public holidays in Lower Saxony

4. State-wide public holidays: **1 January, Good Friday (Karfreitag), Easter Monday (Ostermontag), 1 May, Ascension Day (Himmelfahrt), Whit Monday (Pfingstmontag), 3 October (German Unity Day), 31 October (Reformation Day), 25 and 26 December** (NFeiertagsG § 2; Draft law on Reformation Day).
5. Shops are closed on these days and on Sundays. When a holiday falls on a Saturday or Monday you may not be able to shop for two or three days in a row — shop in advance. → 31. Shopping

6. Libraries and most university canteens are closed too; check the day before.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Semester fee	Required	Every semester, before the deadline	LUH – Re-registration
Exam registration	Required	During the QIS registration period	Exam information & subject advice

5. Responsible office

- **Semester-fee deadlines:** Immatrikulationsamt / ServiceCenter → 21. ServiceCenter
- **Exam deadlines:** Academic Examinations Office (Akademisches Prüfungsamt) and your faculty → 18. Exams
- **Semester ticket:** AStA (AStA – Semester ticket) → 24. AStA
- **Warning day:** Federal Office of Civil Protection (BBK – Nationwide warning day)

6. Sources and official links

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#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	wahl.uni-hannover.de	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Iranian Student Association (ISL)	t.me	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	NFeiertagsG § 2	umwelt-online.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Draft law on Reformation Day	niedersachsen.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – Re-registration	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	Exam information & subject advice	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	AStA – Semester ticket	AStA Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	BBK – Nationwide warning day	Federal Office of Civil Protection	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **Don't wait for the last day:** a semester-fee payment can take up to a week to show as received, and QIS is overloaded in the last days. Reminders in student chats usually went out a week before the deadline.

66. Passport, Documents, Certified Translations and Certified Copies — Übersetzung & Beglaubigung

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This page is general information, not legal advice. Passport and legalisation rules are set by your own country and by the German mission there, and can change without notice.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 7 — Resources & Appendices · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Questions about **renewing a passport**, **certified translations** and **certified copies** come up again and again. This page explains what is done in Germany, what can only be done in your home country, and where to go.

2. Who needs this?

- Students whose passport is about to expire or must be replaced.
- Anyone who needs a translation or certified copy for the university, the Ausländerbehörde, an insurer, an employer or the driving-licence office.

3. Steps

A) Your passport

1. **Check your passport's validity early.** A German residence permit is usually issued at most until your passport expires, so renew or replace your passport **before** applying to extend your residence permit. → 10. Residence permit ⚠️ Based on student experience; ask the Ausländerbehörde.
2. **Your legal duties:** apply for a new passport **in good time before it expires**, and report a lost passport to the Ausländerbehörde **without delay** (§ 56 AufenthV).
3. 🌍 **Where:** only **your own country's embassy or consulate** can issue a passport. Find it in the Federal Foreign Office's list (Federal Foreign Office – Missions of other states in Germany). Many countries require an online application first and an in-person visit for identification; consulates outside Berlin may offer only some services — check before you travel.

4. 🌍 **Military service, deposits or study obligations** in your home country are decided only by your country's authorities and embassy; ask them before changing anything (e.g. your place of residence in your passport, or travelling home).
5. **After you get a new passport:** your passport number is linked to your residence card. Tell the Ausländerbehörde about the new passport and, until your card is updated, **carry the old passport as well**, especially when travelling. ℹ️ Student experience.

B) Documents from your home country: translation, legalisation and evaluation

1. **Certified translation in Germany:** German offices usually accept translations by a **sworn translator (beeidigte/ermächtigte Übersetzer)**. Search the official joint database of the German state courts by language (justiz-dolmetscher.de).
2. 🌍 **Apostille or legalisation:** whether a foreign document needs an apostille or legalisation depends on the issuing country, and for many countries it can only be done **there**. Ask the German mission in that country (Federal Foreign Office – German missions abroad) and ask the German office or university whether it needs it — before you leave home.
3. **Evaluation of a foreign degree:** for work or further studies, a statement of comparability (Zeugnisbewertung) is issued by the **ZAB**. You apply online with a BundID account; processing takes about three months once all documents are in (ZAB – Statement of comparability). → 1. Applying, 46. After graduation
4. **AI translation** is fine for understanding a document, but it is **not a certified translation**. If an office asks for a certified one, you can send an unofficial translation for now and say that the certified one is on its way. ℹ️ Student experience.

C) Certified copies (Beglaubigung) in Hannover

1. **At the university:** the LUH certification office (Beglaubigungsstelle) certifies **free of charge** documents issued by LUH or needed for use at LUH; Monday–Friday 09:00–12:00, **by appointment only**. Bring the original and a copy; you usually get it back on the spot (LUH – Certification office).
2. **For other purposes:** a Bürgeramt or a notary (Notar), for a fee. ℹ️ Some universities and offices accept only notarised copies — ask the receiving office.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Current passport, ID documents, photos	Required for a new passport	🌍 Your embassy sets the exact list and fee	Missions of other states in Germany
Certified copy at LUH	Possible	Free, by appointment	LUH – Certification office
Sworn translation	Possible	Students reported about €25–30 for a short document such as a driving licence (2025–2026)	⚠️ Unofficial
ZAB statement of comparability	Possible	Online application with BundID	ZAB

5. Responsible office

- **Passport:** your country's embassy or consulate (Federal Foreign Office – Missions of other states in Germany)
- **Certified copies at the university:** Beglaubigungsstelle der Leibniz Universität Hannover, building 1101, room A112 · beglaubigungsstelle@zuv.uni-hannover.de (LUH)
- **Sworn translators:** justiz-dolmetscher.de — joint database of the German state courts
- **Degree evaluation:** Zentralstelle für ausländisches Bildungswesen (ZAB) (ZAB)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	§ 56 AufenthV	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Federal Foreign Office – Missions of other states in Germany	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	justiz-dolmetscher.de	justiz-dolmetscher.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Federal Foreign Office – German missions abroad	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	ZAB – Statement of comparability	KMK / ZAB	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	LUH – Certification office	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **Embassy visits (2025–2026):** several students were seen without an online appointment but had to arrive **very early** and wait until the afternoon. Phones and bags were often handed in at the entrance. Bring copies of everything you uploaded online.
- **Replacing a passport early:** some embassies only replaced passports with less than six months' validity left; others accepted a change of residence as a reason. ⚠️
- **Delivery:** new passports were usually sent by post a few weeks later.
- **Privacy:** never post scans of your passport or your file numbers in public groups.

67. Consumer Rights, Scams and Free Legal Help — Verbraucherrechte & Rechtsberatung

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This page is general information, not legal advice. In any serious dispute, get help from one of the free advice services below before you pay money or sign anything.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 7 — Resources & Appendices · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Unwanted contracts, auto-renewing subscriptions, instalment purchases, deposits that were never returned, threatening e-mails and "where do I find a free lawyer?" are among the most common problems students report. This page collects your basic rights and the places that help for free.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** students — especially newcomers who don't read German yet and sign German contracts.

3. Steps

A) Before you sign

1. **Don't sign what you don't understand.** Take a copy home and translate it. Find the contract term, automatic renewal and the notice period (Kündigungsfrist). → 32. Contracts
2. **Deposits and rent:** don't send money without a **written contract** and before you have seen the flat or received the keys; state in the transfer what the money is for. A tenant may only sublet to you **with the landlord's permission** (§ 540 BGB). → 4. Accommodation
3. **Instalment purchases:** compare the monthly instalment with your real income — if your student job ends, the instalments continue. ℹ️

B) After you sign: the 14-day right of withdrawal

1. Contracts made **online, by phone or away from business premises** (e.g. in a café or at your door) usually come with a **right of withdrawal (Widerrufsrecht)** (§ 312g BGB).

2. The withdrawal period is **14 days** and usually starts when the contract is made. It is enough to **send** the withdrawal before the deadline, and you don't need to give a reason (§ 355 BGB). Withdraw in writing (e-mail or letter) and keep proof.
3. **Exceptions:** custom-made goods, perishable goods, leisure or travel services for a fixed date and some other cases have no right of withdrawal (§ 312g BGB).

C) Payment demands, debt collectors (Inkasso) and court payment orders (Mahnbescheid)

1. **Threatening e-mail or letter from a person or a debt-collection agency (Inkasso):** neither ignoring it completely nor paying immediately is the right move. First check whether a contract actually exists, then ask the consumer advice centre. ℹ️
2. **Take a Mahnbescheid seriously** — a court payment order in an official yellow envelope. You have **two weeks from delivery** to object (Widerspruch) (§ 692 ZPO).

D) The bank won't open an account

- Everyone legally resident in the EU has the right to a **basic payment account (Basiskonto)**; the bank must respond within ten business days (§ 31 ZKG). → 6. Bank account

E) Free help in Hannover

1. **Consumer advice centre of Lower Saxony (Verbraucherzentrale):** contracts, subscriptions, energy, money matters; **free phone advice**, in-person advice by online appointment (Verbraucherzentrale – Hannover advice centre).
2. **Legal Clinic of the LUH Faculty of Law: free, out-of-court legal advice** for students of all LUH faculties, given by law students supervised by experienced lawyers (Legal Clinic Hannover).
3. **Studentenwerk Hannover: free legal advice** for international students (hannover.de – Services for international students); social counselling by online appointment (Studentenwerk – Advice). → 23. Studentenwerk
4. **AStA:** advice for international students, including employment law. → 24. AStA

F) Theft, threats and fraud

1. **Immediate danger:** police **110**. → 37. Emergency numbers
2. **Non-urgent cases** (theft in a hall of residence, online fraud): file a report (Anzeige) at the nearest police station or at the Lower Saxony police online station; keep the evidence (messages, transfer receipts, the ad).
3. **Theft or disputes in a hall of residence:** also tell the hall management or Studentenwerk. ℹ️

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Copy of the contract, receipts, messages	Required	For any advice or complaint	ℹ️
Legal Clinic advice	—	Free, LUH students only	Legal Clinic
Verbraucherzentrale phone advice	—	Free	Verbraucherzentrale
Verbraucherzentrale in-person advice	Possible	By appointment; ⚠️ the fee was not stated on the page checked	Verbraucherzentrale

5. Responsible office

- **Verbraucherzentrale Niedersachsen – Beratungsstelle Hannover:** Landschaftstraße 3, 30159 Hannover (entrance from Georgsplatz) · phone 0511 91196-0 (Verbraucherzentrale)
- **Legal Clinic der Juristischen Fakultät, LUH:** contact form on the Legal Clinic website
- **Studentenwerk Hannover – Sozialberatung:** Lodyweg 1C, 30167 Hannover · soziales@studentenwerk-hannover.de (Studentenwerk)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	§ 540 BGB	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	§ 312g BGB	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	§ 355 BGB	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	§ 692 ZPO	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
5	§ 31 ZKG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
6	Verbraucherzentrale – Hannover advice centre	Verbraucherzentrale Niedersachsen	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Legal Clinic Hannover	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	hannover.de – Services for international students	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	Studentenwerk – Advice	Studentenwerk Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	Lower Saxony police online station	onlinewache.polizei.niedersachsen.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- **Online fitness coach (2026):** a student signed a German contract in a café and later received threatening e-mails. Advice from other students: ask for a copy of the contract before any payment, don't reply emotionally to threats, and call the Verbraucherzentrale.
- **€100 "room reservation" deposit without a contract:** a common scam pattern.
- **Disputes with a main tenant (Hauptmieter):** several students got help from the university's Legal Clinic — you send your question by e-mail and get an appointment if they can take the case.

- **Ending a hall contract:** get the exact end date of the contract in writing before handing back the keys, to avoid paying rent for extra months.

68. GitHub Guide — How to Contribute to This Handbook, Step by Step

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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🗓️ This page was last updated: 2026-11-10

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 7 — Resources & Appendices · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

This handbook lives on GitHub so that anyone can fix a number, report a broken link or add an experience. This page shows the two ways to help — no programming knowledge needed.

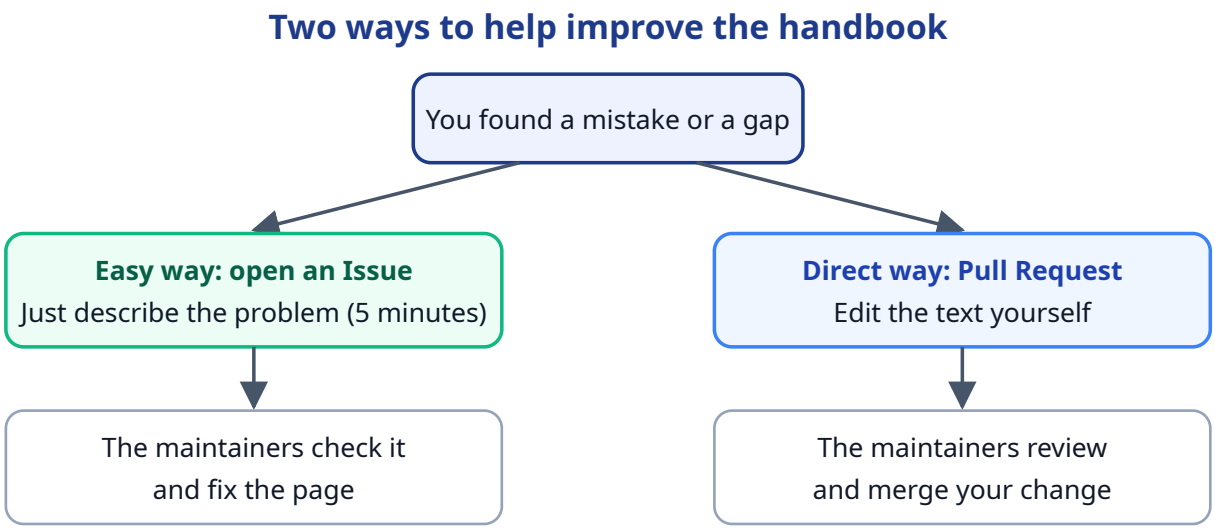
2. Who needs this?

- Anyone who found a mistake, outdated information or a gap.
- Student groups who want to keep the handbook up to date.

3. Steps

A) GitHub in one minute

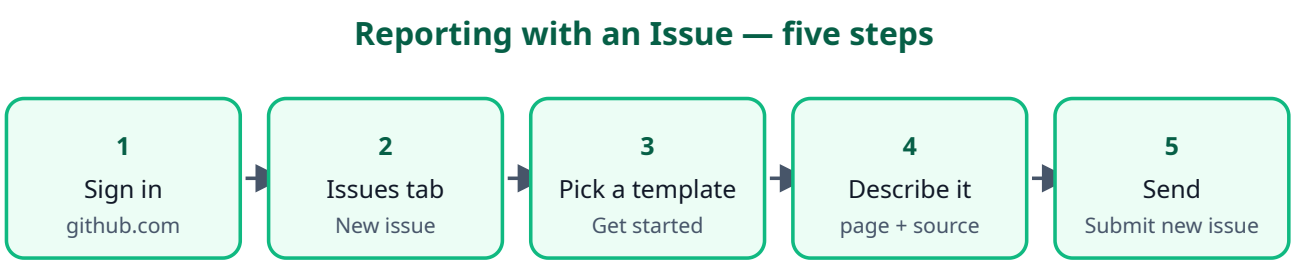
GitHub is a website where the handbook's files are stored. Every change is saved with its author and date, and nothing reaches the handbook until a maintainer has checked it.



B) Step zero: create a free account

1. Go to github.com/signup and create a free account with your e-mail address (GitHub Docs – Creating an account).
2. ℹ️ Your username is public on issues and changes; choose a neutral username if you don't want your real name shown.

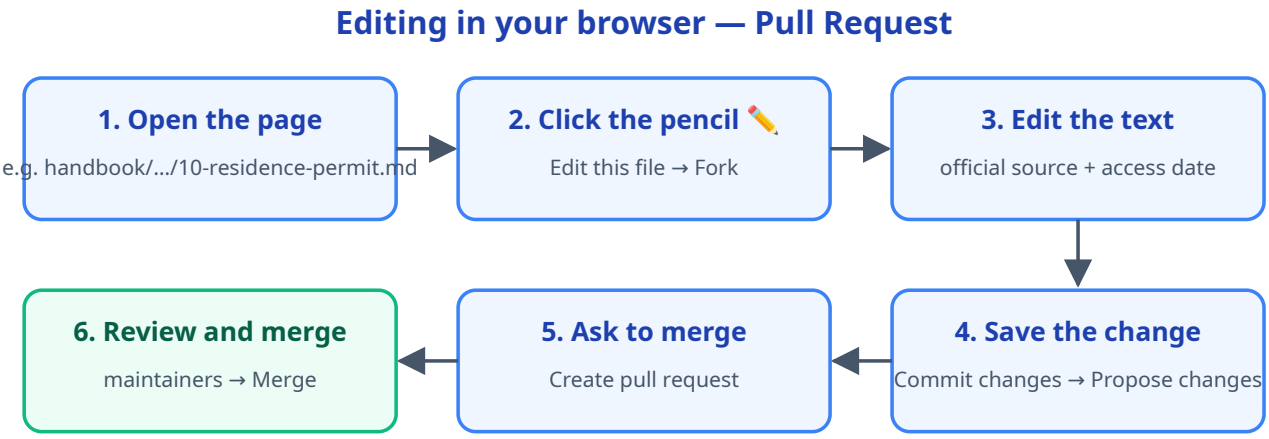
C) The easy way: report with an Issue (no Git needed)



No Git knowledge needed — just a free GitHub account

1. Sign in to GitHub and open the Issues tab of the repository.
2. Click **New issue**.
3. Choose one of the three templates (choose a template): broken link or error, student experience, or new topic.
4. Fill in the form: which page, what is wrong, and the **correct official source** if you have one.
5. Click **Submit new issue**. A maintainer replies and fixes the page (GitHub Docs – Creating an issue).

D) The direct way: edit in your browser with a Pull Request



In step 2 GitHub makes your own copy (fork) of the repository;
the handbook only changes once a maintainer approves.

1. Open the page you want to fix in the repository (e.g. `handbook/01-arriving-in-hannover/10-residence-permit.md`).
2. Click the pencil icon ✏️ **(Edit this file)** above the text. If you are not a team member, GitHub asks whether to **fork** the repository (make your own copy); confirm.
3. Edit the text. **Main rule:** every new figure, deadline or fee needs an official source link right next to it. → CONTRIBUTING.md
4. Click **Commit changes…**, write one short sentence about the change (e.g. "Update residence-permit fee for 2027") and click **Propose changes**.
5. On the next page click **Create pull request** and tick the checklist in the template.
6. A maintainer reads your change and may ask a question. Once approved it is **merged** and appears in the next PDF too (GitHub Docs – Editing files).

E) A new page

1. Open TEMPLATE.md and keep its seven-part structure.
2. Create a new file in the right section folder (**Add file → Create new file**), named like `69-topic-name.md`.
3. Add the page to that section's `README.md` and to the handbook contents.
4. Create a pull request as above.

F) For people who use Git

```
git clone https://github.com/FreeXYZ-HalfPI/Hannover-Handbook-InternationalStudents.git
cd Hannover-Handbook-InternationalStudents
git switch -c fix-residence-fee
# edit the file
git add handbook/01-arriving-in-hannover/10-residence-permit.md
git commit -m "Update residence permit fee for 2027"
git push origin fix-residence-fee
```

Then click **Compare & pull request** on GitHub. Before sending, check the links (`bash tools/check_links.sh`), regenerate the sources tables (`python3 tools/build_sources.py`) and the

search index (`python3 tools/build_search.py`), and build the PDF if you can (`python3 tools/build_pdf.py`). → README

G) Golden rules

1. **An official source for every claim**, with an access date.
2. **Personal experiences only in section 7** of a page, always with a date.
3. **No personal data:** no names of others, phone numbers, e-mail addresses, exact addresses, passport numbers or photos of documents — neither on pages nor in issues.
4. **Write simply:** as if explaining to a friend who just arrived; short sentences, German terms in brackets.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
GitHub account	Required for issues and changes	Free	GitHub – Sign up

5. Responsible office

- **Maintainers of this handbook:** via GitHub Issues
- **Rules for contributors:** CONTRIBUTING.md

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	github.com/signup	github.com	2026-10-26	⚠️ Blocks automated checks — open in a browser
2	GitHub Docs – Creating an account	docs.github.com	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Issues tab of the repository	github.com	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	choose a template	github.com	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	GitHub Docs – Creating an issue	docs.github.com	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	GitHub Docs – Editing files	docs.github.com	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

Section 8 — Information by Nationality and Specific Needs

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-10-24 · Back to the handbook contents

Most of this handbook applies to everyone. This section collects what is **different depending on where you come from or what status you have** — visa, residence, recognition, banking, protection status and community. Throughout the handbook, the 🌍 symbol marks points that depend on nationality.

Pages in this section

- 58. Which rules apply to you? — start here: overview by nationality and status
- 59. EU, EEA and Swiss citizens — free movement, EHIC, no visa or blocked account
- 60. Visa-free nationalities — Australia, Canada, Israel, Japan, New Zealand, South Korea, UK, USA and others
- 61. Visa-required countries and APS — national visa, waiting times, APS for China, India and Vietnam
- 62. Sanctions, banking and currency restrictions — money transfers, basic account, export control, consular services
- 63. Refugees and people with protection status — advice, admission, funding and temporary protection (Ukraine)
- 64. Religion, food, culture and home communities — embassies, religion, food and intercultural life

Is something specific to your country missing — for example document legalisation, typical visa waiting times or a home-country scholarship? Share it (with a date and source) on page 57.

58. Which Rules Apply to You? — Overview by Nationality and Status

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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This page is general information, not legal advice. If you have more than one citizenship, the most favourable one usually determines your rules — ask the Ausländerbehörde if unsure.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 8 — Information by Nationality · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Most of this handbook applies to every international student. But visa, residence, work, insurance and recognition rules differ a lot depending on **where you come from** and **what status you have**. This page tells you which group you belong to and which pages to read.

2. Who needs this?

- **Every** international student — read it before anything else.

3. Find your group

Group	Who	Visa before arrival	Residence permit	Work limit	Read next
A — EU / EEA	Citizens of EU countries, Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway	No	No (just register your address)	None	59
B — Switzerland	Swiss citizens	No	Yes, free-movement permit for stays over 90 days	None	59
C — Visa-free for study and work	Australia, Canada, Israel, Japan, New Zealand, South Korea, United Kingdom, USA	No	Yes, apply in Germany within 90 days	140 days/year (study permit)	60

Group	Who	Visa before arrival	Residence permit	Work limit	Read next
D — Visa-free for study only	Andorra, Brazil, El Salvador, Honduras, Monaco, San Marino	No (if you won't work before getting the permit)	Yes, apply in Germany within 90 days	140 days/year (study permit)	60
E — Visa required	All other countries	**Yes — national visa (type D)**	Yes, before the visa expires	140 days/year	61
E+ — APS countries	School/university education in China, India or Vietnam	Yes, plus **APS certificate**	Yes	140 days/year	61
F — EU mobility	Non-EU students already holding a study permit from another EU country (exchange/joint programmes)	No (up to 360 days via notification)	Not for up to 360 days	Rules of the mobility scheme	10
G — Refugees and protection status	Asylum seekers, recognised refugees, people with subsidiary or temporary protection (e.g. Ukraine)	—	Your existing status	Depends on status	63

Sources: LUH – Entry and Residence; § 41 AufenthV; § 16b AufenthG; Federal Foreign Office – Visa requirements overview.

4. Other things that depend on your country

Topic	What varies	Page
School certificate recognition	Direct university access or Studienkolleg	1. Applying
Health insurance	EHIC (EU), social security agreements, or German insurance	7. Health insurance
Bank account and payments	Sanctions or banking restrictions	62. Sanctions and payment restrictions
Driving licence	EU licence valid; some countries convert without tests	38. Driving licence
Family members joining	Language requirement exemptions for some nationalities	11. Family
Document legalisation	Apostille or legalisation, depending on the issuing country	11. Family
Pension refund when leaving	Not possible for EU and social-security-agreement countries	47. Leaving Germany
Embassy, food, religion, community	Where to find your community in Hannover	64. Religion, food and home communities

5. Responsible office

- **Questions about your individual case:** Welcome Centre of the International Office — incoming-student@uni-hannover.de · +49 511 762 188 99 (LUH) → 22. International Office

- **Official check of your visa requirement:** Federal Foreign Office Visa Navigator (digital.diplo.de)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Entry and Residence	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	§ 41 AufenthV	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	§ 16b AufenthG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Federal Foreign Office – Visa requirements overview	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	digital.diplo.de	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

59. EU, EEA and Swiss Citizens

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 8 — Information by Nationality · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

As an EU/EEA or Swiss citizen you enjoy freedom of movement, so many steps in this handbook do not apply to you. This page summarises what you **do** and **don't** need.

2. Who needs this?

- Citizens of the 27 EU countries and of Iceland, Liechtenstein and Norway (EEA).
- Swiss citizens (similar rules with a few differences).
- Non-EU family members of EU citizens.

3. Steps

1. **Entry:** a valid passport or national ID card is enough; no visa (LUH – Entry and Residence).
2. **Stays over 90 days:** you must have sufficient health insurance and enough money to live on, but you do not need to prove this in advance (LUH – Entry and Residence; Freedom of Movement Act § 4). No blocked account is required.
3. **Register your address** like everyone else, within two weeks of moving in. → 5. Registering your address ℹ️ With an EU ID card that has an online function, you may be able to register online.
4. **Residence permit:** EU/EEA citizens need none. **Swiss citizens** must apply for a residence permit (Aufenthaltserlaubnis-CH) at the Ausländerbehörde for stays over 90 days (LUH – Entry and Residence).
5. **Health insurance:** if you have statutory insurance at home, bring your **European Health Insurance Card (EHIC)**. A German statutory insurer confirms to the university that you are exempt from German student insurance. If you work more than a minijob in Germany, you usually must switch to German insurance (LUH – Health insurance; Your Europe – Health cover for students). → 7. Health insurance
6. **Application:** EU applicants often have later deadlines (e.g. 15 July / 15 January for many Master's programmes) and may apply directly instead of via uni-assist — check your programme (LUH – Application & admission). → 1. Applying

7. **Work:** no residence-law limits; social-insurance rules for students apply as for Germans. → 40. Student jobs, 42. Tax
8. **BAföG:** EU citizens may be eligible after five years of residence in Germany, or earlier in some cases (e.g. if you or your parents have worked in Germany) (§ 8 BAföG – eligible foreign nationals). → 43. Scholarships
9. **Driving licence:** EU/EEA licences remain valid; no conversion needed (§ 28 FeV). → 38. Driving licence
10. **Phone and banking:** EU roaming and SEPA rules apply; you may keep your home account, but landlords and employers often prefer a German IBAN. → 6. Bank account, 8. SIM card
11. **Voting:** EU citizens living in Germany can vote in local (municipal) and European Parliament elections (Federal Returning Officer – EU citizens).
12. **Erasmus+:** exchange students should contact the exchange coordinators (LUH – Exchange students).

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Passport or national ID card	Required	—	LUH
EHIC	Possible	If insured at home	Your Europe
Residence permit (Swiss only)	Required for Swiss citizens	For stays over 90 days	LUH
Blocked account / visa	—	Not required	LUH

5. Responsible office

- **Registration:** Bürgeramt → 5. Registering your address
- **Swiss residence permit / EU family members:** Ausländerbehörde → 10. Residence permit
- **Advice:** EU citizens' rights information service (Your Europe Advice)

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Entry and Residence	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Freedom of Movement Act § 4	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
3	LUH – Health insurance	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Your Europe – Health cover for students	European Union	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	LUH – Application & admission	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	§ 8 BAföG – eligible foreign nationals	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	§ 28 FeV	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
8	Federal Returning Officer – EU citizens	bundeswahlleiterin.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	LUH – Exchange students	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	Your Europe Advice	European Union	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

60. Visa-Free Nationalities — Applying for Your Permit in Germany

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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This page is general information, not legal advice. Check your status with the Federal Foreign Office or the Ausländerbehörde before you travel.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 8 — Information by Nationality · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Citizens of some countries can enter Germany without a visa and apply for their study residence permit after arrival. This saves the embassy step — but there are traps, especially around working before the permit is issued.

2. Who needs this?

- **Study and work, visa-free (§ 41 (1) AufenthV):** Australia, Canada, Israel, Japan, New Zealand, Republic of Korea (South Korea), United Kingdom, United States (§ 41 AufenthV).
- **Study only, visa-free (§ 41 (2) AufenthV):** Andorra, Brazil, El Salvador, Honduras, Monaco, San Marino — only if you do not want to work before getting the permit (§ 41 AufenthV).
- 🌍 Citizens of other visa-free countries (e.g. many Latin American and some Asian countries) may only visit for **90 days as tourists** — for studies you need a national visa → 61. Visa-required countries.

3. Steps

1. **Entry:** enter with your passport. Carry your admission letter, proof of finances and insurance in case border police ask about the purpose of your stay. ℹ️
2. **Register your address** within two weeks. → 5. Registering your address
3. **Apply for the residence permit within 90 days of arrival** at the Ausländerbehörde (online portal in the city of Hannover) (LUH – Entry and Residence). → 10. Residence permit ℹ️ Don't wait until day 89 — appointments take time; your application keeps you lawfully in Germany.

4. **Proof of finances:** like other non-EU students you must show about €992/month (2026), e.g. via a blocked account, scholarship or Verpflichtungserklärung (German missions in Italy). You can open a blocked account after arrival, but doing it beforehand speeds things up.
5. **Working:** you may **not** work until you hold a residence permit that allows it. Group C citizens with a national visa may work in the first 90 days; if you want to start a job immediately, the university recommends getting a visa beforehand (LUH – Entry and Residence). Group D citizens who plan to work must get a visa in their home country before arriving (LUH – Entry and Residence).
6. **Health insurance:** statutory student insurance after enrolment, or travel insurance until then. 🌍 US, Canadian, Israeli, Japanese, Korean and Australian citizens: some home policies are not accepted — check the § 11 SGB V requirements. ⚠️ → 7. Health insurance
7. **Driving licence:** many of these countries/states are on the list for conversion without tests (Annex 11 FeV). → 38. Driving licence
8. **After graduation:** citizens of § 41 (1) countries have easier access to the labour market. → 46. After graduation
9. 🌍 **UK citizens:** since Brexit, UK citizens are third-country nationals but listed in § 41 (1) AufenthV. UK citizens who lived in Germany before 2021 have special Withdrawal Agreement rights ⚠️ Ask the Ausländerbehörde if this applies to you.

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Passport	Required	—	§ 41 AufenthV
Admission letter / enrolment	Required	—	LUH
Proof of finances	Required	€992/month in 2026	German missions in Italy
Health insurance	Required	—	LUH
Residence permit fee	Required	€100	§ 45 AufenthV

5. Responsible office

- **Residence permit:** Ausländerbehörde → 10. Residence permit
- **Help at the university:** Welcome Centre → 22. International Office

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	§ 41 AufenthV	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	LUH – Entry and Residence	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	German missions in Italy	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	§ 45 AufenthV	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

61. Visa-Required Countries and the APS Certificate (China, India, Vietnam)

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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This page is general information, not legal advice. Visa procedures differ between German missions and change often; your mission's website is always authoritative.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 8 — Information by Nationality · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Most international students at LUH come from countries whose citizens need a **national visa (type D)** to study in Germany. This page explains the general procedure, country-specific extras such as the **APS certificate**, and how to cope with long waiting times.

2. Who needs this?

- Citizens of all countries **not** listed in 59 or 60 — for example most countries in Africa, the Middle East, South and Central Asia, South-East Asia and many Latin American countries. Check with the Federal Foreign Office – Visa requirements.
- 🌍 **APS countries:** applicants whose school or university education was in **China, India or Vietnam**.

3. Steps

General procedure

1. **Find your responsible mission** (the embassy or consulate for your place of residence) and read its information sheet ("Merkblatt") on student visas (Federal Foreign Office – German missions abroad).
2. **Book an appointment early.** Many missions use a service provider or the online **Consular Services Portal**, where you can upload your documents (Consular Services Portal). 🌍 In some countries waiting times are many months or there are waiting lists; book as soon as you have your admission (or as soon as the mission allows).
3. **Typical documents:** application form, passport, biometric photos, admission letter, proof of finances (blocked account: €992/month in 2026), health insurance, CV and certificates, language certificate, and

sometimes a motivation letter (German Embassy San José – Student visa information (PDF)). → 2. Before you arrive

4. **Visa fee:** usually €75 (German Embassy San José – Student visa information (PDF)).
5. **Processing:** the mission may consult the Ausländerbehörde in Hannover; processing often takes several weeks. Apply only to the mission responsible for you — applications at other missions (e.g. in a neighbouring country) are usually rejected unless you legally reside there.
6. **If your visa will be late:** tell the university in writing before the enrolment deadline. → 12. Admission and enrolment
7. **After arrival:** register your address and apply for the residence permit **before the visa expires**. → 10. Residence permit
8. **Rejected?** You can ask the mission to reconsider (remonstration) within the period stated in the rejection; the letter explains how. ⚠️ Free advice: AStA or the Refugee Law Clinic.

APS certificate (China, India, Vietnam)

1. **What it is:** the Academic Evaluation Centre (Akademische Prüfstelle, APS) at the German embassy, run with the DAAD, checks the authenticity and plausibility of your school and university certificates before you apply to German universities and for your visa (TUM – APS overview; University of Saarland – APS).
2. **When:** apply for APS **before** your university application — processing can take several weeks (interviews may be required, e.g. in China and Vietnam). Your APS certificate is usually needed for the uni-assist application and the visa.
3. **Where:**
   - 🇨🇳 China: APS Beijing (and Shanghai) — aps.org.cn
   - 🇮🇳 India: APS India, New Delhi — aps-india.de
   - 🇻🇳 Vietnam: APS at the German Embassy Hanoi — vietnam.diplo.de (section "Akademische Prüfstelle")
4. ⚠️ Exceptions exist (e.g. for some scholarship holders or exchange students). Check your APS office's website.

Other country-specific points

- 🌍 **School certificates:** in many countries a school-leaving certificate alone does not give direct access to a German Bachelor's programme; you may need one or two years of university at home or the Studienkolleg (anabin; uni-assist – Country information). → 1. Applying
- 🌍 **Document legalisation:** some missions require certificates to be legalised or verified before accepting them. → 11. Family
- 🌍 **Sanctions or banking restrictions** can make paying for a blocked account difficult. → 62. Sanctions and payment restrictions

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
National visa (type D)	Required	Fee usually €75	Federal Foreign Office
Proof of finances	Required	€992/month in 2026	German missions in Italy
APS certificate	Required (China, India, Vietnam)	Fee set by each APS office	aps-india.de
Health insurance	Required	—	LUH

5. Responsible office

- **Visa:** the German mission responsible for your place of residence

- **APS:** the APS office in your country (see above)
- **University help with visa questions:** Welcome Centre → 22. International Office

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Federal Foreign Office – Visa requirements	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Federal Foreign Office – German missions abroad	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Consular Services Portal	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	German Embassy San José – Student visa information (PDF)	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	TUM – APS overview	tum.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	University of Saarland – APS	uni-saarland.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	aps.org.cn	APS China (German Embassy / DAAD)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	aps-india.de	APS India (German Embassy / DAAD)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	vietnam.diplo.de	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	anabin	KMK	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
11	uni-assist – Country information	uni-assist	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
12	German missions in Italy	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
13	LUH	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

62. Students from Countries with Sanctions, Banking or Currency Restrictions

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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This page is general information, not legal or financial advice. Sanctions change frequently. Never try to get around sanctions or anti-money-laundering checks — it can lead to criminal charges and loss of your residence permit.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 8 — Information by Nationality · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Students from some countries face extra hurdles: international bank transfers may be blocked or delayed because of EU or international sanctions, capital controls in their home country, or banks' risk policies. This page explains what to expect and where to get help — without singling out any country.

2. Who needs this?

- 🌍 Students whose home country is subject to **EU sanctions** (you can check this on the EU Sanctions Map) or whose government restricts money transfers abroad (EU Sanctions Map).
- Students whose family cannot easily send money to Germany.

3. Steps

1. **Know the rules:** EU sanctions are mostly targeted at specific persons, companies, banks and goods — they do **not** forbid you from studying in Germany or from having a bank account here. However, transfers from sanctioned banks may be blocked, and German banks must carry out extra checks (Deutsche Bundesbank – Financial sanctions).
2. **Plan your finances early:** transferring money for a blocked account can take weeks or be impossible from some countries. Ask blocked-account providers **before paying** whether they accept transfers from your country and in which currency. Alternatives accepted by German missions: a **Verpflichtungserklärung** (formal obligation letter) by someone living in Germany, or a scholarship (Federal Foreign Office (German Embassy Managua) – Blocked account). → 2. Before you arrive

3. **Opening a German account:** you have a legal right to a **basic payment account (Basiskonto)**, regardless of nationality (§ 31 ZKG; BaFin). A bank may ask questions about the source of your money — keep documents (scholarship letters, family transfer receipts) ready. → 6. Bank account
4. **Use legal channels only:** informal money-transfer systems or carrying large amounts of cash create problems. Cash over **€10,000** must be declared to customs when entering the EU (German Customs – Cash controls).
5. **Semester fee and rent:** pay from a German account to avoid rejected transfers. If money is stuck, tell the university **before** the deadline — ask the International Office for advice. → 13. Semester fee
6. **Emergency financial help:** if a sudden crisis in your home country cuts off your funding, the International Office's emergency aid and other funds may help. → 43. Scholarships and financial support
7. **Online services and software:** some services (e.g. app stores, cloud or payment services) restrict access for users from sanctioned countries. With a German address and account this is usually solved. ℹ️
8. **Export control in research:** certain research areas (e.g. some engineering, physics or IT fields) are subject to export-control rules, which can affect access to labs or projects for nationals of some countries. Your institute is responsible for checking this (BAFA – Export control). ⚠️
9. **Consular services:** if your country's consulates in Germany have closed or have limited services (passport renewal, document legalisation), contact your embassy in Berlin early — passport renewals can take a long time. Your residence permit depends on a valid passport. → 64. Religion, food and home communities
10. **Talk to someone:** the Welcome Centre and AStA know these situations well and can refer you to specialist advice. → 22. International Office, 24. AStA

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Proof of origin of funds	Possible	Banks may ask	Bundesbank
Verpflichtungserklärung	Possible	Alternative to a blocked account	Federal Foreign Office
Customs declaration for cash ≥ €10,000	Required if applicable	—	German Customs

5. Responsible office

- **Sanctions questions (financial):** Deutsche Bundesbank, Financial Sanctions Service Centre (bundesbank.de)
- **Bank account complaints:** BaFin (bafin.de)
- **University advice:** Welcome Centre — incoming-student@uni-hannover.de

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	EU Sanctions Map	European Union	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Deutsche Bundesbank – Financial sanctions	Deutsche Bundesbank	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
3	Federal Foreign Office (German Embassy Managua) – Blocked account	Federal Foreign Office (German mission)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	§ 31 ZKG	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
5	bafin.de	BaFin	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	German Customs – Cash controls	German Customs	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	BAFA – Export control	Federal Office for Economic Affairs and Export Control	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

63. Refugees, People with Protection Status and Students from Ukraine

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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This page is general information, not legal advice. Your rights depend on your exact status. Before changing anything (e.g. switching to a student permit), get independent legal advice.

Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 8 — Information by Nationality · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

People who came to Germany seeking protection can study at LUH. This page explains the special advice services, how admission and funding differ, and what to consider about your residence status.

2. Who needs this?

- Asylum seekers (Aufenthaltsgestattung), people with a tolerated stay (Duldung), recognised refugees and people with subsidiary protection.
- People with **temporary protection** under § 24 AufenthG — mainly people who fled the war in **Ukraine**.
- Students and researchers at risk in their home country.

3. Steps

1. **Advice at LUH:** the International Office has a dedicated contact for prospective students with a refugee background (LUH – Information for refugees). Hannover's universities and Studentenwerk also set up support for students affected by the war in Ukraine (hannover.de – Support for Ukrainian students and researchers).
2. **Admission:** you generally apply like other international applicants, usually via uni-assist. If you cannot fully document your previous education because of flight, there are special procedures (plausibility check, assessment tests) (Study in Germany (DAAD) – Information for refugees). ⚠️ Ask the LUH contact before applying.
3. **Language and preparation:** German courses and preparatory programmes are offered at the LLC and the Studienkolleg; the DAAD funds university preparation programmes for refugees (e.g. "Integra")

(Niedersächsisches Studienkolleg; Study in Germany (DAAD) – Information for refugees). → 35. Learning German

4. **Funding:** recognised refugees and people with certain protection statuses can receive **BAföG**; others may receive benefits under other laws (§ 8 BAföG – eligible foreign nationals). ⚠️ Studying can affect social benefits — get advice from Studentenwerk's social counselling first. → 43. Scholarships
5. **Temporary protection (Ukraine):** residence permits under § 24 AufenthG have been extended automatically until **4 March 2027** following the EU's decision (asyl.net – Extension of Ukraine residence permits). With this permit you may study and work. Switching to a student permit is possible in some cases but has consequences (e.g. for benefits and work limits) ⚠️ (Germany4Ukraine – Help portal).
6. **Work:** recognised refugees and people with § 24 protection generally may work without the 140-day limit; asylum seekers and people with a Duldung need permission from the Ausländerbehörde. ⚠️ → 40. Student jobs
7. **Free legal advice:** the **Refugee Law Clinic Hannover** at the Faculty of Law advises refugees and migrants (hannover.de – Refugee Law Clinic at the Faculty of Law (2020 report)); the Lower Saxony Refugee Council also helps (Flüchtlingsrat Niedersachsen).
8. **Researchers at risk:** the Philipp Schwartz Initiative of the Alexander von Humboldt Foundation funds threatened researchers at German universities (Humboldt Foundation – Philipp Schwartz Initiative).
9. **Psychological support:** free counselling at ptb; specialised centres for traumatised refugees exist in Lower Saxony (NTFN) (NTFN). → 29. Counselling

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Residence document (Aufenthaltsgestattung, permit or Duldung)	Required	For enrolment	LUH
Proof of previous education	Required	Special procedures if documents are missing	Study in Germany
Language certificate	Required	Depends on programme	LUH
Semester fee	Required	Same as all students; hardship options may apply	LUH – Re-registration

5. Responsible office

- **University advice for refugees:** Hochschulbüro für Internationales, Welfengarten 1A, 30167 Hannover (LUH)
- **Residence questions:** Ausländerbehörde → 10. Residence permit
- **Social counselling:** Studentenwerk Hannover → 23. Studentenwerk

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	LUH – Information for refugees	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
2	hannover.de – Support for Ukrainian students and researchers	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Study in Germany (DAAD) – Information for refugees	DAAD	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
4	Niedersächsisches Studienkolleg	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	§ 8 BAföG – eligible foreign nationals	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
6	asyl.net – Extension of Ukraine residence permits	asyl.net — unofficial / secondary source	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
7	Germany4Ukraine – Help portal	germany4ukraine.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
8	hannover.de – Refugee Law Clinic at the Faculty of Law (2020 report)	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
9	Flüchtlingsrat Niedersachsen	nds-fluerat.org	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
10	Humboldt Foundation – Philipp Schwartz Initiative	humboldt-foundation.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
11	NTFN	ntfn.de	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
12	LUH	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
13	LUH – Re-registration	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

> This section is for personal experiences; it is not a general rule or legal advice. Share yours (with a date) on page 57 or by opening a GitHub issue.

- No experiences added yet.

64. Religion, Food, Culture and Your Home Community

⚠️ This handbook is guidance based on students' experience — not law and not official advice

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Last reviewed: 2026-11-10 · **Section:** Section 8 — Information by Nationality · **Key:** ⚠️ = needs confirmation · ℹ️ = note · 🌍 = depends on your nationality

1. Purpose

Feeling at home matters. This page helps you find your embassy or consulate, places of worship, food from home and cultural communities in Hannover — and explains how religion is handled at German universities.

2. Who needs this?

- **All** international students — whatever their religion, culture or language.

3. Steps

Your embassy or consulate

1. Find your country's embassy (usually in Berlin) and any consulate responsible for Lower Saxony in the Federal Foreign Office's list of foreign missions in Germany (Federal Foreign Office – Missions of other states in Germany). Several countries have honorary consulates in Hannover; for full consular services (passports) you may need to travel to Berlin, Hamburg or Frankfurt.
2. Renew your passport **well before** it expires — your residence permit can only be extended with a valid passport. → 10. Residence permit
3. 🌍 **EU citizens** whose country has no embassy nearby can get consular help from any other EU member state's embassy (Your Europe – Consular protection).

Religion

1. **Freedom of religion** is guaranteed by the Basic Law, including the freedom to have no religion (Basic Law – Article 4).
2. **At university:** LUH is a secular institution. Exams can be scheduled on religious holidays; if this is a problem, ask your examinations office early. ⚠️ There is no general right to reschedule.
3. **Church tax:** only deducted if you declared membership of a tax-collecting religious community at registration. → 5. Registering your address

4. **University chaplaincies and religious student groups:** Protestant and Catholic university communities (ESG, KHG) are open to all and also offer social and financial advice; Muslim, Jewish, Hindu, Buddhist and other student groups are listed among the registered student associations (LUH – Student associations). → 49. Student groups ℹ️ Know of a room of silence or prayer room on campus? Please add it via page 57.
5. **Places of worship in Hannover:** the city's information on religious communities and intercultural life is a starting point (hannover.de – Living in Hannover). ℹ️ Community members: please add verified addresses on page 57.

Food

1. **Canteen labels:** vegetarian/vegan dishes and allergens are marked; ask staff about pork, alcohol or halal options. → 28. Mensa
2. **International groceries:** many shops sell food from around the world. → 31. Shopping

Culture and community

1. **Intercultural life in Hannover:** many migrant organisations and cultural associations are active in the city; the city's integration and migration pages are a starting point (hannover.de – Living in the Hannover region). ⚠️
2. **Country-based student groups at LUH** → 49. Student groups
3. **Discrimination or racism:** you don't have to accept it. → 27. ChancenVielfalt

4. Documents and costs

Item	Required / possible	Notes	Source
Valid passport	Required	Needed for every residence-permit extension	→ 10. Residence permit
Consular fees	Possible	Set by your country	Your embassy

5. Responsible office

- **Foreign missions:** listed by the Federal Foreign Office (auswaertiges-amt.de)
- **Student groups:** AStA international department — international@asta-hannover.de

6. Sources and official links

Every link on this page was checked on the access date; the result is in the last column. If a link no longer works, report it on page 57.

#	Source	Publisher	Accessed	Result
1	Federal Foreign Office – Missions of other states in Germany	Federal Foreign Office	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
2	Your Europe – Consular protection	European Union	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
3	Basic Law – Article 4	Federal Ministry of Justice (law text)	2026-11-08	✅ Opened
4	LUH – Student associations	Leibniz University Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened
5	hannover.de – Living in the Hannover region	City and Region of Hannover	2026-11-10	✅ Opened

7. Student experiences (unofficial)

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- No experiences added yet.